SETTING-NEUTRAL ROLEPLAYING RULES



The 2d12 System

Version 2

CORE RULEBOOK

One roll, many outputs. Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

SKROXIOUSDM

The 2d12 System

Version 2 · Core Rulebook

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The 2d12 System is a setting-neutral tabletop roleplaying engine. Settings are published as separate books.

Acknowledgements & Inspirations

Testament of Dust owes a heartfelt thank-you to the creators of Blades in the Dark, :Otherworld, Cypher System, Fate, Torchbearer, Gumshoe, 2d20, Reign, and Imperium Maledictum.

In different ways, these games helped shape the questions behind this one: What makes a risk worth taking? What should success cost? How do a character's beliefs and obligations become part of play? And what keeps people moving when the world is larger, stranger, and less forgiving than they are?

Thank you for the examples, the challenges, and the moments that made me stop and reconsider a rule—or an entire approach. Sometimes the inspiration was a particular idea. Sometimes it was the feeling a game could create at the table. Sometimes it was simply the encouragement to believe that another way of doing things was possible.

2D12 system is my own answer to some of those questions, but I did not arrive at them alone. This acknowledgement is a small expression of gratitude for the work that helped me get here.

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CHAPTER I

Introduction

The 2d12 System is a setting-neutral engine for tabletop roleplaying. This chapter explains what this book contains, how its rules are named and how settings build on it.

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

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About This Book

This core rulebook holds the complete, setting-neutral rules of the 2d12 System: the engine, six optional modules, and generic Descriptors, Playbooks and Focuses that work in any genre.

Ch.	Chapter	Contents
I	Introduction	Terminology, renamed stats, notation, settings
II	Core Rules	The 2d12 roll, character creation, Tychē Points, Effects, Resistance and recovery, clocks, Truths, Momentum and Woe, the conflict system, playbooks, advancement
III	Optional Modules	Module A Cyphers & Artifacts · Module B The Grind & Travel · Module C Truth-Driven Sandbox · Module D Downtime · Module E Factions · Module F Inquiry & Revelation
IV	Adversaries	GM rules for adversaries and opposition
V	Generic Descriptors	Descriptor rules and 24 setting-neutral Descriptors, six per pool
VI	Generic Playbooks	Playbook and equipment rules; Bellator, Furcifer, Savant, Interlocutor, Explorator, Adept
VII	Generic Focuses	Focus rules and 24 setting-neutral Focuses
App.	Quick Reference	The roll, Difficulty, outcomes, bonus dice, recovery and the four currencies at a glance

When a rule here mentions another chapter, it uses that chapter's name and section number. For example, Core Rules §4.1 means Chapter II, section 4.1. A bare reference such as §6 points to a section in the same chapter. Setting books use the same chapter names when they refer back to this book.

Notation

- ★ Major. An ability that costs 1 Refresh when you take it, at creation or through advancement. Taken as a creation extra, it costs 2 Refresh total, including the extra ability's 1-Refresh price (Generic Playbooks §1.1–1.2).
- ◆ Capstone. Unlocked after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from that playbook. Take it as an Advance; it costs no Refresh, and each character can have one.
- ◈ Weird. A Focus that assumes the supernatural, strange technology or other weird elements. Each setting decides which ◈ Focuses it allows and how its world reacts to them.
- Tags are written in *italics*, such as *scarred knuckles*. Statuses add a tier, such as *wounded-2*.
- Difficulty is written by name and target, such as Standard 15 or Hard 18.

SETTINGS

The 2d12 System has no setting of its own. A setting book adds Campaign Truths, a skill list, its own Descriptors, Playbooks and Focuses, and special rules for its creatures and dangers. Where a setting rule and a general rule conflict, the setting rule wins.

Terminology

House name	What it is
Woe	The GM's pool: complications and escalation
Momentum	The party's shared pool of surplus Power
Tychē / Tychē Points	Each PC's narrative currency: invoke tags, accept compels; set by Refresh
Sōma	Pool: strength, endurance, toughness, vitality. Resists wounds, poison, exhaustion, cold
Mētis	Pool: alacrity, speed, precision, stealth, reflexes. Resists traps, falls, being caught
Psychē	Pool: mind, intellect, perception, memory, cunning. Resists confusion, illusion, deception
Pneuma	Pool: spirit, will, presence, faith, the supernatural. Resists fear, despair, possession, corruption

House name	Generic core playbook
Bellator	Front-line muscle; anchor Fight or Brawl
Furcifer	Infiltrator, scout, thief; anchor Stealth
Savant	Scholar, detective, scientist; anchor Lore or Investigate
Interlocutor	Diplomat, con artist, leader; anchor Persuade
Explorator	Ranger, pilot, explorer; anchor Survival
Adept	Mage, psychic, hacker; anchor Arcana or Tech

- Pool shorthand. Playbook stat blocks list base pools as Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne (Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma).
- Scars take the name of the pool most tied to the condition that caused them: a Pneuma Scar, a Psychē Scar (Core Rules §6.3).

CHAPTER II

Core Rules

One roll, many outputs. A pair of twelve-sided dice decides whether you succeed, how much Power you earn and whether fate twists. Around that roll: pools that double as stress, tags and Truths, Momentum and Woe, and scripted conflicts.

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

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1. Design Pillars

1. Every currency has one job. Four resources, each answering a different question:

Resource	Owner	Job
Pools (Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma)	Each PC	Physical, mental and spiritual cost — Effort and Resistance
Tychē Points	Each PC	Narrative authority — invoke tags, accept compels
Momentum	The party (shared)	Tactical surplus from strong rolls
Woe	The GM	Mirror of Momentum — complications and escalation

Where each idea comes from: §14.

2. One roll, many outputs. A single 2d12 roll tells you whether you succeed, how well (Power), and whether something twists (doubles).
3. Fiction is mechanical. Tags, statuses and Truths give recorded fiction mechanical weight: tags and statuses modify the roll, Truths shift Difficulty (§2, §5, §8). Use only the modifiers a rule names; don't invent situational maths.
4. Characters are driven, not just capable. Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts are the primary engine for earning Tychē Points and XP.

2. Core Resolution

2.1 The Roll

Roll 2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

- Skill: +0 to +4 (from the skill pyramid; untrained = +0).
- Tags: +1 per relevant power tag, maximum +2 per roll. −1 per relevant weakness tag (no cap).
- Statuses: + the tier of the highest relevant helpful status, − the tier of the highest relevant harmful status.
- Truths: shift Difficulty by steps (§8), not the roll: one step per rank, ±3 steps at most.

Why 2d12 summed: it produces a bell curve (2–24, average 13) — predictable for skilled characters, swingy at the extremes, and big enough that +1 modifiers matter without dominating.

2.2 Difficulty Ladder

Difficulty	Target	Example
Trivial	—	No roll; it happens
Routine	9	Climb a rough wall with plenty of handholds
Easy	12	Climb a knotted rope
Standard	15	Pick a decent lock
Hard	18	Track someone over bare rock
Formidable	21	Talk down a warlord in front of his troops
Heroic	24	Hold a collapsing gate long enough for a village to escape
Epic	27	Things legends are made of
Divine	30	Miraculous

Roll only when the outcome is uncertain and matters; otherwise the action is Trivial and simply happens. Each step of Difficulty is 3 points. Modifiers can push a target below Routine 9; it is still a number to roll against, not an automatic success.

2.3 Odds Reference

Chance to hit the number needed on the dice (after subtracting your bonuses):

Need on dice	2d12	3d12 keep 2	4d12 keep 2
7+	90%	98%	99%
9+	81%	94%	98%
11+	69%	88%	95%
13+	54%	78%	89%
15+	38%	65%	80%
17+	25%	48%	66%
19+	15%	32%	48%
21+	7%	17%	28%

Example: Skill +3 and one tag (+1) vs. Standard 15 → need 11+ → 69%, or 88% with one bonus die.

2.4 Bonus Dice and Effort

You can add d12s to the roll and keep the best two. Maximum +2 bonus dice (4d12 keep 2) from any combination of:

Source	Cost
Effort	3 points from the relevant pool, minus that pool's Edge (min 0), per use
Momentum	1 for the first die, 2 for the second
Woe	Give the GM 1 Woe per die
Help	An ally spends 1 point from a pool and shares the consequences

Effort. You can use Effort up to your Effort Level times per roll (1 at start; advancement unlocks 2 and 3). Each use buys one of:

- +1 bonus die — declared before rolling.
- +1 Power — declared after a Success or Success at a Cost. It cannot turn a failure into a success.

Example: Effort Level 2 lets you buy one bonus die before the roll, then spend again for +1 Power if you succeed.

Paying costs. Pay Effort and Help in full; you can't spend points a pool doesn't have unless a rule says so (§6.1). Paying the last

point runs the pool dry; a cost of 0 never does. Pay each listed cost separately, when its rule says. If a cost takes you out, finish that action, but buy no more Effort or abilities for it.

Free benefits. Free bonus dice still count toward the +2 cap. Free Help waives only the pool cost: the helper must still be relevant and still shares the risk. Backing a side at the start of a conflict is not Help (§10.2).

2.5 Outcomes

Result	Outcome
Beat the target by 3+	Success — 1 Power, +1 per full 3 points over
Meet the target	Success — 1 Power
Miss by 1–3	Success at a Cost — 1 Power, but the GM adds a consequence or gains 1 Woe (player's choice)
Miss by 4+	Failure — the GM makes a move; GM gains 1 Woe

Power is spent on Effects (§5). Any Power you don't spend becomes Momentum (party pool, max 6).

Versus tests, conflicts and automatic success. Versus tests compare opposing totals instead of using this table (§10.5). Inside scripted conflicts, §10.7 limits what failure, costs and Woe can do. An automatic success replaces the roll: apply its listed Power, with no dice-based critical or complication.

2.6 Doubles (Twists)

If your two kept dice show the same number:

- On a success: Critical — +1 Power and add a narrative flourish.
- On a failure or cost: Complication — the GM introduces a complication right away.
- Double 12s: an independent test always succeeds, with +2 Power instead of +1.
- Double 1s: always bring a complication, even on a success, but don't fail automatically. A success still gains the +1 critical Power.
- Buying it off. When the dice give you a complication (a twist, or a Risky roll, §2.7), you may cancel it by giving the GM 2 Woe: a problem now, or a problem later. If you keep it and the GM can't think of a fitting complication, the GM gains the 2 Woe instead.
- NPCs. When the dice give an NPC a complication, the GM may spend 2 Woe to cancel it. Otherwise the GM describes the complication, or invites the players to.

Base chance of doubles on 2d12 is about 8% (1 in 12). Doubles created by an ability count as rolled doubles. For doubles in versus tests and conflicts, see §10.7.

2.7 Risky Rolls (Optional)

Some rolls aren't harder, just more dangerous. Before a roll, the GM may call it Risky 1, 2 or 3.

- Risk die. Roll one extra d12 of a different colour with the others. It's never kept, doesn't add to the total and doesn't count toward the bonus dice maximum.
- Complication. If the Risk die shows the rating or lower, a complication occurs after the roll is resolved, whatever the result and on top of any twist. You can buy it off for 2 Woe (§2.6).
- Raising the stakes. The GM may spend 1 Woe to make a roll Risky 1, or to raise its rating by 1 (maximum 3). Settings may make some hazards Risky by default.

Rating	Risk die shows	Chance of a complication
Risky 1	1	about 8%
Risky 2	1–2	about 17%
Risky 3	1–3	25%

3. Character Creation

Character Creation at a Glance

Before creating characters, agree on the campaign premise: the situation that brings you together, the immediate problem, the kinds of characters that fit, and why you will cooperate. For example: isolated settlements must reopen a trade route before winter while rival leaders compete to control it.

These steps describe the order of creation; the subsections below group rules by subject for reference. Revisit earlier choices as your character takes shape.

1. Establish the campaign premise together.
2. Sketch your character concept: a role, an important experience, and something you want to explore.
3. Write your World Belief (§3.5).
4. Write your Self Belief (§3.5).

5. Choose Descriptor, Playbook, and Focus (§3.1); complete pools, Edge, skills, tags, abilities, and starting resources (§§3.2–3.4, §3.6).
6. Introduce the characters and agree on connections, including the link supplied by your Focus.
7. Write your Other Belief with the other player's agreement (§3.5).
8. Choose a concrete starting Goal (§3.5).
9. Write your Instinct (§3.5).
10. Review the character with the group.

3.1 The Sentence

> *"I am a [Descriptor] [Playbook] who [Focus]."*
>
> *"I am a Reckless Furcifer who Never Leaves Anyone Behind."*

Part	Grammar	What it gives you
Descriptor	Adjective	+2 pool points to one pool, 1 power tag, 1 weakness tag, 1 suggested Instinct
Playbook	Noun	Starting pools and Edge, special abilities, XP trigger, load-out, an anchor skill
Focus	Verb phrase	A tag theme (2 power tags + 1 weakness), a Tier 1 Focus ability, and a link to another PC

3.2 Pools and Edge

Four pools, each roughly 6–14:

- Starting values: the playbook sets the base (totals 36), plus 4 points to distribute and +2 from the Descriptor (42 total).
- Edge: the playbook gives 3 points of Edge, maximum 2 in any one pool at creation. Edge reduces the cost of Effort from that pool and adds dice when you Resist with it (§6).
- Pools are spent on Effort (§2.4) and Resistance (§6). They are your stress tracks.

Pool	Covers	Resists
Sōma	Strength, endurance, toughness	Wounds, poison, exhaustion, cold
Mētis	Speed, precision, stealth, reflexes	Traps, falls, being caught or grabbed
Psychē	Intellect, perception, memory, cunning	Confusion, illusion, deception, madness from knowledge
Pneuma	Will, presence, faith, emotional core, the supernatural	Fear, despair, possession, corruption, social pressure

3.3 Skill Pyramid

Ten rated skills from a list of 20:

Rating	Count
+4 Great	1
+3 Good	2
+2 Fair	3
+1 Average	4

The playbook's anchor skill must sit at +3 or +4. The pyramid rule (each tier must have at least as many skills as the tier above it) still applies when you advance.

Generic skill list by default pool:

Sōma	Mētis	Psychē	Pneuma
Athletics	Shoot	Notice	Will
Brawl	Stealth	Investigate	Persuade
Fight	Drive/Pilot	Lore	Intimidate
Endure	Craft	Tech	Empathy
Survival		Medicine	Arcana*
		Deceive	

*Arcana is renamed per setting: Mysticism, Faith, Psionics, Weirdness, or removed entirely in mundane games.

The default pool pays for Effort and Resistance. The GM can allow another pool when the fiction supports it (Intimidate with Sōma = looming; with Pneuma = cold menace).

3.4 Tags

Characters carry 6–8 character tags from Descriptor, Focus, and Playbook:

- Power tags (e.g. *ex-navy marksman*, *silver tongue*, *grandfather's revolver*): +1 each when relevant, max +2 per roll.
- Weakness tags (e.g. *owes the wrong people*, *bad knee*): −1 when relevant, or compel for a Tychē Point (§4).
- Any tag can be compelled. A power tag can also cause trouble when its meaning creates a concrete complication. It keeps its normal benefits (§4).
- Burning a tag: mark a power tag as burned to gain an automatic +1 Power on a success. It stays unusable until you recover it (a downtime action or a milestone). Burning ignores the +2 cap.

With a +2 cap, a third relevant tag is best used for burning or as Tychē Point invoke material.

3.5 Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts

Three Different Jobs

- Beliefs state convictions and commitments: why you act. Write one World, one Other, and one Self Belief.
- Goal states a concrete objective for this session or mission: what you want to accomplish next.
- Instinct states an if/then reflex: how you habitually respond.

Rewrite a Goal when it's accomplished or no longer fits, and check it at the start of each session. Beliefs and Instincts can change at milestones (§12.3). Beliefs can justify compels (§4) and meaningful decisions can earn XP (§12.1). They do not create an additional resource.

Writing Your Beliefs

Each Belief combines a conviction with a commitment to act: "I believe this; therefore, I will do this." Write what you intend to do, not an outcome you are guaranteed to achieve. Avoid a

virtue without an action: "I value loyalty" gives less direction than "Those who stand beside me deserve my loyalty; I will not abandon a companion to save myself."

World Belief

Connect yourself to an important problem, faction, institution, or conflict in the campaign premise. Explain why you cannot simply walk away.

- What must change, or be protected?
- Why does it matter to you personally?
- What will you do about it?

> *I believe [something about the campaign situation]. Because [why it matters to me], I will [an action or ongoing commitment].*

Example: "The settlements will starve if their leaders keep the roads divided. Because I have seen what isolation costs, I will bring them into a common defence agreement."

Agree with the group that this commitment engages with the campaign you intend to play. Characters need not share an ideology, but should have reasons to participate together.

Self Belief

State a principle about who you are, who you intend to become, or what you consider right. Show how it affects your choices.

- What principle is more than a convenience?
- What kind of person are you determined to become, or never become?
- What will you do when this conviction becomes difficult to uphold?

> *I believe [a personal principle]. I will live by this conviction by [a commitment], even when [a meaningful pressure or cost].*

Example: "People are not expendable tools. I will not knowingly sacrifice those in my care merely to secure an advantage."

Your Self Belief need not contradict the others, but their demands may sometimes pull in different directions. Do not resolve those possible dilemmas during creation.

Other Belief

Once the characters have concepts and roles, introduce their World and Self Beliefs. Agree on connections and shared history, then choose another PC whose outlook or choices interest you. Your Focus's existing link may supply this connection; writing a Belief does not grant an additional Focus benefit.

- Whom do you trust, admire, distrust, or feel you owe?
- What do you hope to preserve or change in the relationship?
- How will you act because of that conviction?

> *I believe [another PC] is / deserves / needs [my conviction about them]. Because [our connection or why it matters], I will [how I intend to act toward them].*

Example: "Mara kept our caravan alive when I lost my nerve. I will support her leadership, but I will speak against her when she treats lives as acceptable losses."

Agree on the relationship premise with the other player. Your Belief expresses your perspective, not authority over their character's motives or decisions. An agreed misunderstanding is possible; it does not establish your interpretation as fact.

Connecting Beliefs to Your Character

Use Beliefs as prompts, not prerequisites, when completing your mechanical choices:

- Descriptor: how does your temperament shape your approach?
- Playbook: what role and methods do you bring?
- Focus: what distinctive pursuit supports or complicates your commitments?
- Skills and abilities: what can you already do, and where does ambition exceed competence?
- Tags: which strengths help you act, and which vulnerabilities make that difficult?
- Load-out: which gear options and load may support your commitments? Follow §3.6; do not choose every item in advance.

Beliefs grant no extra skills, tags, abilities, equipment, pool points or Tychē, and a conviction isn't a power tag. Wanting to protect others doesn't mean you're good at it.

Choose Your Starting Goal

Choose a concrete opening objective that advances at least one Belief. It should have a recognisable completion point.

> *My current Goal is to [achieve a specific result]. I will know it is accomplished when [observable outcome].*

Example: "Secure the mill town's agreement to send a delegate to the road council."

Completing this Goal does not complete the World Belief about uniting the settlements. A Belief can motivate several successive Goals. Your Goal can instead arise from an Other or Self Belief; it need not serve all three.

Write Your Instinct

Write a recognisable trigger and habitual response. Your Descriptor's suggested Instinct can be a starting point.

> *When [trigger], I [habitual response].*

Example: "When we enter an unfamiliar place, I identify an escape route before settling in."

Acting on an Instinct takes no time, but it doesn't guarantee success or skip a roll the normal rules require. Scripted conflicts limit it further (§10.18).

Review Before Play

Read your three Beliefs, Goal, and Instinct aloud. Check that:

- Each Belief contains a conviction and intended action.
- The World Belief connects to the agreed premise.
- The Other Belief concerns a PC and has their player's agreement.
- The Self Belief can influence a difficult choice.
- The Goal gives you something concrete to pursue immediately.
- The Instinct has a recognisable trigger.
- You have reasons to cooperate even when convictions differ.

> USING BELIEFS TO PREPARE PLAY
>
> For each character, note an opportunity and a possible dilemma suggested by their Beliefs. These are invitations, not predetermined outcomes. Challenge commitments without prescribing the correct response. Use Other Beliefs to invite interaction, not override another player's agency. A character's conviction does not automatically establish facts about the world. Do not demand a roll merely to prove that the character sincerely holds it.

Example: A Character Ready for Play

Premise: isolated settlements must reopen their trade route before winter.

Concept: a former caravan guard seeking to prevent another disastrous winter expedition. The player completes the normal mechanical choices for protection, travel, or negotiation; these Beliefs do not dictate a single build.

- World: "The settlements will starve if their leaders keep the roads divided. Because I have seen what isolation costs, I will bring them into a common defence agreement."
- Other: "Mara kept our caravan alive when I lost my nerve. I will support her leadership, but I will speak against her when she treats lives as acceptable losses."
- Self: "People are not expendable tools. I will not knowingly sacrifice those in my care merely to secure an advantage."
- Goal: "Secure the mill town's agreement to send a delegate to the road council."
- Instinct: "When we enter an unfamiliar place, I identify an escape route before settling in."

The GM might offer a delegation in exchange for escorting a vulnerable supply caravan through a dangerous pass. The Goal provides direction, capabilities determine options, and the Beliefs make decisions matter. The GM does not predetermine the character's answer.

3.6 Starting Resources

- Tychē Points: start each session at your Refresh (base 3; §4.1). Beliefs and connections grant no extra points.
- Starting abilities. You get 1 playbook ability and your Tier 1 Focus ability for free, and may buy up to 2 more playbook abilities at 1 Refresh each.
- ★ (Major) abilities cost 1 extra Refresh whenever you take them: as your free pick (1), as a creation extra (2 total) or through advancement. Veteran acquisition costs are added on top (Generic Playbooks §1.2). Refresh can't drop below 1 (§4.1).
- Load-out: choose light, normal or heavy load before the mission, then declare playbook-kit items as you need them and mark their load; don't buy a full item list in advance. Signature items are chosen at creation and count against load when carried; always-carried items and items marked (0) follow their listed rules (Generic Playbooks §2.1). In conflicts, declare active gear before scripting each exchange (§10.10).

4. Tychē Points

Spend 1 Tychē Point to:

- Invoke — reroll all dice, or add +2 after rolling. This works with any tag or Truth you can justify, even one belonging to the scene or an enemy. Invokes are not limited by the tag cap. Invoke before the roll's outcome is resolved.
- Declare — establish a minor fact about the scene. The GM may require it to tie to one of your tags.
- Resist harder — reduce one Resistance cost to 0 (§6).

Declarations stay minor. A declared fact can make an approach possible or supply a relevant asset. It can't resolve an action by itself, buy status tiers or Disposition, or change Truths above scene scale (§8).

Resisting harder. The Resistance still resolves normally, but its pool cost is 0, so it can't run the pool dry, even if the pool is already empty (§6.1). It doesn't restore spent points or clear an existing running-dry status, and it can't Resist ordinary Disposition loss or a protected payment (§10.7).

Scripted conflicts add timing limits to all three spends (§10.18).

Earn Tychē Points by:

- Accepting a compel — the GM or another player offers a meaningful complication based on one of your tags (power, weakness or Scar), Beliefs (§3.5) or your Instinct. Accept → +1 Tychē Point. Refuse → pay 1 Tychē Point.
- Compelling yourself — propose the same kind of complication on yourself. If the GM agrees it meets the rules below, take the complication and gain +1 Tychē Point. Facing it can also earn XP (§12.1).

What makes a compel

- Meaningful. The complication must change the situation: an obstacle, obligation, exposure, hard choice, or lost opportunity. Flavour or a minor inconvenience doesn't count.
- Clear offer. Before you accept, know which tag, Belief, or Instinct justifies it, what will happen, and what it commits your character to. You otherwise control how your character responds.
- Limits. A compel must follow from the established meaning of the tag, Belief, or Instinct. It adds no numerical penalty and can't undo a resolved success. An existing penalty doesn't earn Tychē just because a tag, Belief, or Instinct explains it.
- *Feared duellist:* a rival challenges you before an audience whose support you need. *Devoted healer:* you stay to treat a dying enemy and lose the chance to pursue their commander.

Beliefs and Compels

All three Belief categories use the same compel procedure. Acting in line with a Belief earns nothing by itself; only a complication that meets the standard above does. Several Beliefs behind one complication still earn one Tychē Point. Beliefs grant no modifiers and are not extra power tags.

Belief example: your Self Belief rejects sacrificing people for advantage. You propose staying to escort stranded civilians instead of pursuing the fleeing saboteur. Before acceptance, agree that the delay will let the saboteur escape the immediate pursuit. Accepting that meaningful complication earns 1 Tychē Point; it does not dictate every action you take afterward.

Acting against a Belief is not refusing a compel and carries no automatic penalty (§12.3). An Other Belief never grants control over another PC.

4.1 Refresh

- Base Refresh is 3. At the start of each session, your Tychē Points reset to your Refresh (if you have more, keep them, up to the cap).
- Tychē cap. You can hold at most Refresh + 3 Tychē Points. Any you would gain above the cap are lost.
- Spending Refresh. Creation extras and ★ abilities cost Refresh (§3.6).
- An attuned artifact (Module A) costs 1 Refresh while attuned, not merely while carried.
- Minimum Refresh is 1. Purchases can't take Refresh below 1. Your current Tychē Points can still drop to 0.
- The advancement option "+1 Refresh" (§12) lets you buy Refresh back, up to the Refresh cap (§12.2).

Refresh happens only at the start of a session, not at a new scene, exchange, Inquiry phase or downtime stay. It restores Tychē Points only; pools, injuries, injury trades and Disposition use their own procedures.

Design intent: power comes at the cost of narrative flexibility. A low-Refresh character is mechanically strong but has to accept compels to stay fuelled.

5. Effects

Effect	Cost	What it does
Attack	1 Power per tier	Inflict a Status (e.g. *wounded-2*, *rattled-1*, *on fire-3*). In conflicts, Attack removes Disposition instead (§10.6)
Weaken	1	Reduce one of the target's statuses by 1 tier, or Suppress one of its tags for the scene. In conflicts, only with an explicit ability (§10.6)
Create	2 Power per rank	Create a Truth (*smoke cover*, *crowd on our side*) that lasts for the scene or until its removal condition is met. +1 Power: it ignores the end of the scene. Record its scope, rank and removal condition (§8)
Enhance	1 per tier	Give an ally a helpful status (*inspired-2*)
Restore	1 per tier	Reduce a harmful status on yourself or an ally. Lasting injuries have limits (§6.6)
Discover	1	Ask the GM one question; you get a true, useful answer
Advance	1 per segment	Tick a progress clock (§7)
Disrupt	3	Cancel or delay an enemy's prepared action, or take 1 point off the GM's Woe. In conflicts, see §10.6
Extra Feat	1	Achieve a second, related goal with the same action. In conflicts, once per action (§10.6)

Each point of Power buys an Effect that fits what your character did in the fiction. No Effect is mandatory; all purchases share one Power budget, and any unspent Power becomes Momentum.

In scripted conflicts, each action can buy only the Effects §10.6 permits. Fictional relevance is required but doesn't unlock anything else.

Free waives only the stated cost, not timing, permissions or limits.

Create discounts. Only an ability or item that states a discount lowers Create's cost: −1 Power per discount, minimum 1. Being relevant doesn't make a tag or Truth a discount. Truths above scene scale need clocks or major arcs (Module C.6).

5.1 Statuses

- Statuses have tiers 1–6. They modify rolls by ± their tier (use only the highest relevant harmful status and the highest relevant helpful status).
- Recording a status. When you create a status, record its name and tier, its scope (who or what it affects, and in which circumstances), and its removal condition (the event, recovery, treatment, or change that ends it). The scope must follow from the fiction. *Mapped patrol routes-2* — evading the patrols you watched; ends when the routes change.
- What it hinders. A status modifies only rolls within its scope: *slashed thigh-3* hinders running and climbing, not reading a ledger. A status can also decide what is possible: no roll lets you use a hand you no longer have. If circumstances change, review its scope; don't broaden it just because its name allows another reading.
- Stacking. New harm of the same kind sets the status to one tier above the higher of the existing and incoming tiers (*wounded-2* hit by *wounded-3* becomes *wounded-4*). Harm is the same kind when it worsens the same injury, affliction or condition, whatever it's called: another cut worsens *wounded*, renewed menace worsens *terrified*, but a fresh burn needn't stack with a concussion. The GM says whether new harm stacks before you decide to Resist or accept an injury (§10.11).
- Order. Resistance and armour reduce incoming harm before it stacks; they can't reduce a protected payment such as an accepted injury trade (§10.7). Harm reduced to tier 0 isn't recorded. A status can't go above tier 6.
- Tier 6: the target is Taken Out of whatever that status represents (dead, unconscious, captured, convinced, routed), within its scope. A harmful status reaching tier 6 also gives a Scar unless a specific rule replaces it (§6.3). Death needs a lethal cause and established stakes; a physical status at tier 6 can make you Dying (§6.7).
- Impede is not a status. It is a temporary conflict penalty (§10.6). An ongoing hindrance needs its own name, tier, scope and removal condition.

5.2 Example Statuses

Statuses can describe physical, mental, emotional, or social circumstances. The following names are examples, not a closed list. When recording one, give it a tier, a specific scope, and a removal condition (§5.1). Use a more precise name whenever it makes the effect clearer. These examples grant no new permission to purchase or inflict statuses; normal Effect costs and conflict permissions still apply.

Helpful status	Typical scope
Inspired	Acting on renewed hope, encouragement, or conviction.
Focused	Concentrating, analysing information, or resisting distraction.
Composed	Maintaining restraint and clarity under emotional or social pressure.
Prepared	Acting on specific plans, reconnaissance, or rehearsed procedures.
Supported	Drawing on established backing from allies, a crowd, or an institution.
Trusted	Persuading or reassuring a particular person or group that believes in you.

Harmful status	Typical scope
Wounded	Physical actions affected by a particular injury.
Exhausted	Sustained effort using the depleted physical or mental capacity.
Unsteady	Balance, coordination, reflexes, or precise movement.
Rattled	Concentration and clear thinking after shock, confusion, or intimidation.
Terrified	Facing, approaching, or acting against a particular source of fear.
Discredited	Claims and appeals made to an audience whose trust has been damaged.

Make the scope specific. Prepared and Supported need an established basis: name the plan, information, allies, or backing involved. One circumstance does not automatically grant a status and a separate tag or Truth benefit; establish and apply each component by its own rules. Trusted and Discredited apply to a named audience and subject, not everyone or every interaction. They are not universal reputation scores and do not automatically decide what another character believes. Exhausted should identify the depleted capacity rather than penalise everything.

Recording examples.

- *Mapped patrol routes-2*: helps evade the observed patrols; ends when their routes change.
- *Trusted by the village council-2*: helps persuade the council about local threats within your established credibility; ends when that trust is withdrawn or betrayed.
- *Mentally exhausted-3*: hinders sustained mental work; ends through appropriate recovery (§6.5).
- *Discredited before the merchant guild-2*: hinders claims about the disputed shipment made to the guild; ends when the accusation is disproved or credibility is restored.

Special conditions stay separate. These examples use the normal tiered-status rules. Grind conditions — Hungry & Thirsty, Weary, Exposed, Shaken, Sick, and Broken — use their listed effects and recovery requirements (Module B.3), not generic tiers inferred from their order. Running-dry statuses also follow their pool-specific procedure (§6.2). Impede is a temporary conflict effect, not a status (§10.6).

6. Resistance, Harm and Recovery

When an imposed consequence lands on you (a status, lost gear, a bad position), you may Resist, subject to the exclusions below:

1. Choose the pool that fits (see §3.2: Sōma for harm, Mētis to dodge, Psychē against deception and confusion, Pneuma against fear and the supernatural).
2. Roll a number of d12s equal to 2 + that pool's Edge and read only the highest die. If penalties take the pool's Edge below 0, see Negative Edge below.
3. Pay the listed cost in pool points. Don't subtract Edge from it; Edge has already helped by adding dice. If two or more dice show 12, pay 0 and clear one tier-1 status:

Roll	Cost	2d	3d	4d	5d
Two 12s	0 + clear a tier-1	1%	2%	4%	6%
9–12	1	55%	68%	77%	81%
5–8	2	33%	26%	19%	13%
1–4	3	11%	4%	1%	<1%

4. Effect: reduce the incoming status by 2 tiers (to 0 if that brings it below 1), or turn a severe consequence into a lesser one.

The chance columns show Edge 0 to 3 (2d to 5d). A single 12 is simply a highest die in the 9–12 band. When an ability says your Edge counts as 1 higher for a Resist, or gives Edge +1 to it, roll one more die; a penalty to Edge (such as *Exposed* or *Shaken*) rolls one fewer.

Negative Edge. If penalties take Edge below 0 for a Resist, roll 1d12. At Edge −2 or lower, the cost is 1 higher than listed (maximum 3). A single die can't give the double-12 result.

Roll	Cost at −1	Cost at −2 or lower	Chance
9–12	1	2	33%
5–8	2	3	33%
1–4	3	3	33%

Ability thresholds. Your Resistance result is the die you read: the highest die, or the single die at negative Edge. A threshold such as "on a Resistance result of 5+" checks it and grants only the benefit it names. A cost made 0 by an ability doesn't also clear a tier-1 status; only the double-12 result does that.

Imposed harm, in order. When an effect imposes a harmful status:

1. The GM names the status, its source and its incoming tier, and says whether it stacks with a status you already have (§5.1).
2. If you Resist, add any armour that applies (Generic Playbooks §2.3) and pay the cost. A cost you can't fully pay makes you run dry (§6.1).
3. Record what is left with normal stacking. A status reduced to tier 0 isn't recorded.

Once per application. Resist each application of harm once. You can't make a second attempt against the same harm.

What Resistance can't touch. Resistance changes an imposed consequence. It doesn't reverse the action's success, restore lost Disposition or revoke an agreed outcome. You can't Resist:

- ordinary Disposition loss in a conflict (§10.6);
- an injury you accepted to cancel Disposition loss (§10.11);
- a cost you accepted in a concession (§10.12), or any other cost you accepted as payment for a benefit;
- a running-dry status (§6.2).

Protected payments. Only an exception that names the protected payment or Disposition effect can change it; generic wording such as "cancel harm" isn't enough. The same applies to prevention, redirection, immunity and incidental clearing, including the double-12 result above, whichever action produced it (§10.7). Treatment and healing still work on a recorded status (§6.6) but don't refund what it paid for. Compromise statuses imposed under §10.13 can still be Resisted; that doesn't revoke the concession, and removing the injury creates no replacement cost.

6.1 Running Dry

Trigger. You run dry when a positive cost brings a pool to 0 or is more than the points left in it. Finish the action or Resistance that caused the cost, then take a harmful running-dry status for that pool (§6.2). Running dry does not, on its own, take you out, give you a Scar or refill the pool.

Overrun. Work out the final cost after Edge (for Effort), Tychē and every other permitted reduction, then compare it with the points left in the pool:

- Overrun = final cost − points left (minimum 0).
- Incoming status tier = 1 + overrun (recorded at tier 6 at most).

Spend the points you have. A pool can't go below 0, and the unpaid excess does not move to another pool.

Points left	Final cost	Overrun	Incoming status
3	2	0	None (1 point left)
3	3	0	Tier 1
1	2	1	Tier 2
1	3	2	Tier 3
0	3	3	Tier 4
0	5	5	Tier 6

Overrun beyond tier 6 has no extra effect unless a rule or an established stake says so.

Which costs can overrun. Only Resistance and costs imposed on you. Effort, Help and ability activation costs must be paid in full unless the ability says it can overrun. You may spend your exact last points on purpose: the pool runs dry and you take a

tier-1 status. A cost you accept as payment for a benefit is not an imposed cost.

Pay as you go. Pay each cost at the point its rule says, and resolve any running dry straight away. If that status takes you out, finish only the action or Resistance whose cost caused it: you can't add more Effort, buy more Power or activate more abilities for that action. The action still resolves. If it is one of two independent actions in a volley, both resolve before victory is checked (§10.12).

Separate costs stay separate. Each cost listed separately is its own payment. You can't split one cost into smaller payments, or combine separate costs, to change overrun or stacking. When one effect takes several points from the same pool at once, total them as one imposed cost unless the effect says otherwise. Costs from different pools are resolved separately.

Resisting on empty. You can Resist with a low or empty pool unless your condition prevents it (§6.4), and the Resistance still takes effect. Resolve protection, the Resistance and the original consequence first, then apply the running-dry status. The new status doesn't penalise that Resistance roll or undo its result.

Zero costs. A final cost of 0 never makes you run dry, even if the pool is already empty. Being at 0 isn't an event in itself: you don't take a new status because time passes, a new turn begins, or you take an action that costs nothing. A later positive Resistance cost or imposed cost can make you run dry again.

Empty pools. An empty pool has no penalty of its own. It doesn't remove Disposition or take you out; its running-dry status does that work. You can keep acting with other resources or with actions that cost nothing. The pool stays at 0 until rest restores it (§6.5). There is no automatic refill.

NPCs. Ordinary NPCs don't have pools and never run dry. Spending Woe on an NPC creates no status, and Woe can't be overrun: if the GM can't pay an ability's Woe cost, the NPC can't use that ability. An NPC built with full PC pools runs dry normally.

RUNNING DRY IN ORDER

1. Pay each cost when its rule says.
2. If the cost empties or overruns the pool, work out the overrun.
3. Impose that pool's running-dry status at tier 1 + overrun.
4. Stack it with the same status if you already have it (§5.1).
5. At tier 6, apply the status's scope, then record one Scar (§6.3).
6. Recover the pool and the status separately (§6.5).

6.2 Running-Dry Statuses

The status must fit both the pool and the action that drained it:

Pool	Example running-dry statuses
Sōma	*physically exhausted*, *muscular strain*
Mētis	*unsteady*, *reflexes overloaded*
Psychē	*mentally exhausted*, *cognitive overload*
Pneuma	*resolve fractured*, *spiritually drained*

Set it up once. When you first record the status, set its name and scope. Its recovery category is Depletion unless the source makes it an Injury or Affliction (§6.5). The name decides which rolls it hinders.

One status per pool. The first time a pool runs dry, that status becomes the pool's depletion status for the rest of the continuous ordeal. Write the pool beside it. Running dry in that pool again worsens the same status, unless a genuinely different cause calls for a different consequence. A new name or description is not a different cause. Each running-dry event worsens only one status.

Example. You have *mentally exhausted-2* and overrun Psychē by 2. The incoming status is tier 3, one above the higher tier is 4, so you now have *mentally exhausted-4*.

It is a cost. A running-dry status is a protected payment: armour, Resistance and cancelling effects can't prevent or reduce it, and a clearing benefit from the same Resistance or action can't clear it. Once recorded, it can be treated, Restored or healed like any other status.

6.3 Tier 6 and Scars

When a harmful status reaches tier 6, whether in one hit or through stacking, apply this general procedure unless a specific rule expressly replaces its breaking-point outcome:

1. Resolve its tier-6 outcome (§5.1).
2. Apply removal within the status's scope (below).
3. Record one Scar, subject to the limits below.

Specific replacements. Some creature tracks and setting conditions state their own breaking-point outcome; use it only where stated (§10.14). In Testament of Dust, Sun-Sick and Thirst replace the Scar with their own consequences, while Bled keeps it. The Scar limits below still apply.

Scope. If the status leaves you unable to pursue your side's intent, you are Taken Out (§6.4). If it stops only one activity (*bound* stops you moving, not talking), apply that restriction and stay in the conflict. Set a non-damage status's scope when it is inflicted, and don't widen it at tier 6. Either way, the general procedure still gives its Scar.

Not lethal by default. A running-dry status at tier 6 is not deadly on its own. Death needs a lethal cause and established stakes. Tier 6 doesn't, by itself, cost you a limb, lower a maximum pool or impose any other permanent loss; those need an established consequence, a specific effect or an agreement.

The Scar. The status records your current condition; the Scar records the lasting mark of reaching the breaking point. The player and GM agree on a Scar that fits what happened. A Scar can't introduce an unrelated injury, dictate an unrelated belief,

or extend the opposition's victory beyond the stakes. Label it with the pool most tied to the condition (a *Pneuma Scar*):

Tier-6 status	Possible Scar
physically exhausted	*my old injury gives out under strain*
reflexes overloaded	*hesitates when everything moves at once*
cognitive overload	*gaps in the memory of that night*
terrified	*can't forget what was behind the door*
resolve fractured	*doubts the oath that once sustained me*
bound or *captured*	*can't bear being restrained*

Scar limit. A character gains at most one Scar per scene, and a status that stays at tier 6 gives no further Scar. Only an ability that says so can give more. Don't split one condition into several differently named statuses to gain or avoid Scars.

Scar effects. A Scar is a lasting weakness tag, not a status. Apply it when it's relevant, and it can be compelled for Tychē Points. Rest, treatment, Restore and pool recovery don't remove a Scar; changing one takes an Advance, a milestone or an explicit ability. If a Scar and a harmful status describe the same impairment on the same roll, apply only the larger penalty. Your fourth Scar retires the character from ordinary adventuring. Finish the immediate scene, then decide with the player how the character leaves. Retirement doesn't mean death.

6.4 Being Taken Out

Ways out. You are Taken Out of a conflict when a harmful status reaches tier 6 within its scope (§6.3), when an effect says so, when you voluntarily withdraw, or when an established circumstance prevents you from pursuing your side's objective (§10.9). Ordinary Disposition loss never takes an individual out. Once you are out, you can't start another action, spend Effort or activate an ability unless its rules let you act while Taken Out.

Disposition stays with the side. Being Taken Out doesn't directly change your side's shared Disposition. Your side loses your skills, abilities and help, and if none of its participants can continue pursuing its objective, it loses after independent actions finish (§10.9, §10.12).

Out isn't down. Being Taken Out doesn't, on its own, make you unconscious, injured or dying. Describe it to fit the fiction: pinned down, disarmed, driven back, cut off, or too frightened to go on. Injury needs a status, death needs established lethal stakes (§6.7), and permanent harm needs an established consequence (§6.8).

Resisting while out. Being Taken Out doesn't automatically stop you Resisting, but the Resistance must be something you can still do. You can brace against pain while pinned down, but you can't dodge while fully *bound*, or use an act of will while unconscious. When a status first takes you out, finish any Resistance already under way. Once a conflict is settled, you can only Resist the consequences that were left open to it; you can't use Resistance to reopen the intent or delay settlement.

Getting back in. To rejoin a conflict that is still going, and that your side hasn't lost, you need both of these:

1. the condition that stopped you must be removed; and
2. an ability or rule must explicitly let a Taken Out character return.

Returning doesn't restore any of your side's Disposition unless the ability says so.

An ordinary Defend can't bring back a Taken Out ally unless its rules say it can. If you recover after the conflict is over, you act normally in the scenes that follow, subject to your remaining statuses.

6.5 Rest and Recovery

Recovery follows four successive rest stages:

Rest	Time required	Recovery
First	A few seconds; one action during an encounter	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up
Second	10 minutes	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up, then add 1
Third	1 hour	Roll 1d12, halve the result and round up, then add 2
Fourth	10 hours, usually overnight	Restore all four pools to full

- Divide the recovered points among Sōma, Mētis, Psychē and Pneuma however you wish, without exceeding a pool's maximum. They don't have to go to whichever pool was drained most recently.
- Edge does not apply to recovery. It already cuts Effort costs and adds Resistance dice (§2.4, §6).
- After the 4th rest, the cycle resets — your next rest that day (or the start of a new day) is a First rest again.
- Each PC rests and rolls independently. If two of five party members stop for 10 minutes to recover, the other three don't have to stop or roll.

Recovering running-dry statuses. Restoring a pool doesn't clear its running-dry status, and clearing the status doesn't refill the pool. Each status has one category, Depletion unless its source says otherwise:

- Depletion (exhaustion, strain, temporary overload): the default. It recovers through rest, as described below.
- Injury (real physical damage): recovers through treatment, Restore and healing time, like any wound.
- Affliction (supernatural or ongoing cause): recovers only as its source allows.

Resting off depletion *(playtest value)*. When you take one of the 1st–3rd rests, you can put the recovery roll toward the pool, toward its depletion status, or split it between them. Every 2 points removes 1 tier of the depletion status. Each point counts once. The 4th rest (full restore) also clears any depletion status whose cause has ended. It doesn't clear Scars, injuries or afflictions. Reassurance or first aid can make recovery possible, but can't keep stripping depletion tiers with Restore. Abilities that explicitly restore exhaustion or harmful statuses work as written.

No shortcut. A pool at 0 comes back through these rests like any other. Running dry never gives a special recovery roll, an automatic refill, or a way around the rest cycle. You can't overrun a pool on purpose to replace a bad recovery roll or to jump to a fresh rest stage.

Each layer recovers on its own. Disposition, pools and statuses each recover only through their own procedure:

- Disposition is set fresh when a genuinely new conflict begins (§10.2). Fresh Disposition doesn't refill pools or clear statuses, and a brief pause in the same struggle isn't a new conflict.
- Pools recover through the rests above. A full pool doesn't heal an injury, and an injury doesn't stop pool recovery unless its rule says so.
- Statuses recover by their kind: a temporary state ends when its cause or duration ends; injuries need treatment and time (§6.6); afflictions follow their source.

Winning a conflict, ending a scene or setting fresh Disposition is not a general reset.

6.6 Treatment and Healing

Appropriate care. Treatment must address the cause of the harm:

Harm	Typical care
Wounds, blood loss, poison	Medicine and suitable supplies
Fear, grief, shock	Empathy, reassurance and safety
Confusion, cognitive disruption	Diagnosis, rest or specialist care
Damaged machines or implants	Science or Craft, tools and access
Curses, possession, corruption	A fitting supernatural method or the source's stated cure

A skill doesn't supply the tools, knowledge or fictional permission on its own.

Routine care. In safe conditions, when failure would add nothing, care needs no roll. It gives permission to treat, stabilises where nothing is uncertain, and meets the conditions for natural recovery. It generates no Power. If ordinary treatment could remove one tier of a lasting injury and success is routine, remove that tier and mark the injury *treated* there's no surplus Power or Momentum. Roll only when an uncertain result matters, never just to farm Momentum.

Emergency care stops an injury getting worse: stopping bleeding, splinting a limb, pulling someone away from a harmful influence, isolating a damaged power cell. It doesn't normally reduce the tier. When the outcome is uncertain, roll the treatment skill vs. Standard 15, adjusted by Truths. On a success, the deterioration stops or treatment can begin. On a Success at a Cost, the same, with the normal cost. On a failure, the condition is still untreated; the GM announces any further consequence before another attempt. During scripted conflicts, use the conflict-specific consequence restrictions (§10.7).

Restore on lasting injuries. Restore costs 1 Power per tier (§5). It can clear a temporary condition outright when the action removes its cause: putting out burning clothes reduces *on fire*, calming an ally reduces fear. Lasting injuries are slower:

- Ordinary treatment reduces a given lasting injury by at most 1 tier. Mark it *treated*.
- Further ordinary treatment can't reduce it again until a healing interval (below) actually removes a tier from it. Interrupting rest, changing healers, renaming the injury or starting a new scene doesn't clear the mark, and new harm to the same injury doesn't refresh it. A separate injury has its own mark.
- Spare Power buys other fitting Effects or becomes Momentum as normal.
- Abilities, cyphers and items that explicitly heal a stated number of tiers (such as *healing gel*) follow their own text. Abilities that only change the cost of Restore don't lift the 1-tier limit.

Care in a conflict. Treating someone under opposition uses your action. Emergency care can be a Defend only where the conflict type or an ability allows its skill (such as *Battlefield Surgeon*). Restoring Disposition keeps your side in the contest; it doesn't heal an injury unless the action's rules also provide a healing effect. Healing an injury does not return a Taken Out ally unless the return requirements in §6.4 are met.

Healing intervals *(playtest values)*. Once a lasting injury has had appropriate care and its cause has stopped, safe rest removes one tier per interval. Use the injury's current tier:

Current tier	Safe recovery to remove 1 tier
1	One full night
2	One full day
3	Three full days
4	One full week
5	Appropriate treatment, then one full week
6, not lethal	Remove the incapacitating cause and set a recovery method
6, life-threatening	Stabilise, then definitive care before natural recovery begins (§6.7)

These are game-time intervals, not medical estimates. A full night is the normal overnight rest; a full day is 24 hours in recovery conditions; a full week is seven such days. Intervals can overlap pool rests. Recovery needs shelter, food and care that suit the injury. Light activity is fine; strenuous activity that aggravates the injury stops recovery.

Timing.

- When an injury's tier changes, its next interval uses the new tier.
- If treatment or healing lowers the tier, keep the qualifying time already spent. If that time already meets the new interval, remove one tier and start the next interval at zero. One change can complete only one interval.

- If fresh harm raises the tier, discard progress and start a new interval at the higher tier. Separate injuries don't reset each other.
- A brief interruption pauses recovery; it doesn't erase it. A bad roll on an unrelated action doesn't worsen an injury; that needs a relevant danger or a stated consequence.

Afflictions (poison, disease, possession, curses, ongoing exposure) don't follow the interval table. When the affliction is identified, its source sets what worsens it, what suppresses it, what allows recovery, and whether treatment cures it or only eases the symptoms. A setting book can give specific afflictions, and creatures that recover in unusual ways, their own rules; where it does, those rules win.

6.7 Dying and Stabilisation

Becoming Dying. After Resistance and stacking, life-threatening physical harm that reaches tier 6 makes a living character Dying, if lethal stakes allow that outcome (§10.2). It also gives a Scar as normal (§6.3), unless an explicit breaking-point replacement applies. The character is incapacitated and can't take ordinary actions. Start a 3-segment Dying clock. There is no extra *dying* penalty; the injury already records the harm. Mental defeat, capture, exhaustion and ordinary fear never start a Dying clock, and a running-dry status is never lethal on its own.

Cadence. When Dying begins, set how the clock advances: at the end of each exchange after the one in which Dying began, during a scripted conflict; or after a stated fictional interval, outside one. The clock advances because the interval passes, not because someone attempts treatment. Several characters can act in the same interval without advancing it further. Moving into or out of a scripted conflict carries the existing deadline over; it doesn't advance the clock or grant extra time.

Further harm. Each further unmitigated physical harm that could worsen the mortal injury marks one extra segment, even though the injury stays at tier 6. One action or hazard can mark at most one extra segment. When the third segment is marked, the character dies.

Stabilising. An adjacent character with suitable means rolls Medicine vs. Hard 18, adjusted by Truths. An ability or a fitting supernatural method can offer another way.

- Success: the patient is stable and the clock stops.
- Success at a Cost: stable, with the normal cost, subject to §10.7 inside conflicts.
- Failure: still Dying. The attempt uses the action, but doesn't advance the clock.

Stabilising doesn't erase marked segments, reduce the injury, refill pools or return the patient to the conflict. A stable patient can be moved with care. If a new event makes them Dying again, the clock resumes from its recorded segments.

Definitive care. Emergency care can stabilise a tier-6 life-threatening injury but can't lower its tier. Lowering it below tier 6 takes definitive care: a suitable procedure, facility or specialist, or an ability or item that explicitly heals the injury (such as *Miracle Worker*, *Not on My Table* or *healing gel*). The GM states what that requires when the injury is assessed and doesn't add requirements once they are met. When definitive care brings the injury below tier 6 and removes its immediate lethal cause, clear the Dying clock.

Immediate death. Use it only when the established outcome leaves no plausible time for rescue, or a specific killing method calls for it (such as a creature's killing strike in a setting book). Announce that danger before the roll, and allow Resistance, escape or interruption where their rules permit it; accepted payments cannot be cancelled through these general options. Once such an outcome is fully resolved, don't add a Dying clock to undo it; equally, don't skip the clock for an ordinary mortal wound just because the description is graphic. Resolve permitted post-conflict finishing procedures before compromise (§10.12).

Setting-specific harm. Use a condition's specific tiers, treatment and breaking-point rules where stated. Replace the core Dying clock only if its rule explicitly supplies an alternative death or stabilisation procedure; different condition tiers alone do not replace it. Testament of Dust's Bled uses its own tiers and recovery rules but retains the core three-segment Dying clock at lethal Bled-6. Do not run a second death deadline alongside it.

After a death. Resolve the death and its established consequences. The group may remember the character through Beliefs, relationships, keepsakes or later story developments; death creates no separate points or automatic Truth.

6.8 Permanent Harm

Where it comes from. An injury doesn't become permanent just because its tier is high. Permanent harm needs an established permanent-injury stake, a specific effect or creature rule, a voluntary bargain, or a Scar-giving event. Reaching tier 6 gives a Scar (§6.3), not a permanent loss.

The wound heals; the loss stays. A permanent change can outlast the injury that caused it. When *severed hand-4* has healed, the hand is still gone: the status measured the acute wound. Record the lasting change as a tag or a character fact, not as a status that never heals.

Adapting. Training, help, prostheses, old-world works or supernatural intervention can change how permanent harm affects play. A replacement doesn't automatically remove a related Scar, and a Scar doesn't make a replacement useless. Don't reduce maximum pools, Edge, skills or Refresh unless the effect or an agreed Advance says so.

7. Progress Clocks

- Sizes: 4 (simple), 6 (complex), 8 (daunting), 12 (epic). Specific rules may prescribe other sizes, such as the 3-segment Dying clock (§6.7).
- Player clocks tick with the Advance effect (1 Power = 1 segment).
- Danger clocks tick when the GM spends Woe (1 Woe = 1 segment) or when an established failure consequence or explicit procedure advances them.
- Racing clocks: two clocks run together (e.g. *Crack the vault 8* vs. *Guards arrive 6*).
- Linked clocks: filling one opens or unlocks another.
- Downtime projects normally use 8- or 12-segment clocks; a specific ability or project may prescribe another size, including 6 segments.

Specific procedures govern. A clock's own rule sets its triggers, pace and permitted spends, and the general lines above don't override it. Examples: the Grind (Module B) and the Dying clock (§6.7).

Clocks are not Disposition. A clock measures its named goal; Disposition measures a side's ability to pursue a conflict (§10.18).

8. Truths

Truths are tags that describe the scene, location, faction, or campaign.

- Scene Truths: *Pitch Dark*, *Knee-Deep Water*, *Hostile Crowd*. Each relevant Truth raises or lowers Difficulty by one step (±3) per rank, makes an action impossible or possible, or can be invoked with a Tychē Point.
- Rank. A Truth is rank 1 unless a number follows its name: *Pitch Dark 2* shifts Difficulty by two steps (±6). Rank 2 is the most a Truth can have; anything stronger makes the action impossible.
- Truth cap. Easier and harder Truths cancel step for step. Whatever is left shifts a roll's Difficulty by at most three steps (±9).
- Dangerous Truths. A scene Truth is dangerous when it carries lethal stakes or a listed Danger (*Gas Leak*, *Collapsing Floor* §10.8). Each one gives the GM +1 Woe per scene it is in play (§9.2).
- Campaign Truths: 3–5 world statements agreed at session zero (*Magic is real but feared*, *The Corporation owns the police*).
- Creating Truths: players use the Create effect or spend 2 Momentum; the GM spends 2 Woe. A new Truth is rank 1. Pay the same cost again, at once or later, to raise it to rank 2. A Truth lasts for the scene; only Create can pay +1 Power to make it outlast the scene (§5). The GM may also allow this for an existing Truth when the fiction supports it (*Thick Mist* thickening into *Thick Mist 2*).
- Recording a Truth. When a Truth is created, or an existing fact first matters mechanically, state its scope (the people, objects, place, or circumstances it affects), its rank and its removal condition. It only applies within its scope. It also ends when its duration expires; a removal condition never extends a duration (§5). *Smoke fills the courtyard* — sight-based actions in the courtyard; ends when the smoke clears.
- Removing Truths: use the Weaken or Create effect as a counter ("I kill the lights" removes *Brightly Lit*), at GM discretion. Each counter lowers a Truth by one rank, and a rank-1 Truth that is countered is gone.

Rank only shifts Difficulty. It adds nothing to the roll, Power, Disposition or status tier. Conflicts add further limits on creating and countering Truths (§10.18).

Scale. Scene-scale Creates and spends can't rewrite Site, Region or Campaign Truths; that takes the projects and major arcs in Module C, which also covers using Truths to drive a sandbox campaign.

9. Momentum and Woe

9.1 Momentum (shared by the party, max 6)

Gain: unspent Power from rolls. Decay: lose 1 Momentum at the end of each scene.

Spend	Cost
Add a bonus die	1 (first) / 2 (second)
+1 Power on a success	2

Spend	Cost
Ask the GM a question (Discover)	1
Create a Truth	2
Change one unrevealed scripted action in a conflict (§10.5)	2
Reduce Woe by 1	2

Paying with Woe. When the party is short, the GM may let you pay any spend except *Reduce Woe*, in whole or in part, by giving the GM 1 Woe per Momentum. Bonus dice can always be paid this way (§2.4).

9.2 Woe (the GM's pool)

Starting Woe: 2 per PC at the start of a session.

The GM gains Woe from:

- players paying for dice or other Momentum spends with Woe (1 per point);
- Success at a Cost, if the player chooses Woe (+1);
- failures (+1);
- complications bought off (+2);
- refused compels;
- Escalation (+1, §9.3);
- dangerous scene Truths: those with lethal stakes or a listed Danger (+1 per scene each, §8).

GM spend	Cost
Complication or minor twist	1
Tick a danger clock	1 per segment
NPC bonus die	1 per die
Activate an NPC/monster special ability	1–3
Create a Truth	2
Reinforcements	1 per minion, 3 for a significant NPC
Change one unrevealed action in the NPC side's script (§10.5)	3
Cancel an NPC's complication from the dice (§2.6)	2
Make a roll Risky 1, or raise its Risk by 1 (§2.7)	1

In conflicts, failure, Success at a Cost and Woe spends follow §10.7. Explicit Woe spends, Specials, hazards and Risky rolls keep their stated effects.

9.3 Escalation

Some acts and items make a situation more dangerous just by being there. They carry the Escalation tag. It gives no bonus and doesn't count toward the tag cap.

- Escalation items. Openly carrying an Escalation item into a scene gives the GM +1 Woe, once per item per scene. An item hidden before the scene starts doesn't count until it's drawn.
- Escalation actions. Declaring an Escalation action (reading a forbidden text, waking a dead machine, breaking a sacred taboo) gives the GM +1 Woe before any roll.
- Keep it rare. A playbook's starting kit should hold no more than one or two Escalation items. Settings list their own.

10. Conflict System

Use a scripted conflict for a consequential struggle in which opposing sides can make several meaningful tactical decisions. A conflict might be a fight, chase, argument, negotiation, infiltration, battle, supernatural contest, or struggle against a dangerous environment.

Each side declares an intent, establishes its starting Disposition, and secretly chooses three actions. Reveal and resolve those actions one volley at a time. Continue until one side wins, both sides are defeated, or the participants agree to a concession.

Disposition measures a side's ability to keep pursuing its objective. It is not health, ammunition, morale alone, or a count of individual participants.

10.1 When to Use a Conflict

Use a scripted conflict when all three conditions are present:

- The outcome matters enough to deserve sustained attention.
- An opponent or significant force can actively resist the intended outcome.
- Several meaningful tactical choices could change how the struggle ends.

Otherwise, use an ordinary roll or resolve the situation without rolling. A named opponent, a dangerous situation, or a large group does not automatically require a conflict.

Each Side Needs an Objective

State what each side wants to accomplish, not merely what it wants to prevent. Suitable objectives include:

- Hold the bridge until the refugees cross.
- Capture the courier before she reaches the harbour.
- Convince the council to release the prisoners.
- Escape the hunters without revealing the refuge.
- Reach shelter before the storm cuts off the pass.

An objective may be defensive. Holding the bridge until the refugees cross gives the defenders something concrete to achieve. Merely stopping the enemy usually needs more definition.

Environmental opposition also needs a stated outcome: the storm strands the travellers, the fire consumes the archive, or the river carries away the crossing.

10.2 Setup

Complete these steps before scripting:

1. Declare intent and stakes.
2. Choose the conflict type.
3. Establish participants and sides.
4. Calculate starting Disposition.
5. Apply Superiority to both sides and resolve any setup defeat (§10.3).
6. Record the adjusted starting Disposition.
7. Establish the acting order and script the first exchange.

Intent and Stakes

Each side states what it gains by winning. Establish what losing allows the opposition to do and whether capture, death, permanent injury, exposure, or another lasting consequence is possible.

Discuss what withdrawal or concession could look like.

Intent limits victory. Defeating a side whose objective is to hold a doorway does not automatically let the winner kill everyone, seize unrelated possessions, or achieve another objective.

Lethal Stakes

Establish lethal stakes before the roll or exchange that could produce a lethal outcome.

Stakes may change when circumstances change, but never retroactively. Explain the new danger and allow affected participants to respond before resolving it.

Lethal stakes make death possible, not automatic (§10.12).

Participants

A participant must be able to contribute to the side's objective. Backing the side at setup commits a character to that side's stakes. Helping an action during the conflict likewise makes the helper a participant if they were not already involved.

A character who cannot meaningfully contribute may remain outside the conflict. Do not include them merely to increase Disposition. Companions and groups follow §10.9.

Starting Disposition

The leader normally rolls 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest Edge in that skill's pool. Divide the result by three, rounding down. Then:

- Add +1 per eligible backer. Backing is not Help: it costs no pool points and gives no bonus die. Before the leader rolls, each backer explains a meaningful contribution and commits to the side's stakes. A free-Help ability adds nothing more unless it says so.
- Apply flat starting-Disposition bonuses and penalties from abilities, creature rank, conditions, and similar effects; these have no stacking cap.
- Apply a minimum of 1.
- Apply opposing Superiority (§10.3).

Record the adjusted total. It stays fixed for the conflict as the recovery cap and compromise reference, even if participants later leave (§10.9).

Adversary exception. Sides built with Grit use the Adversaries setup procedure instead of the leader's Disposition roll. Preserve explicit exceptions such as Guard when resolving independent tests.

Continuing the Same Conflict

Set fresh Disposition only for a genuinely new conflict with a materially different objective or changed circumstances. Passing

through a doorway, changing tactics, or turning a Fight into a Chase does not by itself begin a new conflict. Carry forward:

- Current and starting Disposition.
- Used injury trades.
- Taken Out participants.
- Existing injuries, Truths, and other continuing effects.

If the type changes, establish the new action skills before the next exchange. Do not reapply setup bonuses merely because the type changes.

10.3 Superiority

Preparation can weaken an opposing side before the conflict begins. Gain 1 Superiority for each applicable category, to a maximum of 3:

- Know Thy Foe: discover an exploitable weakness, motive, fear, or vulnerability.
- Know Thy Battlefield: secure an advantageous position or understand circumstances that materially favour your approach.
- Know Thy Players: establish a useful plan, alliance, resource, or other preparation.

Each category applies once and requires a distinct material advantage affecting the opposing side and the declared stakes. Rephrasing one advantage does not qualify it for several categories.

After all other starting-Disposition modifiers and the minimum of 1, reduce each opposing total by your Superiority, to a minimum of 0. Determine both adjusted totals before resolving the outcome. Superiority is not tracked or spent afterward.

Overwhelming Preparation

- Only one side at 0: its opponent wins at no cost, within the declared intent and stakes. Do not script exchanges or calculate compromise.
- Both sides at 0: resolve mutual defeat (§10.12), without scripting or a winner's compromise. Neither receives an outright or no-cost victory.
- Neither side at 0: record both totals and proceed to scripting.

Resolve setup defeat as recorded: don't restore a total to 1, reroll setup, or compare remainders or Superiority to break a tie. Only opposing Superiority can take a total below the minimum of 1.

Setup defeat inflicts no injury, pool loss or Taken Out by itself, and doesn't satisfy a creature's finishing requirement. Consequences follow the stakes and the victory or mutual-defeat outcome.

Preparation and Other Benefits

An asset may retain its normal benefits while also contributing to Superiority. A map might justify preparation and later help an action. These benefits perform different jobs:

- Superiority represents preparation at setup.
- An action tag assists a particular roll.
- A Truth changes difficulty or establishes what is possible.

Apply each only when its requirements are met. One asset does not automatically provide all three.

10.4 Conflict Types

The conflict type determines which skills establish Disposition and resolve actions.

Type	Disposition	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Fight	Fight or Brawl	Fight / Brawl / Shoot	Athletics / Endure	Deceive	Notice / Stealth
Chase	Athletics or Drive/Pilot	Athletics / Drive	Athletics / Drive	Stealth	Notice / Survival
Argument	Persuade	Persuade	Will	Deceive	Empathy
Negotiation	Persuade	Persuade	Empathy	Deceive	Investigate
Infiltration	Stealth	Stealth / Tech	Deceive	Craft	Investigate
Battle	Lore (tactics)	Fight	Endure	Deceive	Lore
Spirit Duel	Arcana	Arcana	Will	Deceive	Lore
Hack / Netwar	Tech	Tech	Tech	Deceive	Investigate
Survive the Wild	Survival	Survival	Endure	—	Notice

A dash means the action is unavailable. Settings may add types. Each needs a Disposition skill and a skill for every available action. Use the listed skill that fits the description. An action's name does not remove the need for a plausible approach.

10.5 Scripting and Volleys

Each exchange contains three volleys.

Each side secretly scripts three actions in order, assigning an eligible participant to each. Both sides commit their scripts before revealing the first volley.

Reveal the corresponding actions together, describe them, and resolve their interaction. Repeat for the second and third volleys unless the conflict ends.

If it continues, script another exchange.

Coordination and Rotation

A side may appoint a coordinator to record its script and acting order. The coordinator does not have exclusive authority over the group's decisions.

Rotation runs in rounds and carries across exchanges. Each round, every available participant acts once, in any order, and nobody acts in two volleys in a row unless they are the only one available. Helping does not count as a turn.

Update rotation when someone joins, withdraws, or becomes unable to act. Assigning an action that later proves unsuitable does not permit a free replacement.

Changing a Script

Before revealing a volley, spend 2 Momentum for the players' side or 3 Woe for the GM's side.

Replace one unrevealed action. Keep its assigned actor unless an explicit ability allows reassignment.

Action Interactions

Your action	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Attack	Independent	Versus	Attack independent; Feint trumped	Versus
Defend	Versus	Independent	Defend trumped; Feint independent	Versus
Feint	Feint trumped; Attack independent	Feint independent; Defend trumped	Versus	Versus

Your action	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Maneuver	Versus	Versus	Versus	Independent

Independent actions both resolve, even if one defeats a side or takes its actor out. Complete each action's costs, choices and effects before removing a participant because of that action; check victory after both independent actions finish.

A trumped action makes no roll and produces no effect. Describe the failed approach briefly. Failure, Woe and doubles use §10.7.

In short: Feint beats Defend and loses to Attack; two Attacks, two Defends or two Maneuvers are independent; every other pair is versus.

Independent Tests

Roll against Standard 15, adjusted by applicable Truths and other explicit difficulty modifiers, including adversary Guard. Determine Power normally.

Versus Tests

Both actors roll. The higher total wins and gains 1 Power, plus 1 for every full 3 points of margin.

Winning prevents the opposing action's normal effect, even if all Power funds permitted supplementary Effects rather than loss or recovery.

On an exact tie, neither action gains Power or produces its normal effect. Costs already paid remain spent. Success at a Cost does not turn a losing versus roll into success. Resolve doubles and complications under §10.7.

10.6 Actions and Effects

Describe how the action pursues your side's objective.

Action	Purpose	Fight	Argument	Chase
Attack	Advance the objective directly	Press an opening	Establish a decisive point	Close distance
Defend	Restore or protect your position	Regroup behind cover	Answer an objection	Recover a safe route
Feint	Exploit misdirection	Draw and bypass a response	Bait a revealing answer	Fake a route
Maneuver	Establish an advantage	Flank or obstruct	Shift an audience's attention	Block a path

Three Separate Layers

Layer	What it measures
Disposition	The side's ability to continue pursuing this objective.
Pools	A character's capacity for Effort, abilities and Resistance.
Statuses	Lasting or temporary effects that have actually happened to a character.

Losing one does not automatically reduce the others. Ordinary Attack and Feint remove Disposition only, not Pools or statuses.

Armour and Resistance do not reduce ordinary Disposition loss unless an explicit rule says otherwise. Defend restores Disposition, not Pools, statuses, equipment or established losses.

Attack

Commit at least 1 Power to remove opposing Disposition equal to the Power committed, plus 1. Apply the +1 base loss once per action, not per purchase. With no Power committed to this effect, remove no Disposition.

Defend

Restore 1 Disposition per Power committed, up to your side's starting value (§10.9). With no Power committed to this effect, restore none unless a specific ability grants recovery independently.

Feint

Use Attack's Power commitment and Disposition-loss calculation. Feint resolves independently against Defend, is trumped by Attack, and opposes Feint or Maneuver in a versus test.

Maneuver

Spend Power on these effects:

Effect	Cost	Result
Impede	1	The opposing side's next acting participant takes −3 on their action roll.
Gain Position	1	Your side's next acting participant gains one bonus die on their action roll.
Disarm	3	Disable a specific weapon, asset or key tag for the rest of the conflict.
Create a Truth	2 per rank	Establish a justified Truth, applying explicit discounts and the normal minimum cost.

Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm no more than once each per Maneuver; later successful actions may buy them again. Create may be purchased at a higher rank for its normal cost.

Temporary Effects and Ongoing Conditions

Impede and Gain Position apply to the affected side's next scripted action, including across an exchange boundary. If that action is trumped or otherwise makes no roll, the effect expires unused.

Neither applies to unrelated Resistance or incidental rolls. Gain Position counts toward the normal bonus-dice cap.

Additional grants do not stack, refresh or extend pending Gain Position. Covering Move cannot activate while pending or already declared for its Maneuver (Adversaries §6.18).

Impede is not a tiered status. Multiple pending Impedes do not stack, increase its penalty or extend its duration. Restore does not remove it merely because Restore removes statuses. Impede does not itself restrain, immobilise or render someone helpless.

An ongoing condition needs its own name, tier, scope and removal condition. For example, *entangled-2* hinders movement and actions requiring free limbs, and ends when the net is cut or the target escapes. State fictional restrictions directly; a helpless body or inaccessible weapon is not shorthand for temporary Impede.

Disarming and Denying Options

Identify the disabled asset and explain how. Disabling one asset removes an action category only if it was the side's only plausible means of performing that action. A replacement may restore access when the fiction permits. Switching equipment does not itself change a script.

Supplementary Effects Reference

A successful action may buy its primary effect and the permitted supplementary Effects below, using one Power budget. No primary purchase is mandatory.

Fictional relevance is required, but does not unlock prohibited purchases or harmful-status purchases on ordinary Attacks or Feints. General prices and treatment rules remain in §5.

Effect	Permitted actions	Price / limit	Scope
Weaken	Explicit ability only; any action	As permitted by the ability and §5	Not a cheaper Disarm. Use Maneuver's priced Disarm to disable an asset.
Create	Maneuver	2 Power per rank; explicit discounts and minimum cost apply	Establish a justified Truth.

Effect	Permitted actions	Price / limit	Scope
Enhance	Defend or Maneuver	Normal tier price (§5)	Normal scope and stacking.
Restore	Defend	Normal tier price (§5)	Normal scope, stacking and treatment limits. Maneuver has no default permission.
Discover	Any successful action	1 Power per question; repeatable	Only answers that follow from this action, not unrelated or remote investigation.
Advance	Attack or Maneuver	1 Power per segment; repeatable	A separate established clock genuinely advanced by the action, not a duplicate Disposition track.
Disrupt	Maneuver	3 Power; once per Maneuver	Cancel or delay an established prepared action outside the committed script, or remove 1 available GM Woe.
Extra Feat	Any successful action	Normal price (§5); once per action unless expressly overridden	One related secondary accomplishment within the action's scope, not another turn, roll or scripted action.

Exceptions. Other actions require explicit permission. An exception grants only its named purchase, trigger, cost, frequency and scope; a procedure replacing ordinary Maneuver effects retains that restriction. Each ability that grants an exception states its own limits.

Objective and script limits. Advance cannot automatically convert segments into Disposition loss or bypass a still-disputed objective. If clock completion would settle the conflict, establish that relationship before scripting.

Disrupt cannot generically cancel, replace, reveal or delay a committed scripted action; an ability or scenery procedure must expressly permit interference. Removing Woe cannot reverse an existing spend or cancel an accepted payment.

Extra Feat cannot duplicate primary Disposition effects, disguise a prohibited purchase, cancel an independent opposing action or achieve an objective outside the stakes.

For action-triggered Specials, use Adversaries §6.16: determine and allocate Power, declare supplementary Specials and pay their costs, close declarations, resolve permitted reactions, then uncancelled effects. Check existing effects and effects already declared for the action. Cancellation does not reopen declarations, permit reallocation or refund purchases without an explicit exception. Preserve any expressly listed later activation window, including Self-Repair's volley-end window.

Offensive Bonuses

Additional Power, additional Disposition loss and additional status tiers are separate bonuses. Each applies only to the component it names; a bonus meant for more than one must say so. If an effect inflicts both Disposition loss and a status, the ability must name the component a bonus improves, or let you choose.

Attack bonuses don't apply to Feint, staking, killing strikes or other finishing procedures unless stated.

10.7 Costs, Failures and Complications

Use normal Effort, Momentum, Woe, Tychē Points, tags and Truths subject to these restrictions and the limits in §10.18.

Ordinary Failure

An ordinary failed independent test produces no action effect and generates the usual 1 Woe. It does not also authorise an unrelated GM move, automatic injury or additional Disposition loss: the failed and opposing actions establish the volley.

Losing or tying a versus test, or being trumped, generates no ordinary-failure Woe. Apply this symmetrically to player and GM actors; costs already paid remain spent. Separately triggered complications, ability costs, scenery Dangers and explicit Woe rules still apply.

Success at a Cost

On an independent test missing by 1–3, gain 1 Power as usual. The player chooses either 1 Woe for the GM or an immediate, proportionate complication arising from the action.

An ordinary cost cannot impose an additional status or extra Disposition loss unless an explicit rule permits it. Suitable costs include exposing an approach, losing access to a minor asset or establishing a limited adverse fact.

Scenery actions use their listed Danger when the consequence option is chosen.

Doubles

Doubles work as in §2.6, including doubles created by an ability such as Perfect Strike. In versus tests:

- Double 12s don't override a higher opposing total or break a tie.
- Winning doubles add +1 Power to the margin award (double 12s: +2). Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or effect.
- Double 1s still bring their complication on a loss or tie, but don't lose automatically.

Doubles complications stay within the stakes and the action's scale. They don't cancel an independent action or change the script. Buy them off normally (§2.6).

Explicit Risks and Harm

Abilities, hazards, Risky rolls, scenery Dangers and other explicit rules may impose their stated consequences. Resolve these separately from ordinary Disposition loss.

Protected Payments

Generic wording such as ignore harm, cancel a consequence, take the hit or protect an ally does not affect shared Disposition. A rule must explicitly mention Disposition to reduce, redirect, restore or prevent its loss.

Generic prevention, redirection, immunity, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot prevent or remove an accepted injury trade, a running-dry status generated by paying a cost, an agreed concession cost or another consequence accepted as payment for a benefit. An exception must expressly identify the protected payment it affects.

Once recorded, a status can be treated or healed through the applicable procedure. Later healing does not refund the benefit, restore Disposition, refresh an injury trade or erase a Scar.

10.8 Scenery Maneuvers

A Maneuver may exploit an established feature: a Scene Truth or established fact. If it is not established, create or discover it first.

Name the feature when scripting. If it is unavailable at resolution, the Maneuver produces no scenery effect; do not substitute another feature for free.

Each feature supports one scenery action per conflict unless its nature clearly permits reuse.

Action	Requirement	Power	Result	Danger
Grab a Ride	A fixture and clear path	2	Gain Position and move to another reachable location; ignore Impede this volley.	Tier-1 winded.
Tip & Drop	A heavy object and a target below	3	Remove 3 opposing Disposition, without the Attack bonus.	An ally takes tier-1 struck.
Floor Collapse	A support that can be broken	4	Create rank-2 Collapsing Floor in the affected area.	Tier-1 stunned or a lost tag.
Carpet Pull	A suitable covering and unwarned foes	2	Impede each opposing participant's next action roll this exchange.	Your next Defend takes −1.
Drape Drop	Hangings, netting or similar material	1	Impede the opposing side's next action.	Your next action takes −1.
Shove 'Em Off	An edge and an adjacent target	3	One opponent loses their next scripted action while recovering.	Tier-2 off balance.
Make a Hazard	Fuel, fluid or a breakable container	2	Create a rank-1 hazardous Truth in the area.	You are also exposed to it.

The GM may trigger the listed Danger for 1 Woe. Danger statuses are Resistable normally.

A fall is lethal only with established lethal stakes. Describe results consistently: a collapsing floor or spreading fire affects everyone within its established scope. Dangerous Scene Truths generate Woe normally.

In other types, scenery might be a witness, document, crowd, access point, market stall or bridge. Adapt the nearest effect only when its requirements and consequences remain meaningful.

10.9 Shared Disposition and Participation

Each side has one shared total. Do not divide it among participants; there are no individual shares or spill-over. Ordinary Disposition loss removes no particular participant.

A participant stops acting when a status, explicit effect, withdrawal or established circumstance prevents contribution to the objective.

A side loses at 0 Disposition or when none of its participants can continue pursuing its objective. Check victory using the action-completion rule in §10.5.

Companions and Groups

Distinguish a participant, which takes assigned actions and is bound by the side's stakes, from an asset, which supplies tags, information or explicitly permitted helping benefits without independent turns.

Do not count the same companion twice merely because it can perform both functions.

An independently acting companion occupies a place in continuous rotation, uses its listed skills or ratings and can be prevented from acting or Taken Out. It has no separate Disposition track or injury trade unless explicitly granted one.

A group represented by one rules entry is one participant for rotation and area-effect Disposition bonuses, not one per fictional body. Apply specific Bodies or mass-combat rules only where provided.

Reinforcements and Recovery

Starting Disposition stays fixed for the conflict (§10.2). Reinforcements add their listed Grit to current shared Disposition, even above the starting value. They do not change starting Disposition or the normal recovery cap, grant additional scripted actions, permit free actor reassignment or recalculate setup.

Defend and other Disposition-recovery effects restore only up to the starting value unless explicitly stated otherwise. At or above the cap, recovery restores nothing and does not reduce the current total.

Removing a participant, backer, companion or group subtracts no contribution or Grit from current or starting Disposition. Removal may still defeat the side if nobody remains able to pursue its objective.

10.10 Conflict Gear and Assets

Equipment normally provides an action tag, counting toward the normal +2 tag cap. It may also have one explicitly written distinctive quality. Do not invent qualities during resolution.

Asset	Typical tag
Sword or knife	+1 Attack
Shield or prepared cover	+1 Defend
Spear, polearm or scoped rifle	+1 Maneuver
Smoke grenade or false papers	+1 Feint
Relevant evidence	+1 Attack in an Argument
Prepared treaty draft	+1 Maneuver in a Negotiation

An asset helps only when its use explains how it applies.

Optional Distinctive Qualities

- Sword: before the first exchange is scripted, assign its +1 tag to one action category for the conflict instead of always using Attack.
- Axe: when at least 1 Power is committed to a successful Attack's Disposition effect, remove 1 additional Disposition. Take −1 on Defend while using it.
- Shield: once per conflict, after a successful Defend, restore 1 additional Disposition.
- Knife: against a cumbersome weapon at established close range, Disarm costs 2 Power instead of 3.
- Bow: while the opponent cannot reach you and lacks an effective ranged response, Attack versus Attack is a versus test instead of independent.

Distinctive qualities do not automatically grant a second tag. Apply offensive bonuses under §10.6.

Non-Combat Assets

Evidence, promises, maps, supplies, local contacts, fortifications and plans may be assets.

Evidence supports what it establishes; a promise helps only if the recipient values it; a map helps while relevant; supplies and fortifications must first be secured.

Explain arguments through direct dialogue or third-person description. Award no bonus merely for theatrical delivery.

Changing Equipment

Declare active equipment before scripting each exchange.

Switching does not refresh a once-per-conflict quality, erase a continuing drawback or restore a lost asset.

10.11 Accepting Injury

Once per character per conflict, accept a lasting injury to cancel some loss from a successful Attack or Feint.

Declare before applying loss. Only one participant may trade against each Attack or Feint.

Accepted injury	Loss cancelled
Tier 2	1
Tier 3	2
Tier 4	3

Name the injury and explain how it preserves the side's position. It must follow from the action, have a relevant effect, be new or worsen a status, and remain below tier 6 after stacking.

You cannot:

- Pay with an injury already present or an irrelevant or wholly redundant status.
- Trade after being Taken Out.
- Cancel more loss than inflicted.
- Cancel loss from Maneuvers, hazards, voluntary costs or special effects unless permitted.
- Cancel an execution, imposed status or anything other than ordinary Attack or Feint Disposition loss.
- Invent bodily injury to pay for a purely logistical setback.

An accepted injury is a protected payment (§10.7); it cannot be prevented or reduced. It recovers through treatment and time.

The trade cancels incoming loss, not loss already suffered, and doesn't raise starting Disposition. It refreshes only in a genuinely new conflict.

10.12 Defeat, Mutual Defeat and Concession

Apply the action-completion rule in §10.5 before determining the outcome.

Defeat and Finishing Procedures

The winner achieves its intent within the established stakes, subject to compromise. Don't rerun the same contest; a new conflict needs a materially different objective or changed circumstances.

Defeat doesn't automatically inflict injury. Where a creature or setting requires a finishing procedure, victory earns the chance to attempt it: finish the deciding volley, resolve the procedure as its entry describes, then settle compromise.

Mutual Defeat

If both sides are defeated in the same volley, or both start at 0 after Superiority, neither wins outright.

Resolve compatible parts of both intents and a shared setback within the stakes. Neither receives an incompatible outcome automatically.

Calculate no winner's compromise. Setup defeat follows §10.3.

Concession

Before the next roll, propose an end to the conflict. State what the opponent gains, what your side retains, all injuries, losses, promises or obligations, and how the immediate struggle ends.

Offer meaningful success that fits the situation. A mindless predator may require an escape opportunity or sacrifice rather than surrender.

If accepted, apply the terms without another roll. Do not also apply compromise unless included. Agreed costs are protected payments (§10.7); injuries recover normally.

If rejected, continue. Conceding grants no automatic Tychē Point.

10.13 Compromise

Compare the winner's remaining Disposition with the original adjusted starting value recorded at setup (§10.2):

Starting Disposition lost	Compromise
None	None
More than 0, less than half	Minor
At least half, less than three-quarters	Significant
Three-quarters or more	Major

Use proportions without rounding. If remaining Disposition equals or exceeds the starting value, there is no compromise.

Reinforcements do not change the denominator: compare these two totals, without reconstructing earlier losses or keeping a separate loss ledger. Setup defeat uses §10.3 instead.

What Compromise Means

The winner achieves its intent, but the loser earns a proportionate concession:

- Minor: limited concession, delay, obligation, expenditure or complication.
- Significant: substantial concession, restricted terms, important loss, serious injury or meaningful part of the loser's objective.
- Major: narrow victory at a major price: lasting obligation, severe injury, important loss or powerful new danger.

These are consequence packages, not mandatory lists. Do not automatically add injury to an adequate non-injury concession.

Compromise cannot simply reverse the result or grant the loser's complete incompatible objective.

Negotiating Terms

1. Find the grade from the table above.
2. Agree one package. The loser proposes it: what the winner achieves, what the loser keeps or gains, and every cost and who pays it.
3. Settle injuries. Credit eligible existing injuries, then resolve eligible Resistance.
4. Record the binding result.

Keep terms proportionate, relevant and within the stakes. If agreement proves difficult, the GM adjudicates using these limits. Disagreement does not cancel earned compromise.

Injury Guidance

When appropriate to the package, use tier 2 for Minor, tier 3 for Significant and tier 4 for Major as starting guidance, not automatic injuries, minimum costs or penalties for everyone.

Existing Injuries

An injury suffered during this conflict satisfies one injury cost assigned to that character if its current tier meets or exceeds the required tier. Each injury counts once.

Do not pool, split, transfer or credit injuries against non-injury consequences. An injury treated below the required tier no longer satisfies the cost.

Add no replacement injury because an existing one satisfies the first.

Resistance

Imposed compromise statuses can be Resisted normally (§6); agreed payments can't (§10.7). Resisting an injury doesn't revoke the concession or other stated consequences, and adds no replacement cost.

Binding Results

Victory, concessions, promises and consequences stand. Genuinely new events may change them; do not ignore or immediately reroll them because someone dislikes the result.

10.14 NPCs and Harm

Ordinary NPCs and minion groups cannot trade injury. A named rival built as a full PC may; others require an explicit trait.

Ordinary NPCs have no Pools and reduce imposed harm only through listed Armour, traits or abilities. Apply at most one reduction per imposed status application, never to ordinary Disposition loss or a protected payment (§10.7).

NPC defeat uses §10.12. Capture, escape, injury and death follow the stakes and outcome. Use a Dying clock when rescue matters, not to make an accepted rescue objective impossible.

Creature-specific rules remain in force, including breaking points that replace the tier-6 procedure (§6.3). Immunity may stop an unsuitable status without stopping Disposition loss in a contest the creature can lose.

10.15 Order of Resolution

1. Establish objectives, stakes, participants and exits.
2. Calculate starting Disposition and Superiority.
3. Determine both adjusted totals and resolve any setup defeat (§10.3).
4. Script the exchange and assign actors.
5. Reveal the next volley.

6. Determine the interaction.
7. Pay pre-roll costs; resolve running dry.
8. Roll and determine Power.
9. Make permitted post-roll choices and pay their costs.
10. Allocate Power.
11. Calculate Disposition loss separately from statuses.
12. Offer eligible injury trades.
13. Apply remaining Disposition loss.
14. Resist eligible statuses, stack what remains and resolve tier 6, including explicit creature exceptions.
15. Complete any independent opposing action.
16. Check removal, victory and mutual defeat.
17. Before the next roll, allow concession proposals.
18. Resolve permitted creature finishing procedures before compromise.
19. Settle compromise or concession.
20. Recover each layer only through its own procedure (§6.5).

Specific rules override general rules only on the subject addressed.

10.16 Keeping It Fast

- Use full conflicts only when several tactical decisions matter.
- Record objectives and starting Disposition visibly.
- Use three cards or entries for each script.
- Keep one continuous acting order per side.
- Treat minion groups as one coordinated participant unless separation matters.
- Describe volleys briefly; reserve extended narration for decisive moments.
- Negotiate one coherent compromise package, not accumulating penalties.

Disposition around 8–11 is the initial pacing target. Aim for two or three exchanges and roughly 15–20 minutes, then adjust through playtesting rather than adding steps.

10.17 Area Effects

Provisional for playtesting.

An area effect affects everyone within its established area whom the effect can reach. Establish the area and affected participants before resolving it. An area effect does not automatically distinguish allies from enemies; selective targeting requires an explicit rule or circumstances that keep others outside its reach.

Disposition loss in conflicts. When an area Attack or Feint applies its normal Disposition-loss effect:

1. Apply the committed Power + 1 to the opposing side's shared Disposition once.
2. Add 1 Disposition loss for each additional opposing participant affected beyond the first.

Loss goes to the shared total, never to individuals. A group with one rules entry counts as one participant (§10.9).

Example: an area Attack commits 3 Power to Disposition loss and affects three opposing participants. It removes 6 shared Disposition: 3 Power + 1 for the normal Attack, +2 for the two additional participants.

Apply any eligible injury trade against the combined loss (§10.11). The area Attack remains one Attack: no more than one participant may accept an injury against it.

Explicitly inflicted statuses. When an area effect explicitly inflicts a status, every affected character receives the full purchased or listed tier. Resolve each character's Resistance or NPC harm reduction separately, then stack the remaining status normally.

Example: an effect that inflicts *burned-3* in an area inflicts *burned-3* on every affected character, not tier 3 on one and tier 1 on the others.

An ordinary conflict Attack or Feint inflicts no status just because it covers an area; it inflicts both loss and statuses only if an explicit rule says so. Outside conflicts, area effects inflict sta-

tuses normally and no Disposition loss. Offensive bonuses apply to their stated component (§10.6).

10.18 Conflict Limits Reference

These limits apply to every scripted conflict. Specific rules override them only on the subject they address.

Other Core Rules

- Invoke during an eligible roll, before its outcome is resolved. It changes only that roll: no extra turn, script change or reassigned actor. A trumped action or automatic success has no roll to invoke on.
- Declarations can make an approach possible or supply an asset. They can't resolve a scripted action, cancel an independent action, widen the stakes or reverse an accepted concession.
- Compels. Agree the consequence before accepting. A compel must respect the stakes and action timing, and can't change a script or cancel an independent action. If its terms settle the conflict, use Concession (§10.12) rather than another roll. It can't erase a protected payment.
- Instincts. Acting on an Instinct takes no time but grants no extra action, interrupt, free script change, actor reassignment or rotation bypass. A consequential response needs a permitted action or explicit ability; an Instinct can't rescue a trumped action, allow action while Taken Out or retroactively cancel a resolved effect.
- Truths. Creating or countering a Truth takes a permitted action or explicit exception (§10.6); Momentum and Woe spends grant no extra turn, free reassignment or retroactive cancellation. A Truth can set up a later scenery Maneuver but doesn't resolve it or its Danger (§10.8). A hazardous description doesn't grant both Disposition loss and a harmful status; explicit harm and area effects use their own procedures (§10.17).
- Clocks and Disposition are separate tracks. Don't convert loss, healing or clock segments between them without an explicit rule. Advance is available only to actions §10.6 permits.
- Complications, from dice or bought with Woe, stay within the stakes and timing. They don't change committed scripts or cancel independent actions unless an explicit rule permits it.

Free, Immediate and Automatic Effects

Free removes only the stated resource cost. It grants no extra turn, rotation bypass or permission to act while Taken Out. A passive benefit or a benefit explicitly requiring no action can apply without consuming a scripted action.

An immediate effect resolves at its stated trigger. It interrupts another action only if explicitly permitted, and cannot retroactively cancel resolved costs or effects.

An additional immediate action must specify its trigger, replacement of scripted actions, rotation treatment, use while Taken Out and interaction with independent actions.

Automatic success replaces the roll for an otherwise permitted action. It supplies no extra action, script change, rescue of a trumped action, expanded stakes or unsuitable approach.

On an independent test, apply the listed Power without rolling. In a versus test, it wins with its listed Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically; then resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication.

11. Playbooks

A playbook gives your character base pools and Edge, an anchor skill (+3 or +4), special abilities, an XP trigger, a load-out list and relationship prompts (1 ally, 1 rival). Each generic playbook has eight special abilities and a capstone. The full rules and all six playbooks are in Generic Playbooks.

- At creation: 1 special ability free, and up to 2 more at 1 Refresh each; ★ costs 1 more (§3.6).
- Later: new abilities, veteran abilities and capstones follow §12.2.

Settings rename and reskin playbooks (Adept becomes "Hedge Witch" in fantasy, "Netrunner" in cyberpunk) but keep the structure.

11.1 Generic Core Playbooks

Playbook	Anchor	Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	XP trigger	Concept
Bellator	Fight or Brawl	12/10/6/8	Address a challenge with force or threats	Front-line muscle
Furcifer	Stealth	8/12/8/8	Address a challenge with stealth or precision	Infiltrator, scout, thief
Savant	Lore or Investigate	7/8/13/8	Address a challenge with knowledge or insight	Scholar, detective, scientist
Interlocutor	Persuade	7/9/9/11	Address a challenge with charm, lies, or bargaining	Diplomat, con artist, leader
Explorator	Survival	11/11/7/7	Address a challenge with endurance or the land	Ranger, pilot, explorer
Adept	Arcana or Tech	7/8/9/12	Address a challenge with your powers or gadgets	Mage, psychic, hacker

12. Advancement

12.1 Earning XP (end of session)

1 XP per "yes" unless noted:

- Did you hit your playbook XP trigger? (1, or 2 in a scene with lethal stakes or a listed Danger, §8)
- Did you accomplish your Goal? (+2)
- Did one or more of your World, Other, or Self Beliefs drive a meaningful decision?
- Did your Instinct get you into trouble or save the day?
- Did you face consequences from a weakness tag or Scar?

The Belief question awards at most 1 XP per session, not 1 XP per Belief. Upholding, questioning, or acting against a Belief can qualify when it drives a meaningful decision; merely reciting or rewriting it does not.

MVP vote: the table votes on one standout moment each session; that player gets +1 Tychē Point at the next session (above Refresh, within the cap).

12.2 Spending XP (every 6 XP = 1 Advance)

- +1 to a skill (following the pyramid rule)
- +3 to one pool, or +1 Edge (max 3 Edge per pool)
- A new playbook special ability (★ costs 1 Refresh; veteran costs below)
- A new power tag, or rewrite a weakness tag into a power tag
- +1 Refresh (buys back Refresh spent on abilities or artifacts), up to the Refresh cap of 3 + 1 per 3 Advances
- A higher-tier Focus ability: Tier 2 after 3 Advances; Tier 3 after 6 Advances. Taking the ability costs an Advance; reaching the threshold does not grant it automatically (Generic Focuses §1.1).
- +1 Effort Level (to Level 2 after 3 Advances; Level 3 after 9 Advances)
- Quick Recovery (once only): recover 1 additional point on every recovery roll. It doesn't change the fourth rest's full recovery (§6.5).

Focus choices. Tier 1 is gained at creation. At Tiers 2 and 3, choose one of the tier's two options when buying that ability. Once eligible for the tier, its unchosen option can be taken later as a normal Advance. A ★ option also costs 1 Refresh.

Veteran abilities. After 6 Advances, you may take an ability from another playbook as an Advance. It costs 1 Refresh plus any ★ cost, so a veteran ★ costs 2 Refresh (Generic Playbooks §1.2).

Capstones. A capstone unlocks after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from that playbook. Take it as an Advance; it costs no Refresh, and a character can have only one (Generic Playbooks §1.2).

Refresh limits. Purchases can't take Refresh below 1 (§4.1) or above the Refresh cap.

12.3 Reviewing Beliefs and Instincts

Review the relevance of your Beliefs at session end; ordinary revisions happen at milestones. Reaffirm, revise, or replace them to reflect development in play.

- Reaffirm: keep a conviction and commitment that still matter.
- Revise: update a fulfilled or obsolete action clause while keeping the underlying conviction.

- Replace: write a new Belief when experience changes your outlook or the former commitment no longer belongs in the campaign.
- Relationships: review an Other Belief when the relationship meaningfully changes; agree on shared premises with the other player as in §3.5.

Acting against a Belief has no automatic penalty and doesn't force a rewrite; the player decides whether it leads to reaffirmation or change. Don't rewrite a Belief mid-decision to claim a reward. Rewriting alone earns neither XP nor Tychē.

Keep one World, one Other and one Self Belief. Rewrite a Goal when it's accomplished or no longer fits (§3.5). Instincts can change at milestones.

13. Example of Play

Kade, a *Reckless Furcifer who Never Leaves Anyone Behind* (Mētis Edge 1), is creeping through a warehouse to free a captured friend. He has bought Effort Level 2 with an Advance; new characters start at Level 1 (§2.4, §12.2). Scene Truths: *Dim Lighting*, *Patrolling Guards*.

- Roll: Stealth +3, power tag *quiet boots* +1, power tag *knows this district* +1 (tags capped at +2). The GM sets Hard 18 but *Dim Lighting* lowers it to Standard 15. Kade needs 10+ on the dice.
- Effort, part 1: Kade spends 3 − 1 Edge = 2 Mētis for a bonus die → 3d12 keep 2.
- Result: dice show 9, 9, 4 → keep 9 + 9 = 18, +5 = 23. That's 8 over → 3 Power, plus doubles on a success → +1 = 4 Power.
- Effort, part 2: Kade spends another 2 Mētis for +1 Power → 5 Power.
- Spend: Advance the *Reach the Cell* clock by 3 (3 Power), Discover (1 Power): "Where is the key?" — "On the sergeant's belt." 1 Power left → +1 Momentum.
- Later: the sergeant's dread patron, a bound spirit, lashes out with *terror-3*. Kade Resists with Pneuma (Edge 0), so 2d12: highest die 7 → cost 2 Pneuma. The status drops to *terror-1*.
- Compel: the GM compels *Reckless*: "You can't wait for backup; you go in now." Kade accepts and gains +1 Tychē Point.

13.1 A Scripted Conflict

Later, at the warehouse gate, Kade, Mira and Tarin confront two guards. This is a new scene: the earlier Truths don't apply, and Kade's terror was treated once the spirit's influence ended (§6.6). His spent Mētis and Pneuma stay spent. The PCs want to get their friend through the gate; the guards want to hold them until reinforcements arrive. The stakes are capture and nonlethal injury, not death.

Setup. Mira leads with Fight +3 and the highest Edge in its pool, 1. Her setup dice are 7 and 8: 7 + 8 + 3 + 1 = 19. Divide by 3 and round down to 6, then add +1 for each of her two eligible backers: starting Disposition 8. There are no other flat modifiers or Superiority. Backing supplies these points free, not extra Help dice (§10.2).

The guards' Grit 5 and 3 give their side 8 Disposition without a setup roll. Record both starting totals: they cap Defend and set the compromise grade (§10.2).

Commit the exchange. Before the first reveal, the PCs script Kade on Maneuver, Mira on Attack and Tarin on Defend. The guards script the first guard on Maneuver, the second on Defend and the first again on Feint. That's legal: both guards act in the first

round, and the second guard acts between the first guard's turns (§10.5).

Volley 1 — Maneuver versus Maneuver. Both actions resolve independently. Kade uses Stealth +3 and one relevant tag for +1 to slip around the first guard and open a path. His dice are 7 and 6, for a total of 17. The guard has Guard +1, so Kade's target is Standard 15 + 1 = 16; no Truth changes it here. He succeeds with 1 Power and buys Gain Position.

The guard's independent Maneuver totals 15 against Standard 15: a success with 1 Power, which the GM spends on Impede.

Neither Maneuver changes Disposition. Gain Position and Impede both wait for the PCs' next scripted action; neither applies to a Resistance roll in between.

Volley 2 — Attack versus Defend. Mira receives Gain Position's bonus die. She rolls 9, 6 and 2, keeps 9 + 6, adds Fight +3 and her weapon's +1 Attack tag, then subtracts 3 for Impede: total 16. The guard's Defend totals 13.

Mira wins by 3: 1 Power plus 1 for the full 3-point margin, 2 Power. She commits both to Attack, removing 3 shared Disposition (2 Power + 1), and the guards fall from 8 to 5. Their losing Defend restores nothing, and no individual guard is hurt or removed by the loss. Both pending Maneuver benefits are now spent (§10.6).

Volley 3 — Defend versus Feint. Tarin's Defend is trumped: no roll, and no Disposition restored. The first guard's Feint rolls independently and succeeds with 2 Power, committed to remove 3 PC Disposition.

Before applying that loss, Tarin accepts a new lasting *sprained shoulder-3*, describing how he holds the gate open while the others push through. The injury follows from the action and preserves the side's position. A tier-3 injury cancels 2 incoming loss, so the PCs lose only 1 Disposition, falling from 8 to 7. Tarin marks his once-per-conflict injury trade used; at most one participant could trade against this Feint (§10.11).

The injury is a protected payment: armour, Resistance, redirection and incidental clearing can't touch it, and later healing doesn't refund the trade (§10.7). Below tier 6, it doesn't take him out.

Continue or settle. After the exchange, the PCs have 7 Disposition and the guards 5, so neither side has won. Rotation carries on into the next exchange: Tarin acted last, so he can't take its first volley. A brief pause doesn't refresh Disposition or Tarin's injury trade.

Suppose the PCs later win with 4 of their starting 8 Disposition left. They lost exactly half, so the compromise is Significant. That calls for one outcome-first package, not an automatic tier-3 injury, and Tarin's existing injury can be credited once against it. The PCs achieve their stated intent, not permission to seize unrelated property or kill the guards (§10.12–10.13).

Afterward. Fresh Disposition in a new conflict won't refill pools or heal Tarin's shoulder. Treatment removes at most one tier of a lasting injury before a healing interval removes another (§6.6). A Taken Out character who is healed still needs explicit permission to rejoin an ongoing conflict (§6.4).

14. Design Notes — What Was Kept, Changed, Cut

Source	Kept	Changed	Cut
Fate	Skill pyramid, Tychē Points, invoke/compel, Refresh as cost of power	Aspects are replaced by tags and Truths	Fudge dice, stress boxes
Cypher	Pools, Edge, the sentence, Effort on rolls and on Power, cyphers and artifacts (Module A)	Four pools instead of three; Effort buys bonus dice instead of lowering difficulty	d20 task levels, GM intrusions (replaced by compels and Woe)
:Otherscape	Power/weakness tags, statuses with tiers, effects, burning tags	Power comes from roll margin; tag cap +2	Themebooks, Improve/Abandon tracks
Mouse Guard	Full conflict scripting, shared Disposition, outcome-first compromise, BIG, weapons as action bonuses, the Grind (Module B)	Rolled Disposition divides the setup total by 3 before backers and flat modifiers; actions spend Power	Nature, Persona
Blades	Playbooks, resistance, stress-as-currency, clocks, load-out	Stress tracks are the four pools	Action dice pools, Position/Effect grid, crew sheets
2d20	Momentum, Woe, Truths, Module C, buy-offs, Escalation	Momentum from unspent Power; Truths shift Difficulty; complication range → Risk die (§2.7)	d20 roll-under

14.1 Known Risks

- Currency load: pools + Tychē + Momentum + Woe is the upper limit for medium crunch. Keep spend menus short on the sheet.
- Modifier range: max is skill +4, tags +2, helpful status up to +6, Tychē invoke +2. Statuses are the largest swing. Playtest a ±3 status cap.
- Effort for Power may make high-Edge characters very efficient. Watch Edge-3 pools where Effort is free; consider a minimum cost of 1.
- Resistance dice: Edge adds Resistance dice instead of reducing the cost, and only a double 12 is free (§6). Watch how often stacked penalties (two −1 Edge penalties on a 0-Edge pool) push Resistance to negative Edge, whether high-Edge pools drain faster than before, and whether the double-12 result (1–6%) is too rare to matter.
- Four pools means more pool points to track. The sheet should put all four in one row with Edge beside each.
- Conflict length: with scripting used for every big contest, the conflict test (§10.1) is what stops overuse.
- Running dry: running dry imposes a status at tier 1 + overrun, and Scars come from tier 6, not from an empty pool (§6.1–6.3). Playtest the 2-points-per-tier depletion rate, the one-Scar-per-scene limit, and how often Resisting on an empty pool reaches tier 4 or higher.
- Damage cycle: watch whether the injury trade (§10.11) is a hard choice or always taken, and whether it drags conflicts out. Test the healing intervals, the 3-segment Dying clock, and whether the 1-tier treatment limit makes Restore-cost abilities (*Field Medic*, *Field Surgeon*) too weak against lasting injuries.
- Shared Disposition: one track per side (§10.2, §10.9). Watch whether a lone remaining participant acting repeatedly feels heroic or too forgiving, and whether larger parties get too many injury trades.
- Old simulation figures: earlier notes reported mirrored fights about 23.5% shorter with shared Disposition, and an older setup averaging about 6 Disposition (range 3–9) and 6 volleys. Those figures predate the divide-by-three setup; re-run them before predicting conflict length. A fixed track of 5 is a possible comparison, not a rule.
- Attack and Feint +1 (§10.6): watch whether Defend keeps pace, whether Feint becomes the default action, and how the +1 stacks with *Crowd Work* and *Every Trick in the Book*.
- Superiority (§10.3): watch whether preparation becomes routine, how often both sides claim it, and whether one advantage is being described several ways to claim more categories.
- Playtest flags in the text: §5.1 stacking; §6 negative Edge; §6.3 one Scar per scene; §10.3 PC/opposition symmetry and Superiority eligibility; §10.5 Feint versus Maneuver; §10.13 four-step compromise; §10.17 area effects. These notes don't settle them.

CHAPTER III

Optional Modules

Six drop-in modules for longer campaigns: one-use cyphers and dangerous artifacts, the grinding cost of travel and hardship, a sandbox where the world itself is written in Truths, downtime, factions and investigation.

Use any, all, or none. A setting book may recommend some.

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Combining Modules

Choose the modules the campaign needs. Use an explicit replacement instead of running both versions of the same procedure:

- Downtime (D) replaces Module B.4's Players' Turn procedure. Core field rests and Module B's Grind-condition recovery remain separate (D.1).
- Factions (E) replaces Module C.5's basic faction action procedure. Its starting-cluster procedure E.1A replaces C.8; retain the rest of Module C.
- Downtime with Factions uses one World Turn per stay, after endeavours resolve (D.7, E.10). A longer stay does not create extra World Turns or faster Strain recovery.
- Inquiry (F) adds clue and Insight procedures to Inquiry scenes. It doesn't replace conflicts, and relabelling a scene doesn't reset one.

Module rules override core rules only where they say so: the Grind's 2-Woe tick isn't the danger-clock rate, and a cypher's no-roll use isn't an extra scripted turn. Pools, statuses, Disposition, project clocks and faction Qualities stay separate unless a rule links them.

Anything a module doesn't cover is an open ruling, not permission to add effects, costs or resets. Each module lists its own.

Module A — Cyphers & Artifacts (Cypher)

Cyphers are frequent, disposable power-ups that encourage players to use them rather than hoard them. Artifacts are rare, reusable items that may run out.

A.1 Cyphers

Sample cypher table (d12):

d12	Cypher	Tier	Effects
1	Healing salve / med-gel	2	Restore
2	Smoke charge	2	Create (*smoke cover*)
3	Flashbang / thunderstone	3	Attack (dazed), Weaken
4	Truth serum / mind-read charm	2	Discover ×2
5	Adrenal shot	3	Enhance (surging), restore 3 Sōma
6	Lockbreaker	3	Advance (any lock or security clock)
7	Ward token	3	Negate one incoming status of tier 3 or less
8	Phase key	4	Create Truth (*passage through the wall*) for one scene
9	Courage draught	2	Restore (fear), restore 2 Pneuma
10	Seeker	2	Discover (location of one person or object)
11	Firebomb	4	Attack (on fire), Create (*burning*)
12	Wild card	d6	Player names a reasonable Effect; GM sets the form

- What they are: one-use items or effects — potions, grenades, scrolls, nanite injectors, blessed relics, strange tech. Each has a tier (1–6).
- Using one: an action, usually with no roll. The cypher generates Power equal to its tier, spent only on its listed Effects. Some create a Truth instead. Fixed benefits, such as *restore 3 Sōma*, happen as written and aren't Power.
- Cypher Limit: each PC can carry 2 cyphers. A setting ability may raise this.
- Over the limit: at the end of each scene, the GM gains 1 Woe per extra cypher and may trigger a Volatile result (roll d12: 1–4 one cypher fires randomly; 5–8 one cypher is ruined; 9–12 nothing happens yet).
- Subtle cyphers (setting option): instead of physical objects, cyphers are luck, insights, or favours ("a contact owes you", "a flash of insight"). They work the same way and fit low-magic or modern games.
- GM pacing: give out 1–2 cyphers per PC per session. They should feel like loot that gets spent.

One Power budget. Split the Power among the listed Effects; each Effect doesn't get the full budget. Create costs 2 Power per rank (Core Rules §5): a tier-2 Smoke charge buys rank-1 *smoke cover*, and a tier-4 Firebomb that buys a rank-2 *burning* Truth has nothing left for its Attack.

In a scripted conflict, using a cypher still takes a scripted action, or a trigger the item states. "No roll" means automatic success on an action that's otherwise allowed: it doesn't rescue a trumped action, change the script or bypass rotation, and it can't be used while Taken Out (Core Rules §10.5). With no dice, there's no critical or complication.

Which action. A cypher with Attack among its Effects is used on a scripted Attack or Feint; any other cypher is used on a Maneuver. The Ward token is the exception: use it when a status would be inflicted on you, with no action, once per scene.

Harm and protection. An ordinary Attack removes Disposition, not a status. A status-inflicting cypher inflicts its listed status and removes no Disposition unless it says so. The Ward token can't negate Disposition loss, running-dry statuses or other protected payments (Core Rules §10.7).

Healing. Restore on a cypher follows the normal limit for lasting injuries: treatment removes at most 1 tier, unless the item says otherwise (Core Rules §6.6). Restoring Sōma or Pneuma doesn't clear statuses, refund injury trades, erase Scars or return a Taken Out ally to the conflict (Core Rules §6.4).

Area. Words like grenade or blast don't create an area effect by themselves. An item with an explicit area effect uses Core Rules §10.17.

Cypher format:

> *Flashbang (Tier 3)* — Effects: *Attack (dazed), Weaken.* Form: *palm-sized canister. Draught of Iron Skin (Tier 2)* — Effects: *Enhance (armoured), Restore. Lasts one scene.*

A complete entry also states its action or trigger, targets, duration, removal conditions and any area or conflict exceptions.

A.2 Artifacts

- What they are: reusable items of real power — a flaming sword, a psychic amplifier, a starship's AI core.
- Tags: an artifact has 1–2 power tags (counting toward the +2 cap) and usually a special ability. Its item tag and conflict gear tag don't both count for the same benefit on one roll (Core Rules §10.10).
- Depletion: each artifact has a depletion rating, e.g. 1 in d12. After each use, roll d12; on that number or lower, it is depleted (broken, drained, or needs a downtime clock to restore).
- Attunement: powerful artifacts (marked ★) must be attuned and cost 1 Refresh while attuned (Core Rules §4.1). A PC can attune to a maximum of 2 artifacts.
- Artifact quirks: each artifact has a weakness tag that can be compelled for Tychē Points (*thirsts for blood*, *talks too much*, *draws the Hunters*).

Artifact abilities follow the same conflict limits as cyphers. Switching equipment doesn't refresh a once-per-conflict benefit or restore a depleted item, and Defend restores Disposition only.

Artifact format:

> ★ *Ember-Brand (longsword)* — Tags: *blade of living flame, +1 Attack (conflict gear).* Ability: *spend 1 Power to add* burning *to any status you inflict.* Depletion: *1 in d12 (goes cold until bathed in a forge).* Quirk: cannot be hidden.

Ember-Brand only adds *burning* to a status something else inflicts. Its Attack tag doesn't inflict a status, and Disposition loss doesn't become *burning*.

Module B — The Grind & Travel (Mouse Guard)

The Grind turns time, distance and hardship into slow, steady pressure. Play alternates between a GM's Turn (the mission) and a Players' Turn (downtime).

B.1 Session Structure

Phase	What happens
GM's Turn	The mission. The GM presents obstacles, and rolls advance the Grind (B.2).
Players' Turn	Downtime after the mission. Players spend Checks to take actions: recover, research, craft, pursue Goals.

B.2 The Grind Clock

- During the GM's Turn, the GM keeps a Grind clock visible to the table.
- Each action roll ticks it by 1; Resistance and recovery rolls don't. In a scripted conflict, count 1 tick per exchange, not per volley, actor or die.
- Size by hostility: 4 (harsh: desert, deep winter, the underworld), 6 (normal wilderness or dangerous city), 8 (gentle or well-supplied).
- When it fills: every PC gains the next Grind condition they don't have yet, then the clock resets. The GM may also spend 2 Woe to tick it.

The Grind uses its own rates, not the generic danger-clock rate, and failed conflict actions don't add ticks. It doesn't remove Disposition or cause injuries.

When it fills in a conflict, apply the condition at the end of the current exchange, or when the conflict ends if that comes first. Outside a conflict, apply it at once. The timing never cancels an action that resolves on its own (Core Rules §10.5).

B.3 Grind Conditions (taken in order)

Order	Condition	Effect	Cleared by
1	Hungry & Thirsty	First to Third rests restore nothing	A meal, a Survival roll (Restore)
2	Weary	Effort costs +1	A full night's rest
3	Exposed (cold, heat, wet)	−1 Sōma Edge	Shelter and a recovery roll
4	Shaken	−1 Pneuma Edge; Fear statuses +1 tier	A Will or Empathy recovery roll, or a Belief moment
5	Sick	−1 to all rolls; can't recover pools	Medicine roll (Hard) + rest
6	Broken	Taken Out of the mission; gain a Scar	Players' Turn only

Grind conditions count as statuses for Restore, but they don't stack and have no tier: the Order column is the sequence you gain them in. Broken already includes its Scar; don't add a tier-6 Scar too.

Separate layers. A condition that stops a PC contributing removes them from the conflict without costing Disposition; the side loses when nobody can pursue its objective (Core Rules §10.9). Clearing a condition doesn't refill pools, heal injuries, erase Scars or let a PC rejoin a conflict (Core Rules §6.4–6.6).

No Resistance. Grind conditions are hardship, not harm: they can't be Resisted, only cleared. Ordinary tiered harm still uses core Resistance.

B.4 Checks (Players' Turn)

- Earn Checks during the GM's Turn by applying one of your weakness tags or Scars to your own roll (−1). You earn 1 Check, or 2 if the penalty makes the roll fail.
- Everyone gets 1 free Check in the Players' Turn.
- Spend 1 Check for one Players' Turn action: a recovery roll against a Grind condition or status, a downtime clock roll, a research or crafting roll, restoring a burned tag, attuning an artifact, or a scene that pursues your Goal.
- Sharing: you can give a Check to another PC whose scene you take part in.

Weaknesses become a resource: hurt yourself now to recover later. A Check permits an activity; it doesn't guarantee success. Lasting injuries still follow Core Rules §6.6, and another Check doesn't clear the treated mark. Module D, if used, replaces B.4.

B.5 Travel

A journey is a Journey clock (6 for a short trip, 8 for a hard trip, 12 for an expedition). Each leg (a day or a stage), the party assigns roles; each role makes one roll:

Role	Skill	On success, spend Power on
Guide	Survival or Drive/Pilot	Make Time — Advance the Journey clock
Scout	Notice or Stealth	Spot Trouble — Discover, or cancel one encounter the GM has prepared
Quartermaster	Survival or Craft	Forage / Ration — clear Hungry for the party, or +1 Supplies
Lookout	Notice or Will	Keep Watch — the party isn't surprised; Restore Shaken

- Supplies: the party tracks Supplies as a counter, not a status (start at 3–6). Lose 1 per leg. At 0, everyone becomes Hungry & Thirsty automatically and the Grind clock shrinks by 2, to a minimum of 3.
- Terrain and weather are Truths that set Difficulty (*Muskeg*, *Whiteout*, *Rapids*, *Washed-out Road*).
- Encounters: the GM spends Woe (1 for a minor encounter, 3 for a major one), or uses the Scout's failed roll.
- Portages and hard stretches: a special leg (Endure or Athletics roll for every PC); failure ticks the Grind clock twice.

Journeys and conflicts. Advance buys 1 Journey segment per Power (Core Rules §7). Journey progress and Disposition don't

affect each other. A travel encounter uses the conflict test (Core Rules §10.1): one obstacle may need a single roll, while a sustained chase may be a conflict. Travel roles don't become conflict actions.

Spot Trouble cancels a prepared encounter, not a resolved action or an ongoing conflict. Moving from travel into a chase doesn't reset a conflict already under way (Core Rules §10.2).

Prices. Each role option costs 1 Power; Make Time advances the Journey clock 1 segment per Power. A failed hard stretch ticks the Grind clock twice in total, replacing the normal roll tick.

Module C — Truth-Driven Sandbox (2d20)

Truths become the backbone of an open-world campaign: regions, sites, and factions are defined by Truths that players can discover, exploit, and change.

C.1 Truth Layers

Layer	Example	Lifespan
Campaign	*The old empire's roads still hold its magic*	Changes only through major arcs
Region	*Lawless borderland*, *Endless rain*	Changes through faction clocks
Site	*Flooded lower levels*, *Ghosts guard the vault*	Changes when PCs act on them
Scene	*Pitch Dark*, *Hostile Crowd*	One scene

Record scope, rank and removal condition as usual (Core Rules §8). A Truth's layer sets its scale and how long it lasts, not its rank: rank 2 and the three-step cap still apply.

C.2 Site Sheets

Each location gets a short sheet:

- 3 Truths (at least one hidden; at most one at rank 2)
- A Woe seed: 1–3 Woe the GM adds when the party arrives
- A danger clock (what happens if the party lingers)
- A secret (something worth discovering)
- Rumours (see C.4)

Give the danger clock a real trigger or deadline. It doesn't tick on every failed conflict action (Core Rules §7, §10.7).

C.3 Truth Generator Tables (d12)

Roll once per column or pick.

d12	Terrain / Feature	Atmosphere	Hazard	Secret
1	Ruined fortification	Eerie silence	Unstable ground	Hidden passage
2	Dense forest	Constant rain	Disease	A traitor among allies
3	Flooded lowland	Oppressive heat	Predators	Buried treasure
4	Market town	Festival crowds	Watchful authorities	A forgotten god sleeps here
5	Mountain pass	Biting wind	Rockfall	Smuggling route
6	Abandoned facility	Flickering lights	Toxic air	Experiment gone wrong
7	River crossing	Thick fog	Rapids	Drowned village below
8	Sacred grove	Watched by unseen eyes	Spirit anger	A pact with the old powers
9	Remote camp	Desperation	Bandits	Someone is not who they claim
10	Underground ways	Echoes	Collapse	Lost civilisation
11	Noble estate	Hollow luxury	Political danger	Blackmail ledger
12	Wasteland	Unnatural stillness	Exposure	Gateway to elsewhere

C.4 Rumours

A rumour is an unconfirmed claim, not yet an established Truth. When players test it through Discover, investigation or arriving, the GM rolls d12 to determine what is actually true:

d12	Result
1–4	False — and someone benefits from spreading it
5–8	Twisted — partly true, with a dangerous difference
9–12	True — becomes a Truth

Use the table only for an unsettled rumour, never to overturn something already established. Record what's actually true, including how it differs from the claim. Discovering a hidden Truth reveals it; it doesn't create the fact you wanted.

C.5 Faction Turns

With Module E, use its World Turn (E.10) instead of this section, after the stay's endeavours if Module D is in use (D.7). The rest of Module C still applies.

Without Module E, between sessions (or each in-world week), the GM takes a World Turn:

1. Each active faction rolls 2d12 + its rating (+1 to +4) vs. Standard 15 for its current project.
2. Power ticks the faction's project clock (sized by the change it makes, below).

3. When a clock fills, the faction creates, removes, or changes the appropriate Site or Region Truth (e.g. *The Guild controls the river* replaces *The river is free*). Campaign Truths still require a major arc, not an ordinary completed clock.
4. PCs who hear about it can respond; PC actions can tick faction clocks forward or back using Advance.

A faction project changes a Site Truth with an 8-segment clock and a Region Truth with a 12-segment clock. A Campaign Truth changes only through a major arc (C.6).

C.6 Player Influence on Truths

- Discover effects and Momentum spends reveal hidden Truths.
- Create effects and 2 Momentum create Scene Truths; bigger changes need a progress clock (8 segments for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth).
- Major arcs can rewrite Campaign Truths. These are the "legacy" moments of the campaign.

Create costs 2 Power per rank (Core Rules §5). A 2-Momentum Truth starts at rank 1, and the same cost again raises it to rank 2 (Core Rules §8). A Scene Truth can't stand in for a Site or Region change.

In a conflict, Discover, Advance and other off-menu Effects need a permitted action or explicit exception (Core Rules §10.6). Winning achieves the conflict's stated intent, not every related project clock. A Truth can set up a scenery feature, but using it takes a scenery Maneuver (Core Rules §10.8). Preparation counts toward Superiority only under Core Rules §10.3.

C.7 Session Zero: Entanglements

Use this at the start of a campaign, after players have picked a Descriptor, Playbook and Focus but before Beliefs, Goals and tags are final. It takes about 60 to 90 minutes for four players. The result is a story map and your first Campaign Truths.

Elements. Each PC is a circle on the map. Everything else is placed on the map and joined to PCs by lines, each with a short description.

- Character (square): a named NPC, such as a mentor, a rival, a debtor or a friend.
- Organization (hexagon): a group that could become a faction (C.5, Module E).
- Prop (diamond): an object that matters to the story.
- Set (diamond): a place that matters.
- Situation (triangle): an event or pressure, past, present or looming.

Phases. Go around the table once per phase. Each player adds elements and draws lines from their PC. A player can't use the same shape twice in a row. Each phase also gives each PC something for their sheet:

Phase	Type	Each player adds	Output for the PC
0 Setup	Setup	The Focus link and one line to another PC.	The ally and rival prompts.
1 Origin	Major	Two elements.	A Belief drawn from one of them.
2 Rise	Standard	One element.	One power tag.
3 Branching Out	Meta	One element, plus one extra: connect two non-PC elements, replace one of your own lines, or give another PC a new element.	An Instinct or a named ally.
4 Turning Point	Major	Two elements.	A weakness tag and your first Goal.

Using the map.

- Triangles. Wherever two PCs have conflicting lines to the same element, mark it. Those are the first compels and the first scenes.
- Wedges. The GM picks one line to threaten in the first session.
- Late arrivals. A new PC runs the same phases against the existing map.

Campaign Truths. Finish by writing 3 to 5 Campaign Truths (Core Rules §8) from the map. Each Situation is a candidate, and each Organization that most PCs touch gives one. Mark Organizations that conflict with each other as faction candidates for C.8.

Lines into factions. A line between a PC and an Organization suggests a Module E record. Keep the faction's policy separate from personal ties:

- *Sworn member of*, *commissioned by*: a membership or office Truth (E.4), with its permissions, duties and limits. A line alone doesn't grant command.
- *Patron of*, *funded by*: a patronage record (E.4): what's supplied, what's expected and when it ends.
- *Owes*, *is owed by*: a favour (E.7) with agreed service, limits and terms, not an unlimited debt.
- *Feuds with*, *hunted by*: adverse starting Standing, if it reflects the faction's policy toward the party (E.3). *Fears* alone doesn't change Standing.
- *Betrayed*, *estranged from*: a personal exception for that PC (E.4). It replaces the normal relationship Truth instead of stacking with it.

Props and Sets tied to an Organization become faction assets (E.2) only if the faction actually owns, controls or can reach them. Interest alone isn't possession.

Relationships aren't free bonuses. Record relevant Truths normally. An ally or faction tie doesn't by itself grant Help, Backing, an extra turn, its own Disposition or Superiority; apply those rules when the resource actually contributes (Core Rules §10.2–10.3, §10.9; Module E.6).

C.8 Building Factions: Long Knives

If Module E is in use, use E.1A instead. Otherwise, build the starting factions for C.5 like this:

1. Place. Name the location. Record it as the first Region Truth (C.1).
2. Gather. List the groups the PCs' lines point to: Organizations from the map, plus fragments of them. Note what each wants in the area and who would oppose it.
3. Cluster. Pick about four factions that would find one another aggravating. Law or a local lord often belongs even if no PC touches them.
4. Sheet. For each faction write:

- Has: one obvious asset and one less obvious one. These set its rating: +1 minor, +2 solid, +3 major, +4 dominant.
- Wants: its current project, with a clock sized by the change it makes (8 for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth; C.6) and the result Truth it creates or changes when the clock fills.
- Link: how it connects to the PCs.
- Relations: allied or hostile toward each other faction. Where it matters, write the relation as a Truth (Core Rules §8).

5. Incident. One faction does something underhanded or aggressive that affects the others. Treat it as a project that has already filled: record its result Truth. The PCs may see it but can't prevent it.
6. Reaction. Give each other faction a response as a linked clock (Core Rules §7), opened by the incident.
7. Future. Write the result Truth each clock creates if the PCs do nothing. Make at least one visible to the players, and bad enough that they want to act.
8. Involvement. Note how each PC is pulled in. Appeals from factions should be biased and based on limited information.

The incident is history. It happened before play starts; it can't later cancel a PC's action, skip a conflict or complete a project. Once play begins, use C.5 or Module E. Campaign Truths still need a major arc.

Module D — Downtime (Torchbearer, Imperium Maledictum)

Downtime is the stretch between expeditions when the party is safe enough to recover, prepare, build and answer to the people around them. It has three equal jobs: recover and prepare (treat injuries, restore tags, restock), make and grow (craft, research, adapt to loss) and connect (tend allies, settle obligations, push on the wider world). Module D adds no new currency. It runs on Checks, Power, clocks and Woe, all of which already exist.

D.1 When It Applies

- Haven. Downtime begins when the party reaches a place with shelter, food and enough safety that nobody expects an attack tonight: a village, outpost, monastery, camp or home base. The GM decides.
- Field rests stay separate. Core Rules §6.5 rests and Module B's night's rest and Grind recovery work as written, and give no Checks or endeavours. Reaching a haven isn't a reset: pools, statuses and Scars follow their own recovery rules.
- A stay ends when the party leaves the haven or is forced out. Finished work stands; clocks keep their progress.
- Replaces Module B.4. If you use Module D, the Players' Turn follows these rules.

D.2 The Stay

Length and intervals. An interval is one full week. Healing intervals (Core Rules §6.6) run alongside it. *All numbers in this module are playtest values.*

Stay	Length	Free Checks per PC
Brief	Up to 3 days	1
Ordinary	About a week (1 interval)	2
Extended	Each further full week is another interval	+1 per extra interval

- Checks. Free Checks are added to any Checks earned on the expedition (B.4: applying a weakness tag or Scar to your own

roll). Spend 1 Check for one endeavour. Unspent Checks are lost when the stay ends. You may give a Check to another PC whose endeavour you join.

- Stay Woe. The GM does not use expedition Woe in downtime. The stay starts with 1 Woe per PC. Woe gained from downtime rolls joins this pool, which pays for the stay's event, complications and danger clocks, then is discarded (Core Rules §9.2).
- Momentum gained in downtime decays at the end of each scene and never leaves the stay (Core Rules §9.1). Tychē Points do not refresh unless the downtime begins a new session (Core Rules §4.1); invokes, declares and compels work as normal.
- Goals. At the end of the stay, each player writes one Goal for the next expedition (Core Rules §3.5).
- World Turn (Module E). If Module E is in use, a stay contains one World Turn (E.10). It uses no Checks and no Stay Woe.

D.3 Upkeep

Staying costs something. Instead of a currency, the stay carries an Upkeep clock of 6. Settings may change its size or replace it with their own currency.

Standard	Ticks / interval	What it provides
Meagre	0	Shelter and food. Truth: *Poor Rest* (+1 step to Recuperate)
Ordinary	1	Reliable lodging and meals
Comfortable	2	Privacy and workspace. Truth: *Well Appointed* (−1 step to Recuperate and Make)
Hosted	0	A host provides everything. Record an obligation (E.7): the service owed, its limits, notice, and what settles it.

- If the clock fills: the haven demands payment. The GM gains 2 Stay Woe, the party gains the Truth *In Debt to the Haven* (removed when the debt is settled with a Sustain endeavour or agreed payment), and the clock resets to 2.
- Routine provisioning (restock party Supplies to 4, ordinary repairs) needs no roll and ticks Upkeep by 1.
- Hospitality isn't free, but a host creates an obligation only when the terms are agreed. A vague "you owe me" is an open negotiation (E.7).

D.4 Endeavours

An endeavour is a stretch of focused effort during the stay.

- Routine. If failure would add nothing and the outcome is certain, no roll is needed. It generates no Power and no Momentum (Core Rules §6.6).
- Uncertain. If the result matters, roll the listed skill against Standard 15, adjusted by Truths. Spend Power on Effects (Core Rules §5). Unspent Power becomes Momentum, which decays.
- Success at a Cost: the GM adds a consequence, or the stay pool gains 1 Woe (player's choice, Core Rules §2.5). Failure: the effort doesn't take, the stay pool gains 1 Woe, and the GM announces any consequence before another attempt.
- Light or Strenuous. A character with a lasting injury who takes a Strenuous endeavour does not progress that injury's healing interval this interval (Core Rules §6.6).

Scenes that become conflicts. A consequential, actively opposed struggle may need a scripted conflict instead of one endeavour roll (Core Rules §10.1). Then use the conflict rules (Core Rules §10.5–10.7), not the Standard 15 and Effect menu above. Checks and Help grant no extra scripted turn, and a shared endeavour doesn't give each contributor their own Disposition.

Shared endeavours. A shared endeavour has one goal for the party or a subgroup. It costs 2 Checks, paid from the participants' pooled Checks.

- Choose a lead. Each participant describes their contribution.
- The lead rolls. Participants add Help as in Core Rules §2.4, within the +2 bonus-die cap.
- Spend Power as usual. The result benefits all participants.
- Participants need not pay equally. Non-participants pay nothing.

Endeavour	Tag	Skill	Typical Effects
Recuperate	Light	Medicine, Empathy, Craft	Restore; restore a burned tag; mark an injury *treated* (−1 tier)
Prepare	Strenuous	Survival, Persuade, Drive/Pilot	Create a Truth (*Provisioned*, *Passage Arranged*); Discover
Make and Mend	Strenuous	Craft, Tech	Advance a project clock; Create; restore a depleted artifact
Investigate	Light	Investigate, Lore, Notice	Discover; confirm a rumour (C.4)
Develop	Light	Varies	Advance a Scar or loss-adaptation clock (D.5)
Connect	Light	Persuade, Empathy, Intimidate	Create a contact Truth (D.6a); subtle cypher (A.1); Advance a faction clock only if the affected project is established (E.10)
Sustain	Strenuous	Craft, Persuade, Lore	Remove Upkeep segments

For an unlisted activity, the GM names a skill, a Light or Strenuous tag and the nearest Effects.

- Recuperate counts as appropriate care (Core Rules §6.6) but doesn't change treatment limits: at most 1 tier per lasting injury, then *treated* until a healing interval removes a tier. It restores one burned tag (Core Rules §3.4). It can't remove a Scar, refill pools or clear an affliction beyond what its source allows, and it doesn't return a Taken Out participant to a conflict (Core Rules §6.4).
- Prepare can supply Superiority (Core Rules §10.3) only against named opposition declared beforehand, only one category per stay, and only if the preparation is concrete. The

cap of 3 per conflict still applies, and one preparation can't be renamed into several categories.

D.5 Projects

A project is any goal too big for one endeavour. Use an 8- or 12-segment clock (Core Rules §7), ticked by Advance. Each roll toward it costs 1 Check.

Project	Size	Notes
Crafting a notable item, restoring a workshop	8	Needs access and materials
Restoring a depleted artifact (A.2)	8	Needs fitting tools
Adapting to permanent harm (Core Rules §6.8): prosthesis, retraining, workaround	8	Does not remove a Scar
Changing a Scar (Core Rules §6.3)	12	Completing the clock counts as the milestone
Changing a site (C.6)	8	A Site Truth
Changing a region (C.6)	12	A Region Truth

- Milestones. For long projects, the GM names 2–3 milestones along the clock, such as *secure the premises*, *obtain equipment*, *complete the work*.
- Minimum time. A project cannot finish faster than the fiction allows, whatever the Checks.
- Unfinished projects keep their progress until the next stay.
- Optional: Study Toward an Advance. Off by default. A 6-segment clock, ticked in Develop endeavours. When it fills, the character gains 1 XP. Use it only if your table wants training to feed advancement directly (Core Rules §12 has no training rule).

D.6 Between-Adventure Events

Roll d12 once at the start of an ordinary stay, before endeavours are declared, or choose a result that fits the fiction. In an Extended stay, roll again every second interval after the first. An event should offer a choice, not remove the stay.

d12	Family	What changed	Offer	If ignored
1–2	Quiet	Nothing disturbs the party	Plans proceed	—
3	Opportunity	A specialist passes through	One endeavour gets −1 step Difficulty (*Expert Help*)	They leave
4	Opportunity	A bargain on supplies	Routine provisioning ticks no Upkeep	The chance passes
5	Relationship	An ally is in trouble	A shared endeavour helps them; create a favour Truth	Their clock ticks
6	Relationship	A rival or old acquaintance arrives	Compel a tag or Belief; Connect or Intimidate to change the relationship	They act against the party
7	Obligation	A past promise comes due	1 Check discharges it if it is within the agreed terms (E.7). Refusing it follows E.7 (one Standing).	The creditor presses the claim
8	Obligation	Costs rise	+1 Upkeep tick; Sustain is −1 step this stay	Debt grows
9	Settlement	A service is short-handed	Truth *Short-Handed*: +1 step to Recuperate and Make	Services stay limited
10	Settlement	A dispute, festival or quarantine	Connect gets −1 step; arrival or departure may be restricted	The mood hardens
11–12	Consequence	A faction's plan shows	Reveal the result of that faction's latest declared project action (E.10). This is not an extra tick.	It is harder to answer next stay

D.6a Reputation in Downtime

Downtime does not create reputation by itself. Distinguish the following:

- Standing (E.3) changes only through consequential deeds a faction learns of and attributes to the party.
- A reputation tag records what a character is known for. It comes from character growth or setting rules, not from a Connect endeavour, and counts toward the tag cap unless an ability says otherwise.
- An ability may make a reputation a Campaign Truth, like the Bellator capstone *Legend of the Field* (Generic Playbooks §3.1).
- A contact Truth (D.4 Connect) names a relationship with a person and what it makes possible. It isn't a reputation tag and doesn't change Standing.

Momentum, Woe and scene-scale Create can't buy reputation (E.11). A relationship Truth (E.3) shifts Difficulty and a reputation tag adds to the roll; both can apply.

D.7 The Stay in Order

- Establish. The GM names the haven, its services and the stay length.
- Show deadlines. Reveal known changes, clocks and obligations.
- Set Upkeep. Choose a standard (D.3).
- Event. Roll or choose (D.6).
- Declare. Players declare individual and shared endeavours and spend Checks.
- Resolve. Play out only the consequential scenes. Healing intervals run alongside.
- World update. Take the World Turn here, after endeavours resolve, so the stay's results (Standing changes, evidence Truths, completed favours) are part of E.10 step 1. Without Module E, tick only clocks tied to established plans or deadlines. The GM may spend Stay Woe to tick danger clocks, but never to advance a faction project (E.10).
- Close. Discard leftover Checks and Stay Woe. Record unfinished projects, write a Goal, prepare to depart.

Example. The party spends an ordinary week (2 free Checks each) at a river outpost. Ysolde has a tier-3 injury; Brannock needs a new tool kit. The event is d12 = 9: the outpost is short-handed (*Short-Handed*). They choose Ordinary upkeep (1 tick). Ysolde spends 1 Check on Recuperate (Light): routine care, no roll, and the injury is marked *treated* (tier 3 to tier 2). She does nothing Strenuous, so her healing interval continues (Core Rules §6.6). Brannock and an uninjured companion pool 2 Checks for a shared Make and Mend push on an 8-segment kit project. Brannock rolls Craft, the companion Helps within the normal bonus-dice cap, and 3 Power Advances 3 segments. Ysolde does not join that Strenuous endeavour. At the close the project clock keeps its progress, and each player writes a Goal.

Module E — Factions, Standing & Obligations

Organizations have ambitions, resources, loyalties, and limits. This module connects their struggles to the party's adventures: factions provide opportunities and assistance; the party's actions determine what those factions can accomplish.

Use this module when alliances, patronage, collective action or political consequences matter. It is setting-neutral, and its numbers are playtest values.

When enabled, it replaces Module C.5′s faction actions, and E.1A replaces C.8; the rest of Module C still applies. Core rules apply to PC rolls, Effects, Truths, clocks and conflicts except where this module says otherwise.

E.1 Faction Records

A faction is an organized group pursuing a shared purpose: a household, village council, guild, temple, company of soldiers, criminal network, or administration.

Record:

- Name, purpose, and long-term ambition.
- Operational reach: the places and communities where it can act.
- Five Qualities, each rated 0 to +4.
- Two or three assets and one vulnerability.
- Standing toward the party, from −3 to +3.
- A representative who can explain or authorize requests.
- One current project and its clock.
- An important ally and rival, where relevant.
- Outstanding favours, obligations, offices, and personal exceptions.

Prepare full records only for active factions. A name, purpose, and Standing suffice for a background group. Begin with three active factions; normally track no more than five at once.

The party may found or lead a faction. Give it ratings justified by its actual people and resources; do not purchase a second char-

acter sheet with personal pool points. Leadership grants only the authority its governing structure recognizes.

E.1A Building the Starting Cluster (Long Knives)

Use this when starting a campaign, after the C.7 story map is drawn. It produces the first faction records (E.1), their starting Standing and the opening situation, and takes about 30 to 45 minutes. It replaces C.8 when Module E is enabled.

Size. Aim for four factions: three active (full records) and one background (name, purpose and Standing).

1. Place. Name the location. Record it as the first Region Truth (C.1).
2. Gather. List the groups the PCs' lines point to: Organizations from the map, plus fragments of them. Note what each wants in the area and who would oppose it.
3. Cluster. Pick four groups that would find one another aggravating. Law, a local lord or an imperial office often belong even if no PC touches them.
4. Record. Fill in each active faction's record (E.1) using the table.

Long Knives field	Becomes	How
Has	Qualities, assets, vulnerability (E.1, E.2)	The *obvious* asset sets the faction's highest Quality (+3, or +4 for a dominant power). The *less obvious* asset sets a second Quality (+2). Other Qualities are 0 or +1. Explain every nonzero Quality through concrete assets. The vulnerability is something opponents can target; it need not match a low Quality.
Wants	Ambition, project, primary Quality, clock (E.1, E.10)	Write the long-term ambition, then one current project with its intended outcome and its primary Quality. Choose the clock by the change it makes: 4 or 6 for a limited or local action, 8 for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth (E.10, C.6).
Link	Standing and representative (E.3, E.4)	Set starting Standing (below). Name a representative. Record membership, patronage and favour lines from the C.7 map (E.4, E.7).
Relations	Ally and rival (E.1)	Name one important ally and one rival for each active faction where relevant.

Starting Standing. Use the C.7 map to establish the faction's actual policy toward the party, not an automatic score from one PC's title or debt:

- A sworn membership or patronage line may support +1 or +2 when it reflects welcoming or trusted treatment. If only one PC has the relationship, record a personal exception instead (E.4).
- A rivalry or pursuit may support −1 or −2 when the faction's treatment is distrustful or hostile. A debt or fear alone isn't hostility; record it separately (E.3, E.7).
- No established relationship: 0.
- Reserve ±3 for relationships that actually meet Enemy or Allied treatment. Where Standing isn't 0 and the relationship matters, record the relationship Truth (E.3).

A personal exception replaces that relationship Truth for its subject and doesn't extend to companions. A friendly representative can't commit resources the faction can't or won't supply (E.4–E.6).

Qualities and Cohesion. A local faction normally has about 5 to 8 points across its Qualities, and a regional power about 9 to 12 (the Reed Quay Association in E.13 totals 9). A Quality of 0 means the faction can't independently mount a major action in that field (E.2). Don't start a faction with permanent Cohesion 0 unless you want it to begin in a Fracture crisis (E.12).

5. Incident. One active faction takes an underhanded or aggressive action that affects the others. Treat it as a completed project: its clock is full and can't be unticked (E.10). Record the result as scoped Truths with rank and removal condition (E.8, E.10). If it was an exceptional commitment, mark Strain on its primary Quality (E.9). The PCs may see the incident but can't prevent it.
6. Reaction. Each active faction declares its first-turn action: project action, primary Quality, intended outcome and any exceptional commitment (E.10). A faction with a credible method may obstruct another faction's *uncompleted* project instead (E.10). The incident's result can only be reversed by a new undertaking.
7. Future. For every active project, write its intended outcome and the scoped Truth it creates if the PCs do nothing (E.8). Use the pacing table to say roughly when. Make at least one visible to the players, and bad enough that they will want to act.
8. Involvement. For each PC with a line into the cluster, write one hook as an undertaking with a foreseeable strategic effect (E.8): which project it advances or obstructs through the Advance effect, and the likely change in Standing (E.3). Leave discoverable signs of secret projects (E.10). A played scene replaces the equivalent off-screen work, not the faction's other activity (E.10).
9. First turn. Take the first World Turn only after play begins. Don't ask for a faction roll to confirm what the party already accomplished (E.8). Off-screen actions use no Momentum, pools, Tychē or Woe (E.10).

The incident is history. It happened before play starts; it can't later cancel a PC's action, skip a contested scene or complete

another project. Once play begins, use the core rules for PC struggles and E.10 for faction actions. Campaign Truths still need a major arc.

Pacing (playtest). Average Power per World Turn for 2d12 + one Quality against Standard 15, counting Success at a Cost (1 Power) but not doubles or opposition. Turns to fill are expected values with overflow discarded; they are estimates, not deadlines.

Quality	Average Power per turn	Turns to fill 8	Turns to fill 12
0	0.89	about 9	about 14
+1	1.06	about 8	about 12
+2	1.25	about 7	about 10
+3	1.46	about 6	about 9
+4	1.69	about 5	about 8

E.2 Organizational Qualities

Quality	Measures
Might	Organized force, military readiness, and coercive capacity.
Treasure	Accessible wealth, credit, and financial organization.
Influence	Information networks and ability to shape outside decisions.
Territory	Productive infrastructure, population, holdings, transport, and logistical reach.
Cohesion	Internal loyalty, legitimacy, discipline, and shared identity.

Rating	Capability
0	No independent organized capability in this field.
+1	Limited.
+2	Established.
+3	Strong.
+4	Exceptional.

Qualities measure capability, not fixed population or geographical size. A small veteran force can have strong Might. A mobile caravan can have Territory through its vehicles, workforce, and supply arrangements.

Explain every nonzero rating through concrete assets. Influence +3 might mean couriers, shipping agents, and sympathetic officials. It does not mean the faction knows every secret.

A Quality of 0 does not prohibit its members from acting as individuals. It means the organization cannot independently mount a major action in that field without establishing the missing capability or securing outside support.

A permanent Cohesion of 0 is a *crisis* when a faction has fallen to it (E.12). A faction built at Cohesion 0 begins with its Fracture clock created and no automatic tick that turn.

Assets and reach

Assets determine what the faction can actually do. A treasury cannot occupy a town without personnel; soldiers cannot cross a sea without transport. A rating never creates an unstated army, fleet, office, or network.

When an asset matters mechanically, record it as a Truth with scope, rank and removal condition. It adds its concrete advantage, not a second bonus restating the Quality.

Record a distant branch separately when local capabilities matter. The imperial institution's full resources are not automatically available to every provincial official.

Changing Qualities

Change a permanent rating only after a lasting change to the capacity it represents. Losing one shipment normally changes an asset, creates Strain, or sets back a project. Losing the principal treasury and credit network may reduce Treasure.

An improvement normally requires an appropriate 8- or 12-segment project, a concrete new resource, and an outcome large enough to justify the next rating. Repetitive minor jobs cannot manufacture permanent growth. No Quality exceeds +4.

E.3 Standing

Standing measures the faction's normal policy toward the party, not the feelings of every member.

Score	Relationship	Normal treatment
−3	Enemy	Actively seeks the party's capture, expulsion, destruction, or lasting defeat.
−2	Hostile	Obstructs the party and supports credible action against its interests.
−1	Distrustful	Demands safeguards, compensation, or supervision.
0	Uncommitted	Judges requests on their immediate merits.
+1	Welcoming	Offers ordinary hospitality, introductions, and opportunities.
+2	Trusted	Shares sensitive information and considers meaningful assistance.
+3	Allied	Treats the party's welfare as an organizational interest within agreed limits.

Standing is not membership, command, fear, or internal unity. A faction may be cohesive and hate the party, or welcome the party while suffering mutiny. A feared enemy can comply with a threat without becoming friendly.

Relationship Truths

When identity is known and the relationship materially affects cooperation, access, or credibility, use one relationship Truth:

Standing	Truth	Rank
−3 / −2	Enemies of the Faction / Hostile Reception	2 adverse
−1	Distrusted by the Faction	1 adverse
0	None	—
+1	Welcome Among the Faction	1 helpful
+2 / +3	Trusted by the Faction / Bound by Alliance	2 helpful

Each relevant rank shifts Difficulty one step (3 points), following Core Rules §8. Helpful and adverse Truths cancel normally; the

net shift remains capped at three steps. Relationship Truths do not automatically modify combat, technical work, stealth, or deception.

Scope: recognized dealings with this faction where the relationship affects the request. Removal: replace the Truth when Standing changes or the relevant relationship ends. A personal exception replaces this Truth for its subject; it never stacks with it.

Trust does not compel obedience. Even an ally may refuse something beyond its means, authority, commitments, or capacity to survive. Ordinary assistance already willingly available needs no roll.

Changing Standing

Change Standing for consequential deeds the faction learns about and attributes to the party:

- +1: complete important work, protect a valued asset, uphold a difficult agreement, or make a meaningful sacrifice.
- +2: avert an organizational catastrophe or deliver a transformative victory.
- −1: cause significant avoidable loss, break a meaningful agreement, or seriously undermine the faction.
- −2: betray it, destroy an irreplaceable asset, or deliberately deliver it into an enemy's hands.

Apply changes once per undertaking, normally at its conclusion or when the consequences become known. Usually apply a net change of at most one step per faction per adventure; reserve two steps for decisive events. Clamp Standing between −3 and +3.

Paid work may demonstrate reliability. Honest failure is not betrayal. Declining an ordinary job is not an automatic penalty. Trivial gifts and repeated errands do not improve Standing indefinitely.

Secret deeds create no immediate public change. Record pending exposure when necessary. False accusations may change treatment; record the accusation as a Truth so disproving it offers a route to repair.

Helping one faction does not automatically offend every rival. Change another faction's Standing only when its interests were meaningfully affected and it knows whom to credit or blame.

E.4 Personal Exceptions and Authority

Use party Standing by default. Record an individual exception only when a particular relationship matters: an estranged child of the leader, a sworn member, an acknowledged oathbreaker, or someone who saved a representative's life.

Give the character an effective Standing for that relationship when needed. Party +1 and a character's temple exception −2 means the temple normally welcomes the group but treats that character as hostile in relevant dealings.

An exception applies to its subject, not automatically to everyone standing beside them. A trusted member can arrange an audience for companions without making them trusted members. Personal deeds change the exception unless the faction reasonably holds the whole party responsible.

Membership and office

Record membership, commissions, and offices as scoped Truths, not another numerical Influence track. Examples include Sworn Member, Commissioned Envoy, Licensed Supplier, and Captain of the Northern Watch.

State the permissions, jurisdiction, duration, duties, and removal conditions. Authority requires appointment, election, sponsorship, initiation, or another established process. Standing may open that opportunity; it does not replace it.

A legitimate seal may make access possible. It does not substitute Standing or a faction Quality for Persuade or another PC Skill.

Patronage

Record what a patron supplies, the service expected, what lies outside the arrangement, and what ends it. Routine agreed service is not a new favour each time. Refusal matters according to the actual agreement, not an unlimited claim on the character.

E.5 Seeking Aid

1. State the assistance, timing, location, authorizing representative, burden, and offered compensation.
2. Check capability, reach, available assets, and the representative's authority.
3. Grant willing, available, inconsequential assistance without a roll.
4. Use a single core check for limited uncertainty; use an Argument or Negotiation conflict when the core conflict criteria are met.
5. If the request is impossible now, explain what would have to change.

For a single request check, establish burden before applying relationship and other Truths:

Base Difficulty	Burden
Easy 12	Minor inconvenience or readily available assistance.
Standard 15	Meaningful expense, limited exposure, or diverted personnel.
Hard 18	Serious expense, danger, secrecy, or political embarrassment.
Formidable 21	A major commitment threatening an important interest.
Heroic 24	An extraordinary but still possible commitment.

PCs roll normal Skills. Pools pay for Effort and Resistance; do not add a pool as an attribute. Persuade, Deceive, and Intimidate reflect different methods and consequences. Evidence, compensation, leverage, and timing can change the request's feasibility or relevant Truths.

For that single request check, use normal core outcomes, Power, doubles, and currencies. A Success at a Cost grants the agreed help with the normal consequence-or-Woe choice. Failure does not secure the help and produces an appropriate move. A failed

request cannot be repeated unchanged: introduce materially new terms or circumstances.

Extra Power can improve agreed scope, speed, or discretion where normal Effects and the fiction support it. It cannot buy permanent Standing or unlimited resources.

When the request is a conflict, set intent and stakes and use the conflict rules. The burden ladder is for single checks only: volleys use Standard 15 or versus totals as normal, and failures follow Core Rules §10.7. Victory grants the agreed intent, subject to compromise, not command of the faction (Core Rules §10.12–10.13).

E.6 Faction Support in Party Scenes

A Quality establishes what support the faction can organize; Standing, authority, and obligations govern whether it is provided. No faction Quality is added directly to a PC roll.

Support has one concrete application:

- Permission: equipment, credentials, transport, or access makes the action possible, or removes the need for a particular roll.
- A scoped Truth: actual conditions change Difficulty under Core Rules §8.
- Active Help: a participating ally uses the core Help procedure, pays its normal cost from its own pools and shares the risk. An ordinary NPC has no pools, so it can't Help unless a rule says otherwise (Core Rules §6.1). Qualities aren't pools.

Do not award all three for the same contribution. Stronger Qualities increase feasible reach, reliability, and scale, not an automatic numerical bonus. Might +4 can organize support beyond Might +1; it does not grant +4 Fight.

Accompanying allies. A companion is either a participant (joins rotation, uses its own ratings, bound by the stakes) or an asset (gives its stated benefit, takes no turn), never both. It doesn't get its own Disposition, and removing it costs none, though a side loses when nobody can pursue its objective (Core Rules §10.9).

Backing gives +1 Disposition per eligible backer and costs no pool points (Core Rules §10.2). A faction's size or personnel doesn't by itself supply backers.

An escort may make a friendly checkpoint automatic. It cannot make every later negotiation easier simply because it exists. Personnel face the real risks of deployment, and a borrowed resource is not freely duplicable or permanently transferred.

E.7 Favours and Obligations

A favour is a specific acknowledged promise. An obligation is the same record from the debtor's side. Record debtor, creditor, service, limits, notice, deadline or duration, and what settles it. Record who can call it in and whether it benefits the party or a named individual.

Agree to scope when the promise is made. "You owe us something" is an unresolved negotiation, not a blank cheque. Favours can be payment for work, part of an alliance, or compensation for aid.

Calling in a feasible, acknowledged favour within its terms requires no request check. Roll only for a separate uncertainty: evading inspection, locating a vessel, or reaching a destination. Broader or newly dangerous work may require renegotiation; establish whether the changed circumstances fall within the original agreement before rolling.

Possible settlements include fulfilment, an accepted substitute, partial settlement, or an agreed delay. Genuine inability is not automatically betrayal, though concealment or indifference may damage trust.

Knowingly refusing a feasible agreed obligation normally costs one Standing; severe betrayal may cost two. Owing a favour does not remove a player's control over their character. State the consequences and let them choose.

Calling in an earned favour does not reduce Standing. Repaying one does not automatically improve it. Falling Standing does not erase outstanding promises. A favour transfers only with the debtor's consent.

A favour grants its stated service, not automatic success, free Help, an extra scripted turn or control over another participant. A promise given as part of a concession or another benefit's payment is a protected payment (Core Rules §10.7); renegotiating it needs agreement.

E.8 Adventures and Strategic Advantages

Before an undertaking, explain its likely strategic effect when the characters can reasonably foresee it. "Secure the bridge and our forces can cross this turn with a rank-1 advantage" gives the players a meaningful choice.

Successful adventures may:

- Accomplish an objective outright.
- Advance or obstruct a project through the Advance effect.
- Establish a scoped Truth for a later faction action.

Examples: Enemy Deployment Exposed; Crossing Secured; Troops Paid Before the Muster; Reformers Have Public Support; Southern Squadron Will Not Intervene.

Record scope, rank, duration, and removal condition. Rank 1 is normal; rank 2 requires a decisive advantage. One-use preparation applies to the next relevant action and then expires; persistent advantages endure only as long as their established circumstances do. Apply the core Truth cap.

A roll does not automatically create a lasting Truth merely because it succeeds: use the appropriate core Effect or establish it as the agreed outcome of the completed undertaking. Larger lasting changes need the appropriate project or milestone, as in Module C.6.

Do not require a faction roll to confirm what the party already accomplished. Capturing a bridge does not lead to another roll to see whether it was captured. A separate roll may determine whether the army exploits that opportunity.

Distinct consequences can follow one achievement, but never award duplicate progress or duplicate modifiers for the same

work. One bad PC roll does not automatically damage a whole faction; consequences must reach its people or resources.

One contribution. If a PC endeavour does the work a faction's project action would do (the party sabotages the project itself), that endeavour replaces the faction's own roll for that project this turn. Never count both for the same work.

A played conflict still uses its permitted actions: Advance or Discover needs an appropriate action or explicit exception. Attack or Feint Disposition loss isn't project progress, and victory grants the stated objective, not unrelated clocks (Core Rules §10.6, §10.12).

E.9 Commitments and Strain

A faction normally takes one major project action per World Turn without automatic Strain. Exceptional deployment can exhaust a capability.

Mark one relevant Quality as Strained when the faction takes an additional major action, makes an exceptional deployment to support the party, overextends to meet a deadline, or suffers an explicit exhaustion consequence. Ordinary hospitality, meals, and introductions do not qualify.

A Strained Quality operates one rating lower, minimum 0. Strain doesn't stack and isn't also an adverse Truth for the same exhaustion. A faction can take at most one additional major action per turn. It must Strain that action's primary Quality, which can't already be Strained, so additional actions can't repeat indefinitely.

Timing. Mark Strain when the action is *declared* (E.10, step 2), so that action and every other action that phase use the lowered rating.

Clear Strain after one full World Turn in which the affected capability is not used for a major action or exceptional commitment, provided recovery remains plausible. Ordinary background activity does not prevent recovery. Strain alone reducing effective Cohesion to 0 does not trigger Fracture; use permanent Cohesion for E.12.

Exhaustion is not destruction. Rest can recover tired guards; it cannot rebuild a burned warehouse. Track persistent losses separately.

E.10 World Turns

Choose one cadence: each in-world week, between adventures, or another agreed meaningful interval. Do not take extra turns simply because a session ended. This procedure replaces Module C.5 while Module E is enabled.

With Module D. The cadence is between adventures: one World Turn per stay. Strain (E.9), Fracture clocks (E.12) and project clocks count in World Turns. A long stay doesn't recover Strain faster, and a short one doesn't skip it.

1. Resolve known consequences of recent play; update Standing, obligations, assets, and exceptions.
2. Declare each active faction's project action, primary Quality, intended outcome, and any exceptional commitment.
3. Resolve actions and opposition. Use ratings at the start of the action phase; apply resulting permanent changes after all declared actions resolve. This prevents turn order from erasing a declared action without warning.
4. Resolve completed clocks, crises, and eligible Strain recovery.
5. Reveal observable developments through news, witnesses, altered conditions, or encounters. Secret projects need not reveal their details, but consequential changes should leave discoverable signs.

Organizational resolution

Roll 2d12 + the relevant effective Quality against Standard 15, adjusted by task difficulty and relevant Truths. Use one primary Quality, not the sum of two. Other capabilities may be prerequisites or provide distinct concrete circumstances; their ratings are not automatic extra modifiers.

- Success: 1 Power, plus 1 per full 3 points over the target.
- Success at a Cost (miss by 1–3): 1 Power and a concrete setback appropriate to the action.
- Failure (miss by 4+): no progress; introduce a relevant setback.
- Doubles follow the core's success/cost/failure twist rules, including double 12s and double 1s.

Organizational exception: off-screen faction actions do not gain or spend the party's Momentum, PC pools, or Tychē Points, and do not generate or spend Woe. Uncommitted Power is discarded. Resolve twists narratively; there is no off-screen Woe buy-off. PC scenes retain all normal core currencies.

Project clocks

Segments	Typical scope
4	Limited local action with few obstacles.
6	Substantial operation or contested local objective.
8	Complex undertaking or lasting institutional change.
12	Major regional transformation.

Commit Power at one segment per Power. A single faction action advances one declared project or produces one limited immediate result; it cannot purchase unrelated outcomes. Cap progress at the remaining segments; discard overflow. Link clocks for wider ambitions.

Use Module C.6 for lasting Site, Region, and Campaign changes: normally 8 segments for a Site Truth, 12 for a Region Truth, and a major arc for a Campaign Truth. A short operational clock does not bypass those requirements.

Opposition and disruption

A faction may spend its action obstructing a known project if it has a credible method. Roll its relevant Quality against Standard 15, adjusted by the target's concrete defences and other Truths. The target's Quality rating is not automatically a Difficulty shift.

On success, spend Power to remove uncompleted progress, one segment per Power. Remove no more than is present and discard excess. A defending faction may devote its own action to coun-

termeasures, producing appropriate protection or removing the obstructing capability. Do not add a free reaction roll for every attempted disruption.

Declare obstruction or countermeasures in step 2 as the faction's one major action. A faction that defends does not also advance its own project.

Apply all same-turn progress and disruption to a clock together before checking completion. A clock that completes cannot later be "unticked": reversing its established result needs a new undertaking.

If two clocks with contradictory result Truths complete in the same turn, neither result is established as written: the GM and players agree on a compromise Truth, and both factions are Strained.

PCs can use Advance to remove progress when sabotage or delay directly supports that effect. Establish the affected project before the roll. A played scene replaces the equivalent off-screen work, not the whole faction's unrelated activity.

Completion

A project grants its declared result, not every benefit the victor might want. Create, remove, or change a Truth when appropriate; record scope, rank, and removal condition. Completion does not automatically make a Truth rank 2 or increase a Quality.

E.11 Conflict, Objectives, and Pressure

Use core Argument, Negotiation, or Battle conflicts when the action deserves a played conflict. Use normal core Disposition, scripting, Power, concessions, and compromise.

Each side has one shared Disposition total, not a track for every faction member. Defeat doesn't by itself cause injury, permanent organizational loss or every objective the winner wants. Use Core Rules §10.12 for mutual defeat and Core Rules §10.13 for compromise. E.10's compromise Truth for contradictory project clocks is a separate procedure.

Standing grants no automatic Superiority. Insider intelligence, an arranged audience, or a secured guarantee can qualify as actual preparation under the core's categories and cap. Evaluate distinct advantages, not labels. Combat receives no direct Standing modifier.

State strategic objectives separately:

- Raid: take or destroy specified resources.
- Occupy: hold a particular place.
- Break resistance: disable a specified fighting force.
- Humiliate: undermine prestige before a relevant audience.
- Annex: establish lasting control over a holding.
- Reconcile: restore cooperation between internal groups.

Winning a battle does not automatically create stable government. Occupation may open a separate integration project and establish Population Rejects the Occupation. One conflict does not grant unrelated spoils or objectives beyond its stakes and compromise.

Woe in faction scenes

Use Woe normally during PC scenes to introduce supported complications, reinforcements, or danger-clock progress. Hostility is a motive, not an unlimited Woe source. A completed World Turn project establishes its result without an extra Woe payment; a new scene complication uses the normal rules. Never charge twice for the same event.

Inside scripted conflicts, failure and Success at a Cost follow Core Rules §10.7: no unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss, or ordinary-failure Woe for losing a versus test. Specials, hazards, Risky rolls and other explicit consequences keep their stated effects and timing. Woe can't change a revealed script or cancel actions that resolve on their own.

Woe cannot directly buy a Standing reduction. It can expose evidence or create circumstances that cause one. Momentum and scene-scale Create effects likewise cannot buy permanent reputation.

E.12 Damage, Crisis, and Reorganization

Target the capability actually harmed. Destroying payroll may damage Treasure; exposing agents may damage Influence; losing an estate may damage Territory; defeat may damage Might; betrayal may provoke a Cohesion crisis.

Use an asset loss, setback, adverse Truth or Strain for limited harm. Permanent rating loss needs a lasting reduction in capacity, set by the stakes or a completed undertaking, not a lost roll. Ordinary Disposition loss doesn't reduce a Quality, mark Strain, remove an asset or tick Fracture.

Fracture

When permanent Cohesion reaches 0, establish an internal crisis and start a 4-segment Fracture clock. Advance it once at the end of each subsequent World Turn that ends with permanent Cohesion still 0. A newly created clock does not receive this automatic tick in its creation turn. Explicit consequences may advance it further.

Restoring permanent Cohesion stops automatic progress but does not erase existing fractures. Reconciliation or another concrete undertaking removes progress. When the clock fills, the faction splits, disbands, loses central authority, or transforms according to the established situation. Its people and assets do not simply vanish.

Branches, alliances, and mergers

Separate a local branch when its resources or loyalties differ materially. Do not use a resource twice as if parent and branch had independent copies. An alliance provides agreed access and obligations, not summed ratings.

A merger is a reorganization project. Reassess Qualities from the actual combined capacity once integration occurs; do not automatically add ratings or increase matched scores. Hostile absorption may bring assets while reducing Cohesion or creating adverse Truths. Defeating a smaller organization can grant a useful asset without increasing a rating.

E.13 Example: Reed Quay Association

An illustrative faction, not setting canon.

Field	Record
Purpose	Protect river trade and control profitable landing places.
Reach	Lower river settlements and commercial offices in the provincial capital.
Might +1	Dock guards and armed crews.
Treasure +3	Freight income and commercial credit.
Influence +2	Agents, weighmasters, and clerks.
Territory +2	Barges, warehouses, and landing rights.
Cohesion +1	Members cooperate primarily for profit.
Standing +2	Trusted; Nera, master of the eastern landing, represents the association.
Vulnerability	Its principal charter is legally disputed.
Project	Secure Exclusive Ferry Rights, 8 segments: a lasting local institutional change.
Favour	Conceal up to six people aboard one outbound barge this season, with a day's notice; no declared contraband.

The party requests public freight records. Nera willingly supplies them; no roll is needed. Access to sealed judicial records is a different request, possibly requiring an introduction or commission.

The association funds a lawful journey and provides a commercial introduction. Passage permits the journey; the introduction grants an audience. Neither grants +3 Persuade because Treasure is +3.

The party retrieves admissible evidence that a rival obtained a charter through bribery. As the agreed outcome of the undertaking, Rival Charter Under Legal Challenge becomes a rank-1 Truth for the ferry-rights project until the challenge is adjudicated. If the party obtains a final judgment itself, do not roll again to establish that judgment.

On the World Turn, the association uses Influence +2. The evidence lowers the Standard 15 target to Easy 12. Dice of 7 and 9 total 16; +2 gives 18, producing 3 Power. It commits three segments. Without the evidence, the same total against 15 would produce 2 Power.

Later, the party saves the winter grain convoy at substantial personal risk. Once the association learns what happened, Standing may rise to +3. A new favour is not automatic: the association must explicitly promise one.

If the association undertakes an additional urgent funding action that turn, Treasure becomes Strained before that action and operates at +2. It cannot take a third major action. Recovery needs a later full turn without a major Treasure commitment and with plausible access to its credit network.

E.14 Table Reference

Question	Rule
What can it do?	Qualities, assets, and operational reach.
Will it help us?	Standing, authority, commitments, and reasonable requests.
What do PCs roll?	Their normal Skill; never add a faction Quality.
What does support do?	Permission, a scoped Truth, or actual Help; no duplicate benefit.
What does the faction roll?	2d12 + one effective Quality, normally vs. Standard 15.
How does it progress?	1 Power per project segment; no off-screen Momentum or Woe.
How do adventures matter?	Achieve an objective, affect progress, or establish a strategic advantage.
How often does it act?	One major action each World Turn; at most one additional action causing Strain.
What is owed?	A written favour or obligation with scope, limits, and settlement.
What causes collapse?	Permanent Cohesion 0 opens a Fracture crisis, not instant disappearance.

For a faction record, copy E.1 and leave space for five ratings, five Strain marks, Standing, personal exceptions, one project clock, and outstanding promises. Keep rating explanations concrete and show the players changes their characters can observe.

Module F: Inquiry & Revelation

Use this module when a mystery is the point of the game: a murder, a vanished caravan, a forbidden text, a buried ruin. It separates finding from understanding. Finding the clue is never the challenge. Reading it correctly is.

The module changes nothing outside Inquiry scenes. Conflicts, travel, Resistance, Momentum and Woe all work as written.

F.1 The Core Rule

> *If a scene holds a core clue, and a character has a fitting skill rated +1 or higher, that character finds it. No roll. No cost. No failure.*

- Core clue. A fact the group needs to reach the next scene or to understand the Truth of the case. Every Inquiry scene has at least one.
- Fitting skill. Any skill from the setting's skill list that the GM can reasonably tie to the clue. Several skills can reach the same clue by different routes.
- Description. The player says what the character does and which skill it uses, or the GM offers the clue unprompted to a character who clearly has it.
- Stuck groups. If nobody has a fitting skill, the clue floats (F.6) to another source. A core clue is never locked behind a missing skill.

A found clue grants no Power, extra scripted turn or script change, and doesn't count as success at a conflict action. Never require a Probe or Buy to get the guaranteed core clue.

F.2 Insight: The Extra Layer

A core clue gets you to the next scene. Insight is everything beyond that: motive, timing, who else was involved, what the culprit will do next, a shortcut, an ally. Insight is optional, and you can gain it in two ways.

Method	How it works
Probe	Roll 2d12 + the skill vs. a Difficulty set by the GM (usually Standard 15). Each Power you spend on Discover (Core Rules §5) is one Insight. The usual outcomes apply: a miss by 1–3 is a Success at a Cost, and a miss by 4+ is a Failure that gives the GM 1 Woe. A failed Probe never removes a core clue.
Buy	Spend 4 − Edge points (minimum 1) from the skill's pool, with no roll. You gain exactly one Insight. The pool is the one that pays for that skill in Effort and Resistance (Core Rules §3.3).

Probe is cheap but risky. Buy is safe but drains the pool you also need for Resistance and Effort. Players should have to choose between them.

Payment. Apply discounts and the minimum, then pay the Buy in full. It's a voluntary purchase, not Resistance, so you can't overrun an insufficient pool (Core Rules §6.1); spending the last points still runs the pool dry.

WHICH POOL PAYS?

Sōma: long vigils, exhumations, hard physical labour. Mētis: meticulous search, tailing, lock and mechanism work. Psychē: deduction, records, anatomy, languages. Pneuma: reading people, rites, dread places, the uncanny. The GM may allow a different pool when the fiction supports it (Core Rules §3.3).

F.3 What an Insight Can Be

When you gain an Insight, choose one. The GM may veto a choice that does not fit the scene.

- Detail. A true fact that deepens a clue you already have. It can help you solve the case, but it is never required to reach the next scene.
- Leverage. Create a Truth that fits what you learned (*the guard captain is afraid of the cellar*). It lasts for the scene, or until the case ends if you pay 1 more: 1 Power from a Probe, or 1 more pool point for a Buy.
- Contact. Name an ally, informant or source, and say how you know them. The GM adds a short tag.
- Spotlight. Show real expertise in front of others. You gain a free invoke of one tag or Truth about your standing, once per scene. Use this to shine, not to win a fight.
- Foresight. The GM tells you one thing the opposition is about to do.

If no Insight fits, nothing happens and no points are lost. Buy costs are refunded.

Benefit scope. A Leverage Truth uses the normal rank, scope and removal condition (Core Rules §8); its case-long extension is an Inquiry exception, not a change to Create.

A Contact provides the stated relationship, not Standing, a reputation tag, free Help or a turn. A Spotlight invoke awards no Standing or reputation. Foresight is information, not a script change or a way to cancel the opposition's action (Core Rules §10.5).

F.4 Boosted Skills and Recovery

- Boosted skill. At creation, mark one skill you hold at +1 or higher. When you Buy an Insight with it, regain 1 point to the paying pool. Mark another skill each time you have taken 4 Advances.
- Recovery. Pools recover as usual (Core Rules §6). The GM may also offer a refresh opportunity: a night in an archive, a round of drinks in the right tavern, a meal with a scholar. Each restores 2 points to the pool that fits.
- Help. One ally may Help a Probe as normal (Core Rules §2.4), or help a Buy by lowering its cost by 1 (minimum 1).
- Tags. A power tag that applies to the skill adds +1 to a Probe, as usual. Burning one gives +1 Power.

Pay before boosted-skill recovery: the regained point isn't a discount, and it doesn't clear a running-dry status the payment caused. A refresh opportunity is offered by the GM, not an automatic refill at the start or end of an Inquiry scene.

Probe Help and tags keep their normal caps (+2 power tags, +2 bonus dice). The Buy discount isn't a bonus die or an extra Insight.

F.5 Danger and the Clock

Inquiry has no failure state, so it needs pressure from somewhere else. Pressure comes from the opposition, not from missed rolls.

- Woe pays for Reaction. When a Probe fails, or when the group lingers, the GM gains Woe as normal. The GM may spend Woe on an Antagonist Reaction: the culprit destroys evidence, a witness vanishes, a patron grows impatient, an ambush is arranged.
- The case clock. Start a 6-segment clock (Core Rules §7) called *They Know We Know*. Tick it when the group makes noise, takes a long time, or when a Probe fails by 4+. When it fills, the opposition acts decisively.
- Danger is a separate scene. A scene either asks "what do we learn?" (Inquiry) or "what do we survive?" (Conflict, Hazard). A scene that is both is two scenes: finish one, then start the other.
- Clues never depend on winning a fight. Winning may give Insight, but a core clue must be reachable even if the group loses, flees or is captured.

Only a failed Probe ticks the case clock, not ordinary failed conflict actions. Antagonist Reactions respect established facts: destroying a source can't make required information unreachable.

Splitting a scene doesn't make a continuing struggle a new conflict. Disposition, injury trades, Taken Out participants and ongoing effects carry forward, and pools don't refresh (Core Rules §10.2).

F.6 Building a Case

Work backward from the Truth, then forward through scenes.

1. The Truth. Write one paragraph: who, what, why, and how it was done.
2. The Hook. Tie it to a Belief, Goal or Instinct of at least one PC.
3. The Twist. Something that widens or changes the case halfway through.
4. The Conclusion. A confrontation, a choice, or a public accusation. Core clues bring the group here, but the players decide what to do with what they know.
5. The scenes. Link them with clues, as below.

Clue type	Use
Core clue	Points to a scene or to the Truth. Always found, never rolled for.
Lead-in	A clue that points *to* a scene. Give every scene at least two lead-ins from different scenes, so the case is a web and not a line.
Floating clue	The GM places it wherever the group looks first. Use it for the clue the case cannot do without.
Leveraged clue	Available only once the group holds another clue. Example: a suspect clams up until you confront them with the ledger.
Pipe clue	A detail that seems like colour now and pays off later.
Red herring	True, interesting and misleading. Never a lie told by the narrator. Give each one a source and a reason.

Scene types: Introduction, Core (holds core clues), Alternate (another route to a clue), Subplot, Action (Conflict or Hazard), Reaction (the opposition responds) and Conclusion.

F.7 Running Inquiry

- Cover the skills. Build an Investigator Matrix, a table of the party's skills against the case's scenes. Give each PC a scene where their skills matter most.
- Be generous. Give information freely. Let players chase red herrings. Give minor NPCs a past and a want.
- Core clues lead to the end, not through it. Following them only gets the party to the last scene. Insight and good reasoning decide whether they arrive prepared.
- Listen and improvise. When players theorise, borrow their best ideas, provided they do not contradict a core clue or the Truth.
- Share the world. A good Insight lets the player describe the contact, the rumour or the detail, within the Truths already established.
- Prompt early. For the first session or two, remind players what their skills can do.

F.8 Weird Methods

Oracles, divinations, scrying, speaking to the dead and similar methods are tools that produce clues, not answers. An Arcana-style skill finds core clues like any other. The result is a true but partial, symbolic or conditional reading. Use Pneuma for the Buy or Probe. Opponents who expect scrying can block it, mislead it, or leave a false trail with their own working. Let the setting decide whether such evidence counts as proof.

QUICK REFERENCE

Core clue: fitting skill (+1 or higher) → found, free.
Probe: 2d12 + skill vs. Standard 15; each Power on Discover = 1 Insight.
Buy: 4 − Edge (minimum 1) from the skill's pool = 1 Insight, no roll; pay in full.
Boosted skill: Buy with it → regain 1 point after payment.
Case clock: 6 segments; tick on noise, delay, or a Probe failed by 4+.
Danger: a separate scene, not an automatic resource reset; clues never depend on winning.



CHAPTER IV

Adversaries

Build opposition on an index card, budget the fight, script it, and run it through the conflict system. Terse reference for the GM.

Every adversary has one thing it is clearly best at. Show the table the Tell.

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1. Principles

- No pools. Ordinary adversaries do not track Sōma, Mētis, Psychē or Pneuma. Grit contributes to their side's starting shared Disposition; it is not a personal track. Shrugs are free Resists. Rivals built as full PCs use their PC resources and applicable exceptions.
- Tags are already counted. Ratings include tags. PCs still Discover, Suppress and compel them.
- Woe is fuel. Ordinary adversaries buy bonus dice (1 Woe each, max +2 including free dice) and fire Specials with Woe. They never use Effort and cannot overrun Woe costs.
- One best action. Every card has one clearly best action and a Tell that hints at it. Give the players something to script around.
- Index-card size. If it does not fit on a card, cut it.

2. The Card

```
NAME — Kind · Rank · Role                                  Threat N
Grit N · Guard +N · Shrugs N · Armour N
Attack +N · Defend +N · Feint +N · Maneuver +N · Other +N
Harm: status (source)
Power tags: … · Weakness tags: …
Kind: traits from the Kind package
Role: role trait
Specials: Name (Woe cost): effect
Tell: the visible sign before it uses its Best action
Wants: what it is after in this scene
```

Field	Meaning
Grit	The adversary's contribution to its side's starting shared Disposition. Add up Grit across a side; adversary sides do not roll for Disposition. Do not track or deplete individual Grit shares.
Guard	Added to Standard 15 when a PC's independent roll targets this adversary.
Shrugs	Free Resists per scene; each cuts an incoming status by 2 tiers. Extra Shrugs cost 1 Woe. Subject to the one-reduction limit below.
Armour	−1 tier of physical harm per point; subject to the one-reduction limit below.
Ratings	Bonus on each conflict action. Other covers rolls outside a conflict.
Harm	Status inflicted by a successful Attack outside a conflict. Tiers equal Power.
Threat	Its cost against the encounter budget. Always equals Grit.

Reduction and payments. Ordinary NPCs apply at most one eligible reduction per imposed status application (Core Rules §10.14); do not stack Armour and repeated Shrugs against the same status. Neither reduces ordinary shared Disposition loss or protected payments. General immunity, prevention and redirection likewise cannot cancel accepted injury trades, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments (§10.7). Later treatment or healing follows its own rules and refunds no benefit.

3. Building an Adversary

Step 1 — Concept and Kind

One line: who it is and what it wants. Pick a Kind: Human, Beast or Guardian (§4), or a Kind supplied by the setting.

Step 2 — Rank

Rank is how dangerous it is *now*. It sets every number.

Rank	Grit = Threat	Best / Fair / Weak	Guard	Shrugs	Tags: power / weakness	Specials
Minion group (3–6 Bodies)	3	+4 / +2 / +0	+0	Bodies2 / 1		1 group trait

Rank	Grit = Threat	Best / Fair / Weak	Guard	Shrug	Tags: power / weakness	Specials
Minor	3	+5 / +3 / +1	+0	0	2 / 1	1
Established	5	+6 / +4 / +2	+1	1	3 / 1	2
Great	8	+8 / +5 / +3	+2	2	4 / 2	3
Paramount	12	+10 / +7 / +4	+3	3	5 / 2	4

Settings supply any Kind-specific construction exceptions; do not add a setting bonus again when its listed Grit already includes it.

Tiers. Minion groups are the mob. Minor and Established are rivals. Great and Paramount can serve as bosses, but Rank alone does not grant Boss Phases. Explicit phased-boss designation follows §7.1.

Use +6 as a starting-PC benchmark from skill and tags, not a universal maximum. With one bonus die, that PC wins a versus roll about this often against an adversary that rolls no bonus dice:

Adversary rating	+2	+4	+6	+8	+10
PC win chance	85%	77%	67%	56%	about 45%

Each Woe die you add moves the odds back toward the adversary. These are roll benchmarks, not encounter-win predictions; versus totals, exceptional doubles and ability-created doubles follow Core Rules §2.6 and §10.5. The listed benchmarks are not current encounter-balance validation.

Step 3 — Role

The Role names the Best action and gives one trait. Assign Fair to two other actions and Weak to the last. A Beast or simple machine has no Feint: it gets Best, Fair, Fair.

Role	Best	Role trait
Brute	Attack	Heavy Hitter. First successful Attack each exchange gets +1 Power. Resolve area effects under Core Rules §10.17; do not multiply this bonus across shared Disposition. Outside conflicts, its Harm is +1 tier.
Shooter	Attack	Dead Aim. Free bonus die on its first Attack each scene.
Bulwark	Defend	Interpose. Once per exchange, it may intercept an ally's imposed status before Resistance or harm reduction, using its own normal reduction instead. Alternatively, use Hold the Line to reduce one successful opposing Attack's ordinary loss by 1. Both options share one use per exchange (§6.13). Outside conflicts, it may likewise intercept fitting harm without a separate frequency limit. Follow the full timing, exclusions and area restrictions in §6.13.
Skirmisher	Maneuver	Hit and Run. A successful Maneuver also removes 1 Disposition from the opponent.
Controller	Maneuver	Shape the Ground. Once per scene, Create a Truth for 1 Woe (not 2) or for 1 Power from a Maneuver.
Trickster	Feint	Ambush. If the PCs have not noticed it when the conflict begins, its side starts with +2 Disposition.
Leader	Defend or Maneuver	Command. While the Leader remains able to participate, minion groups on its side get +1 to all ratings, and changing its side's script costs 2 Woe (not 3).

Step 4 — Tags

Write as many as the Rank allows.

- Power tags explain the Best action: faster than you can see, old-world steel, a hundred donors.
- Weakness tags are levers PCs can find with Discover: proud beyond reason, fears fire, fixed in place.
- Suppressing a power tag (Weaken 1, Disarm 3, Called Shot) lowers the rating it supports by 1 for the scene. If the tag powers a Special, the Special is off for the scene instead.
- Using a Discovered weakness gives the PC +1 on the roll.
- Compelling a weakness costs 1 Momentum or 1 Tychē. The adversary acts on it and the GM gains 1 Woe.

Use the effect permissions of the procedure being resolved (Core Rules §5, §10.6). A successful scripted action may buy relevant Discover; this summary grants no unrelated questions or additional status permission. General Weaken requires an explicit ability in conflicts; use Maneuver's priced Disarm for ordinary asset denial. Called Shot retains only its named permission and duration.

Step 5 — Specials, Harm, Tell, Wants

Pick Specials from the Kind menu up to the Rank limit. Price a new one:

Woe	What it can do
0	Always-on trait, or a once-per-scene minor trick (Armour 1, step between shadows).
1	+1 Power or a free bonus die on one roll. A tier-2 status on one target. Cancel one PC trick. Named reserve reinforcement only under its priced package.
2	Create a Truth. A tier-3 status. Leave the scene. An area effect.
3	Changes the scene: a significant reinforcement under its package, recover 2 tiers or 3 Disposition, a danger-clock tick plus an effect.

This is pricing guidance, not an unrestricted spend menu. Write a Special's trigger, action requirement, targets and component explicitly. Free waives only its listed cost; it grants no extra turn or rotation bypass. Additional Power, Disposition loss and status tiers are distinct, and a bonus does not apply to both loss and harm unless stated. Cancelling a trick does not cancel a protected payment (Core Rules §10.5–10.7).

Area Rule (provisional for playtesting). Use Core Rules §10.17. Establish the area and everyone it can reach; there is no auto-

matic ally/enemy selection. An area Attack or Feint removes its committed Power + 1 from shared Disposition once, plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected. No individual shares or spill-over. A group represented by one rules entry counts as one participant, not one per Body. Explicit statuses apply at full purchased or listed tier to every affected character, with separate Resistance or NPC reduction. An ordinary conflict Attack gains no status merely for being an area effect. Apply both layers only when an explicit rule grants both. At most one participant may accept an injury trade against the combined loss of a single area Attack or Feint.

4. Kind Packages

Human

- Morale. Outside conflicts, a minion group or Minor flees or surrenders at half Bodies or when its leader is Taken Out, unless a Leader still stands.
- Can be talked to. Persuade, Intimidate, bribes, Argument and Negotiation all work.
- Gear is in the ratings. Write Armour separately.
- Build Great or Paramount rival hunters as full PCs.

Special	Woe	Effect
Volley	2	Group or Shooter. An area Attack.
Dirty Trick	1	Once per bearer per exchange after a successful assigned action, Impede the opposing next scripted action in a later volley (§6.17).
Call for Help	2 per copy	Action-free named-reserve call. Use the caller-specific package, shared call window and arrival procedure (§§6.5, 6.24).
Covering Move	1	Once per bearer per exchange after a successful Maneuver, grant Gain Position to the next friendly scripted action in a later volley. Cannot activate while pending or already declared (§6.18).
Last Stand	2	Defeat-triggered. At an eligible defeat at 0 shared Disposition, postpone defeat for one final volley for both sides (§6.10). Once per side per conflict; no personal extra action.
Fanatic	0	Ignores Morale.

Beast

- No Feint. Ratings are Best, Fair, Fair. The missing Feint is the trade-off.
- Cannot be reasoned with. No Persuade or Argument. Intimidate and fire work. Every beast starts with a weakness such as fears fire.
- Morale as Human. Packs scatter when the pack leader falls.

Special	Woe	Effect
Pack Tactics	0	Group trait. +1 Attack if another member of its side Attacked earlier this exchange.
Pounce	1	Free bonus die on its first Attack in a scene. If it wins, apply Impede to the opposing side's next scripted action under Core Rules §10.6.
Savage Bite	1	+1 Power on a successful Attack.
Thick Hide	0	Armour 1.
Venom / Infection	2	After a successful Attack during a conflict, pay 2 Woe to record one deferred poisoned-2 application against the target. Resolve it when the conflict ends under §6.12, regardless of the outcome; compromise does not cause another application. Outside conflicts, inflict poisoned-2 on the hit instead, paying the same listed cost. Once inflicted, the poisoned status rises by 1 tier per scene until treated; a pending record does not progress. During a conflict, at most one recorded application per named Special per target across all sources (§6.12).
Howl	2	Action-free call to one shared reserve Hound Pack; exchange-end arrival, delayed by blocked routes without further payment (§6.22).
Bolt	2	After a successful Maneuver, withdraw at volley end after Self-Repair. Cannot bypass contested escape, pursuit or capture (§6.21).

Guardian

- Unfeeling. Immune to fear, Intimidate, Persuade, Duel of Wills and Pneuma statuses. No Morale; it never flees.
- Protocol. It scripts in a pattern. One Discover reveals its next exchange's script (§6.15).
- Machine. The glitched status lowers all ratings by its tier. A PC with access can use Science as Attack (shutdown) or Maneuver (override).
- Simple machines have no Feint. Thinking constructs Feint normally.

Special	Woe	Effect
Suppressing Fire	2	An area Attack.
Scan	1	Once per exchange, cancel one purchased Impede or Gain Position from a detectable opposing Stealth Maneuver, or reveal one detectable hidden opponent after own successful Maneuver (§6.19).
Self-Repair	1	After successful assigned action, once per Guardian per exchange, repair up to 2 shared Disposition or physical-status tiers at volley end. No Disposition recovery from 0 (§6.14).
Lockdown	2	Once per scene after successful Maneuver, create rank-1 Sealed Doors over named existing controlled barriers (§6.20).
Shock Field	1	When a PC loses a versus roll to it in melee, record one deferred jolted-2 application against that PC (§6.12). This trigger is not limited to Attack. During a conflict, at most one recorded application per named Special per target across all sources (§6.12).
Fail-safe	3	Defeat-triggered. At eligible final defeat at 0 shared Disposition, an active Guardian detonates before finishing procedures, assigning burned-3 to each PC within reach as an additional compromise injury (§6.11). The Guardian is destroyed.
Calls the Works	2	Action-free call to one shared reserve Gate Warden. Accepted command survives caller/link loss; blocked route delays arrival (§6.23).

Special procedures and remaining scope. Self-Repair uses §6.14; Protocol uses §6.15; Last Stand uses §6.10; Fail-safe uses its separate compromise procedure in §6.11; Shock Field, Venom / Infection and any setting Special that explicitly refers to it use the outcome-independent deferred-injury procedure in §6.12. These are explicit Special exceptions, not ordinary Attack effects or permissions to cancel protected payments. A setting supplies its own additional Kind packages and Special entries; the shared procedures grant no unstated trigger, extra turn or actor reassignment. Dirty Trick, Covering Move, Scan, Lockdown, Bolt and the named reinforcement packages use §§6.16–6.24. Their shared timing grants no additional action or activation permission.

5. Encounter Budget

Legacy calibration; playtest flag. The retained budget uses P = about 8 plus party size as a historical benchmark, not the current PC setup formula. Current rolled setup divides 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest pool Edge by 3, rounds down, then adds backers and flat modifiers at full value before the minimum of 1 and Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Recalibrate the expectations below against that procedure; this pass changes no Threat, Grit or budget numbers. Spend Threat (= Grit) against the retained benchmark only with that limitation in mind.

Difficulty	Threat budget	Extra Woe	Legacy expectation
Easy	½ P	none	PCs win without spending Tychē. Openers and calibration.
Standard	P	none	PCs should win and take a Minor or Significant compromise.
Hard	P + 3	+2	PCs win only if they play well. One bad Disposition roll can lose it.
Deadly	P + 6 or more	+4	Signpost it. Flight, bargaining or burning Tychē are real outcomes.

Party size	2	3	4	5
Legacy P	10	11	12	13

- Mix at least two Roles. A Controller with a Skirmisher pack and a Minor Brute gives players script decisions.
- Keep actors to party size + 1 or fewer. Put extra bodies into minion groups.
- Count Woe separately. Session Woe (2 per PC) plus any setting-provided introduction Woe can stack fast. If the encounter already carries introduction Woe, treat Hard as Standard plus Woe.
- Disposition-cutting PC abilities (such as −2 or −3 to the opposing side) apply after the budget.
- Superiority (Know Thy Foe, Know Thy Battlefield, Know Thy Players) lowers opposing Disposition by 1 per eligible distinct category, up to 3, after other setup modifiers and the minimum of 1. Only Superiority can reduce an adjusted start to 0. Determine both sides' adjusted totals first: if only one is 0, its opponent wins at no cost within the stakes; if both are 0, resolve simultaneous setup defeat as mutual defeat without scripting or a winner's compromise (Core

Rules §10.3, §10.12). Symmetry and eligibility retain the core playtest flags.

- Variance warning. The PCs' Disposition roll can materially change the matchup; adversary Grit is fixed. If the result makes the struggle unusually dangerous, signpost it and offer exits rather than treating the legacy difficulty label as a guarantee.

Test legal opposition near a declared party profile's expected setup start, that expectation +2 and +4, before opposing Superiority. Record actual Grit where legal packages cannot match. Retain Threat = Grit and rank construction. Keep builds, resources, tactics, interaction matrix, reserve packages, deferred cap and initial Woe fixed within matched comparisons; vary Woe separately. Record outcome, mutual defeat, compromise, volleys, Woe, repair, protection, phases, reserve Grit introduced and lasting costs. Track initial Grit, available reserve Grit, actual introduced Grit and call costs separately. No validated reserve-budget surcharge or numerical recalibration is established. Win rate alone is insufficient.

6. Running Adversaries

6.1 Setup

1. State intent, stakes and exits for both sides (Core §10.2). State whether death is possible before any roll.
2. Before calculating starting Disposition, record any eligible phased-boss designation and fixed Start/Half Special assignments (§7.1). Designate at most one phased boss per side; designation adds no Grit or Woe.
3. Add up Grit across the side. Apply Ambush (+2 when eligible) and other flat setup modifiers at full value, then a minimum of 1, then opposing Superiority. Determine both sides' adjusted totals before resolving setup. If only one is 0, its opponent wins at no cost within stakes; if both are 0, resolve mutual defeat. Neither outcome activates phases or proceeds to scripting. Record the original adjusted starting Disposition for recovery limits and compromise; do not divide Grit or add an already included setting bonus again.
4. Use the current session Woe pool. At session start, initialize it to 2 Woe per PC. Add this encounter's Difficulty extras and eligible introduction Woe once; count campaign introduction Woe only once. Do not refill merely because a conflict begins.
5. Commit one three-action script for the side, assigning an eligible participant to each action. A minion group is one participant, not one actor per Body.

6.2 Scripting

Each exchange is three volleys. Commit three actions and their actors before the first reveal (Core Rules §10.5).

- Track rotation continuously across exchanges: every available participant acts before anyone repeats; no consecutive turns unless only one participant is available.
- Consider opening with the strongest eligible actor's Best action.
- Vary the script to avoid predictable patterns; repeating an action category is legal when actors and rotation permit it.
- Consider a Defend or Maneuver when the side's shared Disposition is under half its starting value. These are tactical suggestions, not mandatory scripts.
- Show the Tell before the Best action; telegraph an opening action before its reveal.
- Update rotation when a participant leaves or becomes unable to act. An unsuitable or unperformable assigned action grants no free actor replacement; normal script changes retain the assigned actor unless an explicit ability permits reassignment.
- Disarm disables the named asset, not automatically an action category. If another plausible approach remains, the assigned actor may use it; switching gear does not change the script. Otherwise the action may be lost. Before reveal, the GM may pay 3 Woe (2 with an eligible Leader) to change the unrevealed action, not its actor.

6.3 Action Results

- Attack. Commit at least 1 Power to ordinary loss to remove committed Power + 1 from opposing shared Disposition; apply the +1 once per action, not per purchase. No commitment means no loss. An area Attack applying ordinary loss adds 1 per additional opposing participant affected (Core Rules §10.17). No status unless explicitly permitted.
- Defend. Each committed Power restores 1 shared Disposition up to the original adjusted starting value. No commitment means no recovery unless an explicit ability grants it independently. At or above the cap, recovery restores nothing but removes no existing excess. Defend does not restore a personal Grit track, heal statuses or return a Taken Out participant; permitted supplementary purchases remain available.
- Feint. As Attack for loss. It resolves independently against Defend, is trumped by Attack, opposes Feint and Maneuver in a versus test.
- Maneuver. Power buys Impede (1), Gain Position (1), Disarm (3), Create a Truth (2 per rank), permitted supplemen-

tary Effects or an eligible scenery action. Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm at most once each per Maneuver. Impede and Gain Position affect the relevant side's next scripted action, not Resistance; they expire unused if it makes no roll. Pending Impedes do not stack. Only one Gain Position may be pending per side regardless of source; additional grants do not stack, refresh or extend it. Gain Position counts toward the bonus-dice cap.

- Independent rolls against an adversary use Standard 15 plus its Guard, adjusted by applicable Truths and explicit modifiers.
- Versus rolls: the higher total wins with 1 Power, +1 per full 3 points over the opponent. Double 12s do not override a higher total or break a tie. Winning ordinary doubles add +1 Power; winning double 12s add +2 instead. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect. Double 1s cause their complication without automatically losing; successful double 1s also gain the ordinary critical Power. Apply the same procedure to ability-created doubles. An exact tie produces no normal action effect or Power. Losing by 1–3 does not qualify for Success at a Cost. Versus losses, ties and trumped actions generate no ordinary-failure Woe (Core Rules §2.6, §10.5–10.7).
- Supplementary spending. Use Core Rules §10.6 for each action's permissions and limits. No primary purchase is mandatory; all Power may fund permitted supplementary Effects, without double spending. Winning versus prevents the opposing normal effect even if no Power funds loss or recovery; independent opposing actions still resolve. Exceptions grant only their stated scope.
- Automatic success. Replace only an otherwise permitted action's roll, not its interaction or assigned turn. Use listed Power; in versus it wins unless both automatically succeed, then tie unless expressly overridden. No extra action, rescue of a trumped action or dice-based critical/complication follows.
- Resolution order. Trumped actions make no roll and produce no effect. Both independent actions finish before checking victory, even if one defeats a side or takes an actor out. Check eligible Last Stand before final settlement (§6.10). For a phased boss, check thresholds only after removal and victory are determined and the conflict continues without pending defeat (§7.1). Use §6.16 for shared timing and §§6.11–6.12 for Special aftermath timing.

6.4 Woe Economy

Gain Woe from player-bought dice, eligible independent failures (+1), Escalation (+1), dangerous scene Truths (+1 per scene) and bought-off complications (+2). Versus losses, ties and trumped actions generate no ordinary-failure Woe, symmetrically for player and GM actors. Separately triggered complications, explicit costs and scenery Dangers retain their own rules (Core Rules §10.7).

Spend	Cost
Bonus die on an adversary roll	1 per die, max +2 including free dice
Fire a Special	1–3
Reinforcements	Listed named-reserve package (§§6.22–6.24)
Change an unrevealed scripted action before reveal	3 (2 with an eligible Leader)
Tick a danger clock	1 per segment
Extra Shrug	1
Trigger a listed scenery Danger	1

Spend on the Best action early. Unspent Woe at session end is wasted tension. An ordinary failed conflict action does not also authorise an unrelated GM move or extra harm. Independent Success at a Cost follows Core Rules §10.7; ordinary costs add no status or extra Disposition loss without explicit permission. Complications respect stakes and independent-action timing.

6.5 Reinforcements

Reinforcements add their listed Grit to current shared Disposition only, even above the original adjusted starting value. They do not raise starting Disposition, the normal recovery cap or the compromise reference (Core Rules §10.9, §10.13). Defend and other recovery restore only up to the original start unless explicitly overridden. At or above the cap, restore nothing and do not remove an existing excess; other permitted Defend purchases remain available. Removal subtracts no Grit. Joining participants enter continuous rotation under Core Rules §10.5; arrival grants no extra scripted action, free actor reassignment or setup recalculation. Only a genuinely new conflict establishes a new start. Boss phase references and thresholds remain fixed (§7.1). During a Last Stand volley, reinforcement arrival remains legal under its own timing, but its Grit cannot raise the pending-defeat side above 0 (§6.10).

Before setup record a side-wide roster with named cards and available copies. Each caller uses only its listed package. Check prerequisites before payment; pay fully and mark selected copies committed immediately. Committed or previously arrived copies are unavailable to all callers. Each copy enters once. Withdrawal, removal or defeat replenishes no reserve. Add no copies during the conflict without a scenario exception established before setup.

Activate action-free calls between volleys, before the next reveal. They cannot interrupt rolls, action resolution or end-of-volley/exchange-end procedures. The initial call window follows resolution of setup defeat when the conflict proceeds to scripting, before the first reveal. Multiple activations require package permission, full payment and separate available copies. A call before volley three may arrive that exchange end; no new call may be inserted after volley three resolves to arrive immediately. Preserve all participation, communication, route and phase prerequisites. Last Stand opens no call window.

At an eligible exchange end, resolve arrivals after defeat determination and eligible phase checks (§6.16). No arrival reverses finalized defeat, reopens the preceding phase check or creates an additional check. Preserve explicit recovery prohibitions, including Last Stand. Packages allowing route-delayed arrival check the route at that step; blocked copies stay committed without further payment. Do not infer unlisted timing, route or communication requirements for another package.

At conflict end, clear unresolved arrival records without refund or restoration to that conflict's reserve. Dispatched characters remain in the fiction. A later arrival is a new fictional event consistent with settlement, not retroactive reinforcement or automatic reopening. Do not reset reserves to resume the same contest as a fresh conflict. Establish any genuinely new conflict's reserve availability through its setup.

6.6 Minion Bodies

Minion groups have Bodies (3–6) instead of Shrugs. Each successful Attack outside a conflict drops 1 Body. Extra Power spent on Extra Feat drops another. At half Bodies or fewer, ratings drop by 1. At zero, the group is gone. Morale usually ends it sooner. Ordinary conflict Disposition loss removes no Bodies and does not deplete an individual Grit share. A group represented by one entry is one participant for rotation and area-effect loss bonuses.

6.7 When Adversaries Win Or Lose

- Defeat. A side loses at 0 Disposition or when nobody can continue pursuing its objective. Complete independent actions before checking victory. An eligible Last Stand may postpone defeat at 0 for one final volley (§6.10); finish that extension before finishing procedures or settlement. Defeat is not automatic death or injury; outcomes stay within intent and stakes. Removal subtracts no Disposition. If both sides are defeated in the same volley, or both start at 0 after Superiority, use mutual defeat, not a winner's compromise (Core Rules §10.3, §10.12). Simultaneous setup defeat scripts no exchanges and does not itself inflict injury, drain pools, Take Out an individual or satisfy a finishing requirement.
- No injury trade. Ordinary adversaries and minion groups cannot use it (Core §10.14). A named rival built as a full PC can, subject to §10.11: once per character per conflict, at most one participant per Attack or Feint.
- Compromise. Resolve deferred Special applications before ordinary existing-injury credit; include any eligible Failsafe assignments under §6.11. Neither procedure changes the ordinary compromise grade. Use the winner's original adjusted starting Disposition recorded at setup, unchanged by reinforcements. Remaining Disposition at or above that start means none lost; use the final remaining total, not cumulative loss or a separate reinforcement ledger. Use the starting Disposition lost: none = None; more than 0 but less than half = Minor; at least half but less than three-quarters = Significant; three-quarters or more = Major, without rounding. Negotiate one outcome-first package. Injury tiers 2/3/4 guide its severity, not automatic additions. Credit eligible existing injuries once. NPCs may use eligible reduction against imposed compromise statuses, not agreed payments; Resistance does not revoke the loser's concession or create a replacement injury cost (Core §10.13).
- Concession. Offer one before the next roll (Core §10.12); one third of starting shared Disposition is a tactical prompt, not a restriction. Propose concrete gains and retained interests suited to the opponent: humans may surrender, beasts may be distracted or allowed to flee, and a Boss may negotiate retreat. Guardians do not normally offer concessions. If accepted, apply the agreed terms without another roll or an additional compromise unless included. Recorded deferred Special applications remain imposed, Resistable Special effects under §6.12; concession terms must acknowledge them and cannot waive them or turn them into protected payments. Do not add an unstated retreat benefit or danger-clock tick.

6.8 Outside Conflicts

- Passive opposition. Difficulty = 12 + the adversary's relevant rating. A Minor's Defend (Fair +3) gives 15; an Established Steward's Defend (+6) gives 18. This outside-conflict procedure does not replace Standard 15 + Guard for independent conflict tests.
- Active opposition. Roll versus: 2d12 + rating.
- Harm to adversaries. Attack Power inflicts statuses as normal. Apply at most one eligible NPC reduction per application. Tier 6 applies the status's established scope and breaking-point procedure; explicit creature replacements apply only where stated. Apply any explicit creature-specific status ceiling from the setting. Do not introduce Disposition loss outside conflicts.

6.9 Other Conflict Types

The same card runs any type in Core §10.4. Swap Attack, Defend, Feint and Maneuver for that type's skills and keep the ratings, Grit and Woe costs. Rename Specials to fit: Covering Move becomes support for an ally's argument, Lockdown a sealed network in a Hack. A reskin still needs a plausible approach and cannot widen intent, stakes or effect permissions.

6.10 Last Stand

Last Stand is a defeat-triggered Special costing 2 Woe. It gives both sides one final volley, not an individual action outside rotation.

Activation. Complete the deciding volley, including both independent actions, then check removal, defeat and mutual defeat. If a side is defeated at 0 shared Disposition, at least one participant remains able to pursue its objective, and a participating bearer has Last Stand unlocked and usable, the GM may pay 2 Woe before finalizing defeat. A Taken Out or otherwise unable bearer cannot activate it. Exclude setup defeat, mutual defeat and defeat solely because nobody can continue.

For a designated phased boss, Last Stand must already have unlocked at Half and become usable from a subsequent volley (§7.1). Reaching 0 does not unlock it retroactively. Non-phased bearers follow their own availability rules.

One final volley. Postpone defeat, finishing procedures and compromise until exactly one additional volley resolves. Both sides follow normal action interactions, costs, helping, participation and continuous rotation. Use each side's next unrevealed scripted action and its assigned actor. If the exchange has ended, each side secretly commits one action and an eligible actor, then reveals normally. This is not a new exchange: do not refresh exchange-limited abilities or tick clocks merely for scripting the added action. Changing an unrevealed action retains the normal cost and assigned actor; Last Stand grants no free change or reassignment. An unperformable action has no free replacement.

Defeat stays pending. The activating side remains at 0 shared Disposition. Defend, reinforcement Grit and other Disposition recovery cannot raise it during this volley or cancel its pending defeat. This restriction does not prevent otherwise legal supplementary purchases, status healing or other explicit effects. Reinforcements may arrive under their listed timing and participate only when normal scripting and rotation permit; arrival grants no immediate action. Last Stand neither returns a removed participant nor allows action through incapacity.

No new phase activates while defeat is pending. Previously activated benefits apply only while the boss remains eligible; there is no phase refresh or bonus action.

If Last Stand postpones defeat after volley three, process that exchange's normal arrival check once before the extension. Eligible arrivals cannot raise the pending-defeat side above 0 or grant immediate actions. An extension before the normal exchange boundary creates no arrival check. After the extension proceed to final outcome and settlement without another arrival check. Last Stand opens no action-free reinforcement-call window; no call may be inserted between activation and its final volley.

Final outcome. Complete all independently resolving actions. The activating side then loses; if its opponent is also defeated, resolve mutual defeat. Otherwise determine the winner within the stakes from the final state. A side may use Last Stand only once per conflict; multiple bearers do not stack or chain extensions. Resolve eligible Fail-safe next, then permitted finishing procedures, deferred applications and ordinary compromise (§§6.11–6.12). Last Stand grants no immunity to those outcomes.

6.11 Fail-safe

Fail-safe is a separate defeat-triggered Special, not an action or a deferred application under §6.12. It costs 3 Woe and must already be unlocked and usable. A phased boss's defeat-triggered unlock follows §7.1; final defeat cannot supply a missed unlock.

Trigger and participation. After the deciding volley and any Last Stand extension, determine the final outcome. When its side loses at 0 shared Disposition, a Guardian still able to participate may pay 3 Woe and detonate before permitted finishing procedures and compromise. Being Taken Out or otherwise unable prevents activation; shared Disposition reaching 0 does not by itself remove an individual. Exclude setup defeat, accepted concessions, mutual defeat and defeat solely because nobody can continue. Do not reopen an already settled outcome.

Detonation. Establish reach from the Guardian's position and the fiction. Assign one burned-3 additional compromise injury to each PC within reach; do not expand the target set to allies, bystanders or other NPCs. The detonation destroys the Guardian. It grants no action, volley or shared Disposition loss and cannot change the losing side into a winner. Last Stand and Fail-safe are separate purchases: pay 2 Woe and then 3 Woe at their respective triggers; no reserved or waived cost follows from the first purchase.

Assignment is not early harm. Record the blast injuries when the Guardian detonates. Do not impose those compromise statuses before a finishing procedure or use them to lower its Difficulty. Their status application occurs at compromise settlement, after the §6.12 applications below.

Additional injuries and credit. These explicit Special assignments are due even if the winner otherwise owes no injury or its ordinary compromise grade is None. They do not increase the ordinary grade or require unrelated injuries. Settle the assignments alongside any ordinary compromise costs under Core Rules §10.13: credit each eligible existing injury at most once across the complete settlement, never once for Fail-safe and again for another injury cost. Apply eligible Resistance and reduction to imposed injuries normally. Agreed payments remain protected. Resistance removing an injury creates no replacement cost and does not cancel a separate consequence.

6.12 Deferred Special Injuries

Shock Field, Venom / Infection and any setting Special that explicitly refers to it use this procedure. Fail-safe instead uses §6.11; no other Special is brought into this procedure merely by similar wording.

Record each application. Each qualifying paid activation records one incoming application against the affected target: Special, target, status, tier, trigger order and used-named-Special allowance. Shock Field records jolted-2 when a PC loses a versus roll to the Guardian in melee, not only on Attack. Venom / Infection records poisoned-2 after a successful Attack; it does not require a versus win if the Attack resolves independently. Each Special retains its listed target restrictions. A tie or trumped no-roll action does not qualify. Before payment, check a conflict-wide used-named-Special record. Each named Special may record only one application per target per conflict, across all sources. Mark use on recording, not infliction. Ineligible repeats spend no Woe for that application; other action effects resolve normally. Different named Specials have separate allowances. Reduction to 0, source removal, phase changes, reserves, record resolution or conflict-type changes do not reset use. Renaming or reskinning grants no new allowance; variants share the original unless expressly stated

otherwise. This creates no new outside-conflict Shock Field procedure. Setting Specials retain their listed outside-conflict effects and immediate benefits; deferral applies only to the recorded status application.

Pending is not inflicted. A record is not an active status. It imposes no penalty, does not stack or cause tier-6 consequences, cannot be treated or healed yet, and changes neither Disposition nor participation when recorded.

Every outcome. Recorded applications remain due after victory, defeat, mutual defeat or accepted concession. Finalize the outcome after any Last Stand extension, resolve eligible Fail-safe activation and then any permitted finishing procedure before applying these records. Concession terms must acknowledge pending applications; they cannot waive them or convert them into unresistable agreed payments. These remain imposed Special effects.

Resolve individually. Before ordinary compromise's existing-injury credit or Fail-safe injury settlement, resolve records in trigger order. Apply eligible Resistance and harm reduction separately to each incoming application, then stack what remains normally. Do not combine records into a larger incoming status before Resistance. Resolve resulting tier-6, Scar, Dying or explicit creature-specific consequences normally. An application reduced to tier 0 creates no status or replacement cost.

No payment by an existing injury. Compromise credit cannot discharge a deferred application. Normal stacking with an existing matching status still applies. After all applications resolve, an injury actually remaining may satisfy one eligible ordinary compromise injury cost under Core Rules §10.13. Pending records alone supply no credit. Across Fail-safe and ordinary costs, each injury is credited only once (§6.11).

Binding outcome. These applications, Resistance costs and resulting status consequences do not restore Disposition, reopen the settled outcome or grant an action or volley. Clear each record after resolution. Then settle Fail-safe assignments and ordinary compromise where applicable; apply any agreed concession costs under their protected-payment rules. Recover each layer only through its own procedure.

6.13 Interpose (Bulwark)

Once per exchange in a conflict, choose status interception below or Hold the Line. When an ally would receive an imposed status that you can physically or otherwise fictionally intercept, you may take that status in their place. Outside conflicts, you can intercept a fitting status with no frequency limit.

Declare Interpose before the original target rolls Resistance or applies any harm reduction.

- Redirect the entire incoming status to yourself. The original target receives none of that status.
- Resolve your own normal Resistance or NPC harm reduction against it, then stack what remains normally. Do not first apply the original target's Resistance, armour or other reduction.
- Interpose redirects; it doesn't reduce the tier. Ordinary NPCs still get only one reduction per status (Core Rules §10.14).
- It can't redirect shared Disposition loss or any protected payment (Core Rules §10.7).
- You must be able to intercept the source of harm in the established fiction. You cannot protect an ally from an area effect that already affects both of you.

Example: a guardian with Interpose can step into a shock-baton strike that would inflict *jolted-3* on an ally. The guardian receives *jolted-3* and uses its own eligible reduction. It cannot intercept ordinary Disposition loss or shield that ally from a blast that already catches them both.

Hold the Line. While able to participate and fictionally able to shield an ally, reduce combined ordinary Disposition loss from one successful opposing Attack by 1, minimum 0. Declare after calculating loss but before injury trade or loss application. It may trigger outside the assigned turn and grants no action or rotation credit. Apply once, including ordinary area-loss bonuses; multiple Bulwarks cannot apply it to the same Attack. An eligible injury trade may cancel remaining ordinary loss normally. Exclude Feint, Maneuver, separately listed Special damage, statuses and protected payments. It cannot solely protect the Bulwark when no ally is being shielded. No outside-conflict effect.

6.14 Guardian Self-Repair

Once per guardian per exchange, after the guardian succeeds on its assigned scripted action, including Success at a Cost, it may spend 1 Woe to choose one:

- Restore up to 2 of its side's shared Disposition, up to its original adjusted starting Disposition.
- Remove up to 2 tiers from one existing physical status on that guardian that its repair systems can address.

Self-Repair supplements the successful action. It requires no additional action or Power. The action qualifies even when all its Power funds permitted supplementary Effects.

Resolve Self-Repair at the end of the triggering volley, after both independent actions and their immediate consequences, but before Bolt departures, final defeat, mutual-defeat and defeat-triggered Special checks (§6.16). The guardian must still be able to participate and pay the full 1 Woe. Disposition recovery requires the side to remain above 0 at that point. Status repair does not restore Disposition or cancel pending defeat.

Disposition recovery from 0 is not allowed in this window. Use the post-repair total to determine the outcome. It cannot reopen a finalized outcome, reverse setup defeat or an accepted concession, or override an explicit recovery prohibition such as Last Stand's pending-defeat restriction.

Each guardian tracks its own use. Failed, tied, trumped or unperformed actions don't qualify. An unused opportunity expires at the end of the volley; an extra volley within the same exchange doesn't refresh it.

Choose Disposition or status repair, not both. Neither repairs the other layer, refills pools, erases Scars, returns a Taken Out participant or affects a protected payment (Core Rules §10.7). At or above the cap, Disposition repair restores nothing but doesn't reduce any excess.

6.15 Guardian Protocol

A successful Protocol Discover reveals only the actions assigned to the targeted guardian in the next exchange, including their positions in that exchange. Record those assignments as committed when the information is supplied; other participants' assignments remain unrevealed.

This guarantees disclosure of that next exchange, not automatic confirmation of all future exchanges. Characters retain what they have learned and may use observations and an understood operating pattern to predict later actions without paying merely to remember them.

The disclosure must be true when given; the GM can't freely rewrite it. The GM may still change a disclosed action with a normal paid script change (Core Rules §10.5), which doesn't notify the hunters. Tells, observations and information effects still apply.

Protocol grants no extra action, free script change, reassignment or rotation bypass. If the guardian later can't act, its assignment fails normally with no free replacement.

6.16 Shared Special Timing

After a successful action, determine Power, allocate it, declare supplementary Specials and pay their costs. Check existing effects and effects already declared for this action. Close purchases and supplementary declarations, resolve expressly permitted reactions including Scan, then resolve uncancelled effects. Reactions do not reopen declarations. Cancelled purchases remain spent; no reallocation, substitution or late supplementary activation unless expressly permitted. This grants no additional action, reaction or activation permission. Self-Repair retains its expressly listed volley-end activation and payment window (§6.14).

Complete both independent actions, their immediate consequences and permitted reactions. Then:

1. Resolve eligible Self-Repair. Disposition recovery requires the side to remain above 0; status repair cannot cancel pending defeat.
2. Resolve declared Bolt departures, including its same-volley Lockdown exception.
3. Determine removal, defeat and mutual defeat; check eligible Last Stand before final settlement. If the conflict ends, perform no further phase checks or arrivals.
4. If the conflict continues and an ordinary phase check is permitted, check phases before reinforcement Grit. Preserve pending-defeat restrictions.
5. At an eligible exchange end, process committed arrivals under their listed procedures and explicit recovery prohibitions, including Last Stand.
6. Update participation and continuous rotation, then proceed to the next permitted declaration and scripting window.

Arrival creates no additional phase check and does not reverse a phase activated before it. It changes no original start, recovery cap, compromise reference or fixed phase threshold. Newly activated phase benefits still begin next volley. This sequence creates no extra action, exchange boundary, arrival check, phase check or activation opportunity.

6.17 Dirty Trick

After succeeding on its assigned scripted action, including Success at a Cost, the bearer may spend 1 Woe to Impede the opposing side's next scripted action in a later volley, including across an exchange boundary. Declare and pay during the supplementary declaration step (§6.16).

Never affect the opposing action in the current volley, even if its roll has not been made. Impede is −3 on the affected action roll, not a status or Resistance penalty. A no-roll action consumes it unused. Pending Impedes do not stack, increase the penalty or extend duration. Failed, tied, trumped and unperformed actions do not qualify. No additional action or Power, extra turn or reassignment.

6.18 Covering Move

After succeeding on its assigned Maneuver, including Success at a Cost, spend 1 Woe to grant Gain Position to the side's next scripted action in a later volley, including across an exchange boundary. Never affect the current volley. Its bonus die counts toward the normal cap; a no-roll action consumes it unused.

Before activation check both pending effects and effects already declared for this Maneuver. Do not activate or spend Woe if Gain Position is pending or the Maneuver has purchased or otherwise declared a grant of it. Declare and pay during §6.16's supplementary declaration step. Later cancellation does not reopen this window. Additional grants never stack, refresh or extend pending Gain Position. No additional action or Power, extra turn or reassignment. None of Hostage's former Truth or Attack-penalty effects remain.

6.19 Scan

An able Guardian with functioning sensors may spend 1 Woe for one option:

- Counter-Maneuver. After an opposing Stealth-based Maneuver succeeds and its purchases and supplementary declarations close, but before effects resolve, cancel one Impede or Gain Position purchased by it. The approach must be detectable within established sensor coverage. Identify the purchase before paying. Cancel only that effect, not success, Power or other effects; its purchase remains spent. No reallocation or late supplementary declarations. Without either purchase this option cannot activate. Special-granted effects

are ineligible merely because they accompanied the Maneuver.

- Reveal. After its own successful assigned Maneuver, including Success at a Cost, reveal one hidden opponent's current location within established sensor coverage. Declare during §6.16. This removes no cover or concealment automatically, establishes no line of fire, grants no Attack and does not prevent hiding again.

Sensors do not defeat barriers or countermeasures without recorded capability. Pay fully while able to participate. No additional action or Power, extra turn, reassignment, protected-payment cancellation or reopening resolved effects.

6.20 Lockdown

After its successful assigned Maneuver, including Success at a Cost, an able Guardian may spend 2 Woe to create rank-1 scene Truth Sealed Doors. Declare during §6.16. It must control functioning barriers already established in the scene. Name the connected set, passages closed and release/override conditions. Create no barriers and gain no control of unrelated systems.

Apply physical restrictions and ordinary Truth difficulty effects only where materially relevant; no blanket opposing-action penalty or indestructibility. Affect allies, enemies and bystanders according to position. No automatic capture, harm, Disposition loss, Taking Out or victory.

Barriers closed by Lockdown do not prevent completion of the opposing action in the same volley, including Bolt through a route usable when Bolt activated. They constrain subsequent actions and reinforcement arrivals normally.

The Truth lasts until scene end or barriers are opened, breached or overridden. Opening one passage removes its restriction only; end the Truth when none remains sealed. Disabling the Guardian does not automatically unlock barriers. Power loss releases only mechanisms established to work that way. No additional action or Power, extra turn, reassignment, protected-payment cancellation or reopening settled outcomes.

6.21 Bolt

After its successful assigned Maneuver, including Success at a Cost, spend 2 Woe to withdraw through an established usable route. Identify the route and pay during §6.16. Resolve departure at volley end after eligible Self-Repair but before defeat, provided the bearer remains able to participate and physically capable of using the route.

An opposing Lockdown in the same volley does not by itself invalidate the declared route or prevent departure. All other requirements remain. Bolt otherwise cannot cancel, interrupt or protect against the opposing action.

Remove the bearer from participation without subtracting Grit or Disposition. Update rotation normally; no replacement actor, reassignment or extra action. Continue if allies can pursue the objective; otherwise resolve defeat. Departure does not cancel defeat at 0.

Bolt cannot activate or spend Woe to bypass an unresolved objective specifically contesting the bearer's escape, pursuit or capture; use outcome or accepted concession. No teleportation, passage through effective restraint or blocked routes, ally movement, automatic safety from later pursuit, protected-payment cancellation or reopening settlement. No separate use limit; departure grants no permission to return.

6.22 Howl

While able to participate, spend 2 Woe during the action-free call window (§6.5) and give an audible howl to call the side's single reserve Hound Pack. It must be within plausible calling distance, hear the call and have a usable route. Check before paying; mark committed immediately. This creates or summons no beasts. Committed or previously arrived copies cannot be called again by any caller.

Arrive at current exchange end if the conflict continues and a usable route exists. If blocked after payment, remain committed and check at each later exchange end; arrive when the conflict continues and a route opens, without further payment. Caller removal does not cancel or delay otherwise eligible arrival. No arrival into an ended conflict. Apply §§6.5 and 6.16, including fixed references, rotation and recovery prohibitions. The pack is one participant, not one per Body. No action or Power; no separate use limit beyond finite shared availability.

6.23 Calls the Works

While able to participate, spend 2 Woe during §6.5's call window to transmit a command to the side's single reserve Gate Warden. A functioning link must reach it; it must be able to respond and have a usable route. Check before paying; mark committed immediately. No creation or unlisted substitution; committed or previously arrived copies cannot be called again.

Arrive at current exchange end if the conflict continues and a usable route exists. A route blocked after payment delays arrival to a later eligible exchange end without further cost; the copy remains committed and unavailable. After command receipt and commitment, caller removal or link loss does not cancel or delay otherwise eligible arrival. No arrival into an ended conflict. Apply §§6.5 and 6.16.

The reserve uses Variant C Self-Repair (§6.14), does not gain Calls the Works and cannot use this entry to call further Guardians. No additional action or Power; no separate use limit beyond reserve availability.

6.24 Caller-Specific Reserve Packages

Bounty Veteran — Call for Help. While able to participate, spend 2 Woe per activation during §6.5's call window to commit one of the side's two Hired Guns. No action or Power. Multiple activations in one exchange are allowed with full payment and a separate available copy each; both cost 4 Woe. Arrive at current exchange end if the conflict continues, even if the Veteran has since become unable to participate. Apply §§6.5 and 6.16. Add

no unlisted communication or route requirement to this package.

Iron Marshal — Call for Help. While able to participate and the Special is unlocked and usable, spend 2 Woe per activation during §6.5's call window to issue an audible order or transmit a command to one of the side's two House Guard Bands. Each is a Raider Band reskin with unchanged statistics and abilities. It must receive the order, be able to respond and have a usable route. Check before payment; commit immediately. Multiple activations in one exchange require separate available copies and full payment; both cost 4 Woe. No action or Power.

Arrive at current exchange end if the conflict continues and a usable route exists. Route blockage after payment retains commitment and delays arrival to a later eligible exchange end without further cost. Once the order is received, later caller or link loss does not cancel or delay otherwise eligible arrival. No arrival into an ended conflict. Apply §§6.5 and 6.16. Each band is one participant, not one per Body.

Command applies only while the Marshal remains able to participate; removal ends Command, not accepted commitments or the bands' participation. Phase availability grants no free call, extra reserve or duplicate Command. All callers share recorded copies; no call replenishes them. Retain the Raider Band's tags, weakness, Tell and Wants unless separately revised cosmetically; the reskin adds no mechanical benefits.

7. Templates

Eight generic cards, including the named Hired Gun reserve card. Reskin freely. Ratings follow the Rank table.

RAIDER BAND — Threat 3

Human · Minion group (4 Bodies) · Shooter

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Bodies 4 · Armour 0
Attack +4 · Defend +2 · Feint +0 · Maneuver +2 · Other +2
Harm: wounded (carbines)
Power: plenty of bullets, know the ground · Weakness: break and run
Kind: Morale. Role: Dead Aim.
Group trait: Volley (2): area Attack.
Tell: hats come off as rifles shoulder.
Wants: the strongbox, no heroics.

HOUND PACK — Threat 3

Beast · Minion group (5 Bodies) · Skirmisher

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Bodies 5 · Armour 0
Attack +2 · Defend +2 · Feint — · Maneuver +4 · Other +2 (Notice +4)
Harm: wounded (bites)
Power: noses for blood, run as a pack · Weakness: fears fire
Kind: no Feint, Morale (scatter if the handler falls). Role: Hit and Run.
Group trait: Pack Tactics (0).
Tell: the circling tightens.
Wants: drive the prey toward the den.

KNIFE IN THE DARK — Threat 3

Human · Minor · Trickster

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Shrugs 0 · Armour 0
Attack +3 · Defend +1 · Feint +5 · Maneuver +3 · Other +3 (Stealth +5)
Harm: wounded (paired knives)
Power: one with the shadows, a knife for every hand · Weakness: the oath before my life
Kind: Morale. Role: Ambush.
Specials: Dirty Trick (1).
Tell: the nearest lamp gutters.
Wants: no witnesses.

BOUNTY VETERAN — Threat 5

Human · Established · Brute

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 1 (oilskin and mail)
Attack +6 · Defend +4 · Feint +2 · Maneuver +4 · Other +4
Harm: wounded (silver-and-wood shotgun), +1 tier from Heavy Hitter outside conflicts
Power: silver-and-wood shot, twenty years of hunts, a veteran hunter's reputation · Weakness: greedy for the bounty
Kind: Morale; can be bargained with. Role: Heavy Hitter.
Specials: Last Stand (2), Call for Help (2 per Hired Gun; two named reserve copies; §6.24).
Tell: he thumbs back both hammers.
Wants: the bounty, and the credit.

HIRED GUN — Threat 3

Human · Minor · Shooter

Grit 3 · Guard +0 · Shrugs 0 · Armour 0
Attack +5 · Defend +3 · Feint +1 · Maneuver +3 · Other +3
Harm: wounded (carbine)
Power: steady aim, reliable carbine · Weakness: not paid to die
Kind: Morale; can be bargained with. Role: Dead Aim.
Specials: Volley (2): before rolling its assigned Attack, make it an area Attack under the common area rule.
Tell: they plant their feet and bring the carbine to their shoulder.
Wants: collect their pay and leave alive.

HEDGE ADEPT — Threat 5

Human · Established · Controller

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 0
Attack +2 · Defend +4 · Feint +4 · Maneuver +6 · Other +4 (Lore +6)
Harm: wounded or shaken (rite)
Power: binding rites, a ledger of debts, hands that never shake · Weakness: proud beyond reason
Kind: Morale. Role: Shape the Ground.
Specials: Dirty Trick (1), Covering Move (1).
Tell: he straightens his cuffs.
Wants: finish the rite before dawn.

GATE WARDEN — Threat 5

Guardian · Established · Bulwark

Grit 5 · Guard +1 · Shrugs 1 · Armour 1
Attack +4 · Defend +6 · Feint +2 · Maneuver +4 · Other +4 (Science +6)
Harm: wounded (shock-baton)
Power: old-world steel, knows every corridor, obeys the bloodline · Weakness: answers to the old codes
Kind: Unfeeling, Protocol, Machine. Role: Interpose.
Specials: Self-Repair (1), Lockdown (2).
Tell: "Please remain where you are."
Wants: guests kept safe, intruders out.

THE IRON MARSHAL — Threat 8

Human · Great · Leader · Boss

Grit 8 · Guard +2 · Shrugs 2 · Armour 1 (house mail)
Attack +5 · Defend +8 · Feint +3 · Maneuver +5 · Other +5
Harm: wounded (old-world sabre)
Power: remembers the founding, a hundred sworn swords, the house is armed, never loses a flank · Weakness: proud beyond reason, believes the old stories
Kind: Morale. Role: Command.
Specials: Call for Help (2 per House Guard Band; two named reserve copies; §6.24), Covering Move (1), Last Stand (2).
Tell: she sets down her glass.
Wants: the intruders alive, kneeling and useful.

7 Boss Phases

Approved procedure; balance unvalidated. Boss Phases change a designated adversary's available options and ratings as its side loses ground. They use shared Disposition, never a personal Grit track. Phase activation costs no Woe; using a Special or calling reinforcements still requires its listed cost and procedure.

7.1 Eligibility and Fixed Designation

When preparing an adversary, the GM may mark a Great or Paramount adversary as a Phased Boss. Rank and the Leader role do not grant phases automatically. Before calculating starting Disposition, designate at most one eligible phased boss per side and record the designation on its card or conflict record. A side may have none. Do not add, transfer or replace a designation after setup, including through reinforcement arrival or removal.

Minion groups, Minor and Established adversaries require an explicit eligibility exception. A full-PC rival requires an explicit phase-capable entry; fictional importance alone does not qualify it. Other adversaries retain their own ratings, Role traits and Specials but gain no phase benefit unless expressly included. Do not split a coordinated side merely to obtain more phase systems; separate sides need genuinely distinct objectives and independent participation.

Designation alone adds no Grit, starting Disposition, Threat, Woe, turn, script change, reinforcement or unlisted Special, and grants no immunity to defeat or finishing procedures. Encounter cost and phase bonuses still require playtesting.

7.2 Setup and Fixed Thresholds

If setup ends in overwhelming preparation or simultaneous setup defeat, activate no phases. Otherwise record the boss side's adjusted starting Disposition after all modifiers and Superiority as the phase reference. Record Half as half that value rounded down, and Desperate as one third rounded down. There is no minimum threshold.

The reference and thresholds stay fixed for this conflict. Recovery, reinforcements, removal and lawful return do not recalculate them. Changing location, tactics or conflict type in the same unresolved struggle does not reset them.

A reference of 1 gives thresholds 0 and 0; a reference of 2 gives 1 and 0; a reference of 3 gives 1 and 1. A threshold at 0 normally cannot activate before defeat. If both thresholds are met at one eligible check, record Half first, then Desperate, with no intervening action window. Phase designation does not guarantee that every phase occurs.

7.3 Special Ownership, Availability and Revelation

Owned means listed on the card. Available means its phase and other prerequisites permit use. Revealed means the players have learned about it. A Tell, observation or information effect can reveal a locked Special without unlocking it.

The following restrictions apply to the designated phased boss, not automatically to every adversary on its side or to ordinary non-phased adversaries.

Ordinary activated Specials are phase-locked. Record each one's Start or Half assignment before calculating starting Disposition; assignments stay fixed, regardless of setup results, scripts or changing circumstances.

Ordinary Specials	Start	New at Half
1	1	0
2	1	1
3	1	2
4	2	2

The table counts ordinary activated Specials only. Passive and defeat-triggered Specials use the separate schedule below. All count toward the card's normal Special limit unless an existing rule expressly excludes them; phase eligibility adds no slots. All table-allocated ordinary Specials are unlocked after Half. Desperate grants no additional Special unlock.

- Start: Start-assigned ordinary Specials are available when the conflict proceeds beyond setup. Passive Specials operate from Start under their own listed conditions.
- Half: Half-assigned ordinary Specials unlock; defeat-triggered Specials unlock and are revealed. They become usable from the next volley, including a later volley in the same exchange. After volley 3, that means the next exchange's first volley.
- Missed defeat triggers: a defeat-triggered Special cannot trigger before it is unlocked and usable, including on a defeat during the volley that would otherwise qualify for Half. Do not unlock after the conflict ends or claim a passed trigger retroactively.

Unlocking or revelation is not activation. Normal trigger, action requirement, declaration timing, Woe cost, targets, fictional permission and participation restrictions remain. The committed action must still permit use. There is no extra turn, free script change, actor reassignment or automatic permission to act while Taken Out.

Half unlocks an owned reinforcement option only; it grants no new Special, automatic arrival, free cost or alternative arrival procedure. Apply §6.5 for Disposition accounting. Availability does not activate a Special or bypass its procedure: Last Stand uses §6.10, Fail-safe uses §6.11, and deferred Specials use §6.12 when their entries explicitly refer to it.

7.4 Phase Checks and Benefit Timing

Complete the volley's actions, including independent actions and any expressly permitted effects that must resolve before victory. Then determine removal, victory or mutual defeat. Only if the conflict continues and the designated boss remains able to

participate, compare current shared Disposition with each unactivated threshold. Activate every eligible phase whose threshold is met.

Use the final total at that check, not the lowest total reached during the volley. Crossing a threshold and recovering above it before the check grants no activation or pending entitlement. Once activated, a phase does not reverse or activate again through recovery or reinforcements.

Record activation at the check. Newly activated rating changes and other phase benefits apply from the next volley, never retroactively. They may modify an already committed action's later roll but do not change its category or assigned actor. If both phases activate together, their benefits begin together next volley.

Phase	Benefit
Opening	Role trait, passive Specials and Start-assigned ordinary Specials operate under their own conditions. Show a clear Tell.
Half	Unlock the assigned ordinary and defeat-triggered Specials under the schedule above. Owned reinforcement options retain normal costs and timing. Grant no duplicate Command bonus.
Desperate	The recorded available non-Defend category gains +2 to its rating. Defend uses the card's Weak rating as its base. Show a desperate tactic, offer a deal or reveal an exit; no extra negotiated benefit follows automatically.

7.5 Desperate Rating Precedence

Before setup, record one available Attack, Feint or Maneuver category for Desperate. Add +2 there while active; keep the choice fixed. Without an available non-Defend category, grant no bonus without an explicit exception. Replace Defend's base with Weak, then apply eligible modifiers; never add Desperate's +2 to Defend. A Marshal recording Attack uses Attack +7, Defend +3, Feint +3 and Maneuver +5 before other modifiers.

At an eligible exchange boundary, check phases before reinforcement arrivals (§6.16). Arrival creates no additional phase check and does not reverse an activated phase.

The +2 stays attached to the recorded category. A later ability changing ratings does not move it unless it expressly changes the phase designation. These changes affect the designated boss only and grant no additional Power, automatic success, harmful-status permission or action.

7.6 Participation, Suspension and Lawful Return

Check phases only while the designated boss remains able to participate. When it becomes unable to participate, keep its designation, reference, thresholds, phase markers and unlock history. Activate no new phase during its absence and transfer none of its designation to another adversary.

Phase-derived rating benefits are suspended while it cannot participate. Unlocks are not erased but grant no permission to act, activate a Special or return while Taken Out. If another rule legally returns it to the same unresolved conflict, previously activated phase benefits resume from the next volley. Do not reset setup, rotation, used abilities or phase triggers.

At the next normal end-of-volley check for which the boss is eligible, test unactivated thresholds against the current total. Do not reconstruct threshold crossings during its absence. A return after the conflict ends cannot reopen it or activate a phase retroactively.

Command applies only while its Leader remains able to participate; phases neither restore nor duplicate it. Passive Specials follow their own conditions: Start availability does not make them dependent on a Half/Desperate rating benefit or override their participation restrictions. A Special expressly allowed to trigger while its owner is unavailable uses that permission only if already unlocked and usable; any Last Stand or Fail-safe use must still meet §§6.10–6.11.

7.7 Recovery and Outcome References

Starting Disposition remains the normal recovery cap and compromise reference; reinforcements increase current Disposition only (§6.5; Core Rules §10.9, §10.13). No phase refreshes either value or creates a new conflict. Apply §§6.10–6.12 for defeat-triggered Specials and deferred injuries; phase availability grants no further exception. Numerical calibration, rendered layout and encounter balance remain unvalidated.

7.8 Example Exchange

Party of three. Opposition: Bounty Veteran (5), Knife in the Dark (3) and a Hound Pack (3), Threat 11. This matches the legacy P = 11 budget for three PCs, not a guaranteed Standard matchup under current setup. In this example the PCs have noticed the Knife, so Ambush does not apply; there are no other setup modifiers or Superiority. The opposition records starting shared Disposition 11. Its Woe pool is 6.

Before any reveal, the party commits Attack, Defend, Defend, assigned to three eligible PCs in rotation. The opposition commits Pack Maneuver, Knife Feint, Veteran Attack in that order.

- Volley 1: Attack versus Maneuver is versus. The Pack spends 1 Woe on a bonus die and wins by 4, generating 2 Power. It buys Impede (1) and Gain Position (1). Hit and Run also removes 1 shared PC Disposition. Impede applies to the party's next scripted action, not necessarily the PC who just acted. Telegraph the Knife's next action with the guttering lamp.
- Volley 2: the Knife's Feint resolves independently; the party's Defend is trumped and makes no roll. The pending Impede expires unused on that no-roll action. Gain Position supplies the Knife one bonus die, within the normal cap. Its successful Feint removes committed Power + 1 shared Disposition, without an automatic wound. Telegraph the Veteran thumbing back both hammers.
- Before volley 3 is revealed, the players may spend 2 Momentum to change their unrevealed action while retaining its assigned actor. The GM may likewise pay 3 Woe to change the opposition's unrevealed action, not react to a revealed result. If neither changes, the Veteran's Attack opposes the

final PC's Defend. On the Veteran's first successful Attack this exchange, Heavy Hitter grants +1 Power.

- If a status or explicit effect Takes Out the Pack, remove it from participation without subtracting its 3 Grit from shared Disposition; ordinary loss does not individually remove it. Complete any independently resolving actions before checking victory. A concession near one third of starting Disposition is optional tactical advice, not an automatic defeat trigger.

8. Quick Checklist

- Intent, stakes and exits set before any roll.
- Budget calibration flagged; mix at least two Roles.
- Flat setup modifiers counted before Superiority; both adjusted totals checked for setup defeat; original starts recorded.
- Any phased boss and fixed Special assignments recorded before setup; fixed thresholds recorded before scripting and available non-Defend Desperate category recorded before setup.
- Three actions and eligible actors committed before reveal; continuous rotation tracked.
- One Tell per adversary, shown before its Best action.
- Woe tracked; costs paid without overrun.
- Ordinary Disposition loss kept separate from statuses, pools and Bodies.
- Independent actions finished before victory; only continuing conflicts with an eligible boss check phases; benefits begin next volley.
- Last Stand: eligible unlocked bearer, 2 Woe, one final volley per side per conflict; pending defeat cannot be recovered.
- Final outcome, eligible Fail-safe activation, finishing procedure, deferred applications, then injury credit and settlement.
- Fail-safe: active eligible Guardian, 3 Woe, established PC blast reach; no mutual-defeat or concession trigger.
- Deferred Specials: one recorded application per named Special per target per conflict across all sources; each record resolved individually after every outcome; imposed injuries remain Resistable.
- Finishing procedures before compromise; reinforcement Grit changes current Disposition, not original start or recovery cap.
- Concessions negotiated before the next roll; compromise settled as one package.

CHAPTER V

Generic Descriptors

Twenty-four setting-neutral adjectives open the sentence: "I am a [Descriptor]..." Six belong to each pool. Each one gives +2 to that pool, a power tag, a weakness tag and a suggested Instinct. Setting books add Descriptors written for their worlds.

The adjective of the character sentence.

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3. Descriptors 73

1. Descriptor Rules

Each Descriptor gives (Core Rules §3.1):

Element	Detail
Pool bonus	+2 to one pool
Power tag	1
Weakness tag	1 (can be compelled for Tychē Points)
Suggested Instinct	Use it or write your own

Each entry also has a hook: one question to answer at character creation. The answer often becomes your first Belief or a relationship. Every Descriptor works in any genre. Choose one from this chapter or, when playing in a setting, from that setting book's Descriptors.

2. Quick Reference

#	Descriptor	Pool	Power tag	Weakness tag
1	Burly	Sōma	*built like a door*	*too big to hide*
2	Charismatic	Pneuma	*the room turns to me*	*needs to be liked*
3	Compassionate	Pneuma	*a kind word opens doors*	*can't turn away suffering*
4	Cunning	Psychē	*three moves ahead*	*trusts no one's plan but mine*
5	Curious	Psychē	*has to know why*	*pokes at what's best left alone*
6	Furtive	Mētis	*keeps to the edges*	*uneasy in the open*
7	Hardy	Sōma	*shrugs off the cold*	*ignores my own injuries*
8	Haunted	Pneuma	*has seen the dark*	*the past won't stay buried*
9	Light-Fingered	Mētis	*quick hands*	*can't resist a pocket*
10	Loyal	Pneuma	*stands by my own*	*blind to my friends' faults*
11	Methodical	Psychē	*measures twice*	*slow under pressure*
12	Nimble	Mētis	*light on my feet*	*too quick to trust my footing*
13	Observant	Psychē	*misses nothing*	*distracted by detail*
14	Reckless	Sōma	*charges in first*	*never looks before leaping*
15	Relentless	Sōma	*never stops coming*	*doesn't know when to quit*
16	Resolute	Pneuma	*iron will*	*rigid when plans change*
17	Restless	Mētis	*can't sit still*	*poor at waiting*
18	Scholarly	Psychē	*well read*	*lives in books, not boots*
19	Serene	Pneuma	*calm in the storm*	*slow to anger, slower to act*
20	Sly	Mētis	*always an angle*	*nobody takes my word*
21	Steady	Mētis	*hands like stone*	*slow to start*
22	Stubborn	Sōma	*will not be moved*	*can't admit I'm wrong*
23	Suspicious	Psychē	*notices what's off*	*sees enemies everywhere*
24	Weathered	Sōma	*seen worse than this*	*old wounds ache*

3. Descriptors

1. Burly

> *You fill doorways. People step aside before you ask.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *built like a door*
- Weakness tag: *too big to hide*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something is heavy, I pick it up myself."
- Hook: What did you carry, haul or break before this life began?

2. Charismatic

> *When you speak, people stop and listen, whether they want to or not.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *the room turns to me*
- Weakness tag: *needs to be liked*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a crowd gathers, I take the stage."
- Hook: Who once followed you, and where did you lead them?

3. Compassionate

> *You have never walked past someone in pain. You have paid for that more than once.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *a kind word opens doors*
- Weakness tag: *can't turn away suffering*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone is hurting, I stop to help."
- Hook: Whose suffering did you fail to ease, and does it still weigh on you?

4. Cunning

> *You see the board, the pieces and the hand moving them.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *three moves ahead*
- Weakness tag: *trusts no one's plan but mine*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone offers a deal, I look for the catch."
- Hook: Whose plan did you once see through, and what did it cost them?

5. Curious

> *A locked door is a question. You've never been good at leaving questions alone.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *has to know why*
- Weakness tag: *pokes at what's best left alone*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something is hidden, I look inside."
- Hook: What secret did you uncover that you wish you hadn't?

6. Furtive

> *You keep to walls and corners. Being noticed has never gone well for you.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *keeps to the edges*
- Weakness tag: *uneasy in the open*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I enter a room, I check the shadows first."
- Hook: Who are you keeping out of sight of, and why?

7. Hardy

> *Cold, hunger and pain are old companions. You've learned to walk on with them.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *shrugs off the cold*
- Weakness tag: *ignores my own injuries*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm hurt, I keep going until the job is done."
- Hook: What hardship did you survive that killed others?

8. Haunted

> *Something from your past follows you. Some nights you can almost hear it.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *has seen the dark*
- Weakness tag: *the past won't stay buried*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm alone at night, I keep a light on."
- Hook: What did you see that you can never forget?

9. Light-Fingered

> *Things find their way into your hands. You rarely remember deciding to take them.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *quick hands*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist a pocket*
- Suggested Instinct: "If something valuable is left unattended, I take it."
- Hook: What is the one thing you stole that you can never give back?

10. Loyal

> *You chose your people. Nothing will make you abandon them.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *stands by my own*
- Weakness tag: *blind to my friends' faults*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone I trust is threatened, I step between them and it."
- Hook: Who did you swear to stand by, and have they earned it?

11. Methodical

> *Haste makes mistakes. You check everything twice and trust your notes.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *measures twice*
- Weakness tag: *slow under pressure*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I'm unsure, I make a list."
- Hook: What disaster taught you never to skip a step?

12. Nimble

> *You move like water, over walls and through gaps others never see.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *light on my feet*
- Weakness tag: *too quick to trust my footing*
- Suggested Instinct: "If the ground gives way, I move before I think."
- Hook: What did you learn to escape from, and who taught you?

13. Observant

> *You notice the scuffed boot, the nervous glance, the window left open.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *misses nothing*
- Weakness tag: *distracted by detail*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I enter a place, I count the exits and the people."
- Hook: What small detail once saved your life?

14. Reckless

> *Thinking is for later. Right now, something needs doing.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *charges in first*
- Weakness tag: *never looks before leaping*
- Suggested Instinct: "If there's danger ahead, I go at it head-on."
- Hook: Who got hurt the last time you charged in?

15. Relentless

> *You don't stop. Not when you're tired, not when you're hurt, not when it's hopeless.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *never stops coming*
- Weakness tag: *doesn't know when to quit*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I start a chase, I finish it."
- Hook: What did you chase and never catch?

16. Resolute

> *Your word is iron. Once you decide, the world bends or breaks against you.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *iron will*
- Weakness tag: *rigid when plans change*
- Suggested Instinct: "If I give my word, I keep it."
- Hook: What promise are you still keeping, and to whom?

17. Restless

> *Stillness itches. You need to move, act, see what is over the next hill.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *can't sit still*
- Weakness tag: *poor at waiting*
- Suggested Instinct: "If things go quiet, I go looking for trouble."
- Hook: What place could never hold you, and who did you leave there?

18. Scholarly

> *You have read more than most people will ever hear spoken.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *well read*
- Weakness tag: *lives in books, not boots*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a problem is new, I look for precedent."
- Hook: Which book or teacher shaped you, and what did it leave unanswered?

19. Serene

> *Storms rage around you. Inside, you are still water.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *calm in the storm*
- Weakness tag: *slow to anger, slower to act*
- Suggested Instinct: "If panic spreads, I stay still and speak softly."
- Hook: What taught you peace, and what would shatter it?

20. Sly

> *There is always another way in, another word to say, another deal to make.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *always an angle*
- Weakness tag: *nobody takes my word*
- Suggested Instinct: "If there's a shortcut, I find it."
- Hook: Who did you outwit, and are they still looking for you?

21. Steady

> *Your hands don't shake. When everyone else panics, you are the one who aims.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *hands like stone*
- Weakness tag: *slow to start*
- Suggested Instinct: "If the moment is tense, I breathe and take my time."
- Hook: When did your steadiness matter most, and who was counting on you?

22. Stubborn

> *You've been told no all your life. You've ignored it all your life.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *will not be moved*
- Weakness tag: *can't admit I'm wrong*
- Suggested Instinct: "If someone tells me to stop, I dig in."
- Hook: What did everyone say was impossible that you did anyway?

23. Suspicious

> *Everyone wants something. You just haven't worked out what yet.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *notices what's off*
- Weakness tag: *sees enemies everywhere*
- Suggested Instinct: "If a stranger is too friendly, I watch their hands."
- Hook: Who betrayed you, and how did you not see it coming?

24. Weathered

> *Wind, sun and years have worn you down to something hard and lasting.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *seen worse than this*
- Weakness tag: *old wounds ache*
- Suggested Instinct: "If conditions turn harsh, I take the worst of it first."
- Hook: Where did you earn your scars, and who was with you?

CHAPTER VI

Generic Playbooks

The six genre-neutral playbooks: Bellator, Furcifer, Savant, Interlocutor, Explorator and Adept. Each has eight special abilities, a capstone and starting equipment for three genres. Setting books can reskin these six or add new ones.

The noun of the character sentence.

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4. Furcifer 81
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6. Interlocutor 85
7. Explorator 87
8. Adept 89

1. Playbook Rules

1.1 What a Playbook Gives You

Element	Detail
Base pools	Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma, totalling 36. Add 4 points of your choice and +2 from your Descriptor
Edge	3 points: the fixed Edge listed, plus 1 point from the listed choices
Anchor skill	Must be rated +3 or +4 in your pyramid
Suggested skills	A recommended pyramid; change it freely
Playbook tags	Choose 2 power tags from the playbook's list
XP trigger	One playbook behaviour that earns XP (Core Rules §12.1)
Special abilities	1 free at creation, and up to 2 more at 1 Refresh each. A ★ Major costs 1 more (§1.2)
Starting equipment	Signature items (choose 1 of 2), playbook kit, and always-carried items
BIG examples	Sample Beliefs, Goals, and Instincts
Relationships	1 ally and 1 rival from the playbook's list

1.2 Ability Notation

- ★ Major — costs 1 Refresh whenever you take it. A ★ creation extra therefore costs 2 Refresh in total, and so does a ★ veteran ability.
- ◆ Capstone — unlocked after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from this playbook. Take it as an Advance; it costs no Refresh. One capstone per character.
- Veteran abilities: after 6 Advances, you may take an ability from another playbook as an Advance. It costs 1 Refresh, plus 1 if it is ★.

Ability limits. These apply to every ability in this chapter, so the entries don't repeat them:

- Free waives only the listed cost. No ability grants an extra scripted turn or bypasses rotation, the action interaction or the declared stakes unless it says so. Automatic success replaces the roll for an otherwise permitted action (Core Rules §10.5).
- Extra Power, extra Disposition loss and extra status tiers are separate bonuses; each improves only the component it names (Core Rules §10.6).
- Protection, reduction and redirection don't reach shared Disposition loss or protected payments (accepted injuries, running-dry statuses, concession costs and costs an ability calls accepted payments) unless the ability names them (Core Rules §6, §10.7).
- A starting-Disposition bonus is a flat modifier: apply it before the minimum of 1 and Superiority, and don't reapply it when the same struggle changes conflict type (Core Rules §10.2–10.3).
- A fact, Truth or flashback an ability declares can't contradict resolved events, and information doesn't recalculate Superiority after setup.

1.3 Rules References Used in Abilities

Term	Meaning (core section)
Power	Successes generated by a roll; spent on Effects (§2.5, §5)
Effort	Spend 3 – Edge from a pool for a bonus die (before rolling) or +1 Power (after a success) (§2.4)
Resist	Roll 2 + Edge d12 and pay pool points by the highest die (no Edge reduction); at negative Edge, roll 1d12 (cost +1 at Edge −2 or lower, maximum 3). Reduce a status by 2 tiers (§6)
Status	Tiered condition 1–6; tier 6 applies its scope and breaking-point rule, subject to explicit setting exceptions (§5.1, §6.3)
Truth	Scene, site, region, or campaign tag that shifts Difficulty by ±3 (§8)
Disposition	One shared total per side measuring its ability to pursue this conflict's objective, not individual health (§10.9)
Injury trade	Once per character per conflict, accept a tier-2/3/4 injury to cancel 1/2/3 Disposition loss; at most one participant trades per Attack or Feint (§10.11)
Dying	Life-threatening tier-6 physical harm with lethal stakes: 3-segment clock; Medicine vs. Hard 18 stabilises (§6.7)
Checks / Grind	Players' Turn currency and the hardship clock (Module B)

2. Equipment Rules

2.1 Load (Blades in the Dark)

Before a mission, choose your load. During play, declare items from your playbook kit as you need them and mark their load.

Load	Capacity	Effect
Light	3	You blend in; nothing obvious marks you as armed or burdened
Normal	5	You look ready for trouble
Heavy	7	You're *encumbered*: Mētis Effort costs +1 and Stealth Difficulty is one step higher

- Signature items are chosen at creation and always count against load when carried (most are 1–2).
- Always-carried items (load 0) are always on you.
- Items marked (0) cost no load.

2.2 Gear as Tags

- Every item is a power tag when it's relevant, e.g. *crowbar* helps Athletics to force a door. Item tags count toward the +2 tag cap.
- Weapons also give one or more conflict action tags (Core Rules §10.10), e.g. *+1 Attack*. Do not count an item's general tag and action tag twice for the same benefit on one roll.
- Quality: a fine or advanced item gives the one extra benefit its entry lists (it doesn't raise the cap). If you use the optional qualities in Core Rules §10.10, record each benefit once.
- Escalation: some items carry the *Escalation* tag (Core Rules §9.3). Carried openly into a scene, each gives the GM 1 Woe.

Declare active conflict equipment before scripting each exchange. Switching gear doesn't refresh a once-per-conflict quality, restore lost gear or change the script (Core Rules §10.10). Gear narration alone adds no status to an ordinary Attack.

2.3 Armour and Shields

Item	Load	Effect
Light armour	1	*Armour 1*: when you Resist physical harm, reduce it by 1 extra tier
Heavy armour	2	*Armour 2*: reduce by 2 extra tiers; Mētis Effort +1 while worn (doesn't stack with Heavy load)
Shield / riot shield / energy barrier	1	*+1 Defend* in Fight conflicts; counts as cover outside conflicts

Armour that absorbs a tier-4+ hit is *damaged* (−1 Armour) until repaired during downtime. Armour never reduces Disposition loss or a protected payment (Core Rules §6, §10.7).

2.4 Common Gear (any playbook)

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
(0)	Belt knife, flint & steel, coin purse	Phone, wallet, keys, pocketknife	Comm unit, credchip, multitool
1	Rope (15 m), lantern & oil, trail rations (2 days)	Flashlight, first-aid kit, water & snacks	Glow rod, medpatch ×2, ration bars
1	Bedroll & blanket	Duffel with spare clothes	Thermal sheet & sleep sack
1	Crowbar or pry bar	Crowbar or bolt cutters	Hydraulic pry tool
2	Tent or tarp	Tent or camping kit	Pop-up shelter

3. Bellator

> *Muscle, grit, and a willingness to stand in front of trouble. Soldiers, brawlers, bouncers, gladiators, mercenaries, security officers.*



Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	12 / 10 / 6 / 8
Edge	Sōma 2, plus 1 in Mētis or Pneuma
Anchor skill	Fight or Brawl
Suggested skills	+4 Fight · +3 Athletics, Endure · +2 Brawl, Intimidate, Shoot · +1 Notice, Will, Survival, Medicine
XP trigger	Address a challenge with force or threats

Playbook tags (choose 2): *built like a wall · veteran of the line · scarred and unbothered · iron grip · knows how a fight will go · the look that stops trouble*

3.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Juggernaut	When you Resist physical harm with Sōma, reduce the status by 3 tiers instead of 2.
2	Brutal	Once per roll, when you spend Power on a successful Fight or Brawl Attack, choose one: remove 1 additional Disposition with ordinary Attack loss, or raise a harmful status the Attack inflicts by 1 tier for free. It adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and doesn't improve a creature-specific finishing procedure.
3	Bodyguard	When an ally within reach would suffer an imposed consequence you can plausibly intercept, take it instead. Declare this before their Resistance and use your own reduction; if you Resist, your Edge counts as 1 higher. You can't take shared Disposition loss, a protected payment or an area effect that already hits you both.
4	Cleave	When you attack a group or minions, you get one free Extra Feat per roll (hit a second target, break their line, and so on).
5	Menacing	You may use Sōma for Intimidate Effort and Resistance. When you succeed on Intimidate against minions, spend 1 Momentum to make them flee, surrender, or freeze.
6	Pain Tolerance	Ignore the roll penalty from harmful physical statuses of tier 1–2; at tier 3+, reduce it by 1. Only the penalty changes: the tier, stacking, recovery, Taken Out, Dying and Scars work normally.
7	★ Berserker	Once per scene, enter a fury: you get +1 bonus die (free) on Fight, Brawl, and Athletics rolls for the rest of the scene. You can't script Defend or retreat. At scene end, lose 2 Sōma (paid in full) or take *Weary* (Module B; without it, *exhausted-2* until a night's rest); either is an accepted payment.
8	★ Unstoppable	Once per scene, when a harmful physical status on you reaches tier 6, record it and any Scar, but delay being Taken Out by it until the scene ends. You keep acting, with its normal roll penalty. At scene end you're Taken Out unless treatment or an ability has lowered it below tier 6. This doesn't postpone Dying or death, restore a lost limb, protect you from other statuses or prevent a shared-Disposition defeat.
◆	Legend of the Field	Your reputation is a Campaign Truth (*"Everyone knows [name]"*). In Fight conflicts, enemy starting Disposition is −2 (a flat modifier, §1.2), and the GM pays +1 Woe for reinforcements while you stand.

3.2 Starting Equipment

Signature weapon (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Greataxe or warhammer (2) — *+1 Attack*, *crushing blows*	Longsword & shield (2) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Defend*
Modern	Combat shotgun (2) — *+1 Attack*, *room-clearer*	Baseball bat & pistol (2) — *+1 Attack* (bat), *sidearm*
Sci-Fi	Shock maul (2) — *+1 Attack*, *stuns on hit* (spend 1 Power: add *dazed-1*)	Vibro-blade & energy barrier (2) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Defend*

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Mail shirt (light armour)	Tactical vest (light armour)	Ballistic weave (light armour)
2	Plate harness (heavy armour)	Riot gear (heavy armour)	Combat exo-plate (heavy armour)
1	Throwing axes ×3 — *+1 Attack* (range)	Collapsible baton — *+1 Attack*	Concussion grenades ×2 — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Manacles & chain	Zip-cuffs & pepper spray	Mag-cuffs & stun prod
1	Whetstone & armourer's kit	Gun-cleaning kit & spare mags	Field repair kit
1	Flask of strong drink	Energy drinks & painkillers	Stim-shot (restore 2 Sōma, once)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: knuckle-wraps, battle trophy. Modern: brass knuckles, gym bag. Sci-Fi: reinforced gloves, unit insignia.

3.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Strength is only worth something when it protects the weak." / "Every fight I walk away from comes back worse."
- Goal: "Get the merchant to the city gates alive." / "Find out who hired the thugs."
- Instinct: "Always stand between my friends and the door." / "Never let an insult pass in public."

Relationships: Ally — an old comrade-in-arms, a trainer, a medic who's patched you up too often. Rival — the one who beat you once, a former commander, a rival enforcer.

4. Furcifer

Quiet, precise, and always three exits ahead. Thieves, spies, scouts, assassins, infiltrators, saboteurs.



Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	8 / 12 / 8 / 8
Edge	Mētis 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Sōma
Anchor skill	Stealth
Suggested skills	+4 Stealth · +3 Notice, Craft · +2 Athletics, Deceive, Shoot · +1 Fight, Tech, Investigate, Drive/Pilot
XP trigger	Address a challenge with stealth or precision

Playbook tags (choose 2): *light on my feet · eyes in the back of my head · steady hands · knows the underworld · forgettable face · patient as a stone*

4.1 Special Abilities

Shared Opening: Unaware or Impeded

Opportunist and Deadly Precision need an opening: an individual opponent who is unaware of you, or whose action this volley has a pending Impede (Core Rules §10.6), and your approach must actually use it. Hiding your intent isn't the same as being unnoticed, though an opponent busy with your visible allies may not know you're there. An ongoing harmful status isn't Impede.

Check once, after actions and approaches are revealed and before anything rolls; the opening then lasts through the volley. A trumped action never qualifies through Impede. Meeting both triggers counts once.

Outside scripted conflicts, check unawareness just before the roll. Whether your action reveals you depends on what actually happens in the fiction.

#	Ability	Effect
1	Ghost	Your first Effort on each Stealth roll costs 0 pool points. Once per scene, when you're spotted, spend 1 Momentum to declare you were never seen; you're in a nearby hidden position. Declare it before the consequences of being spotted resolve; it doesn't undo anything already resolved.
2	Opportunist	When your permitted action against an individual opponent has an opening, gain +1 Power on a success, once per action. This includes an independent Success at a Cost or an automatic success, but not a losing, tied or trumped action. Spend it only on Effects that action permits.
3	Light Fingers	When you succeed on a theft, plant, or sabotage roll (Stealth or Craft), gain a free Extra Feat.
4	Infiltrator	Once per roll, ignore one Truth that would raise the Difficulty of sneaking, climbing, or bypassing security.
5	Quick Reflexes	Outside scripted conflicts, you always act first when violence breaks out. In conflicts, changing one of your unrevealed scripted actions costs 1 Momentum instead of 2, at the normal timing.
6	Escape Artist	When you Resist capture, restraint, falls, or traps with Mētis, the cost is 0 on a Resistance result of 5+.
7	★ Flashback	Once per mission, declare a flashback to something you prepared earlier. Pay Momentum by plausibility: 0 (obvious), 1 (reasonable), 2 (a stretch), 3 (wild). Then roll as normal; on a success, it happened. It can't reverse paid costs or outcomes.
8	★ Deadly Precision	When your Attack against an individual opponent has an opening, choose one, once per action: remove 1 additional Disposition when you commit Power to ordinary Attack loss, or, if the Attack may inflict a harmful status, buy one status against that target for half its tier in Power, rounded up (tiers 1–2 cost 1, 3–4 cost 2, 5–6 cost 3). The discount applies to the purchased tier, before Resistance and stacking, and changes only the price. It doesn't apply to Feint, hazards, backlash or other purchases.
◆	Nobody Sees Me Coming	Once per session, declare you're already somewhere you could plausibly have reached. Your first roll there gets +2 bonus dice for free, and the GM can't spend Woe to reveal you during that roll.

Shared Limits

Both abilities can apply to the same action, and Opportunist's +1 Power can pay Deadly Precision's discounted price. Where two status prices apply, use the lowest; they don't combine.

Against an area, each ability gives its benefit once: Opportunist +1 Power, Deadly Precision +1 Disposition loss or one discounted status against one qualifying target. A shared area-status purchase uses the normal price (Core Rules §10.17).

Both work in any conflict type where the opening helps the approach, such as a precision Attack in an Argument. Neither unlocks a status purchase or improves staking, killing strikes or another creature-specific finishing procedure, and a helpless target doesn't authorise an otherwise unavailable Attack.

4.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Twin daggers (1) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Feint*	Shortbow & black-fletched arrows (1) — *+1 Attack* (range), *silent shots*
Modern	Suppressed pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *quiet*	Lockpicks & bypass kit (1) — *opens what's closed*, Advance security clocks +1 on a successful roll
Sci-Fi	Needle pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *silent*, *toxin-loaded*	Holo-cloak (1) — *+1 Feint*, *bends light* (Stealth tag)

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Thieves' tools	Lockpicks & electronic bypass	Slicer kit
1	Grappling hook & silk cord	Climbing harness & line	Monofilament line & grapple gun
1	Dark hooded cloak — *shadow-dyed*	Black clothing & balaclava	Thermal-masking suit
1	Caltrops & smoke vials — *+1 Maneuver*	Smoke grenade — *+1 Maneuver*	Sensor jammer — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Garrotte & poison vial	Burner phones ×2	Spy drone (Discover, 1 use per scene)
1	Padded leather (light armour)	Concealed vest (light armour)	Flex-mesh undersuit (light armour)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: hidden blade, chalk. Modern: hairpin picks, earpiece. Sci-Fi: implanted lockpick, false ID chip.

4.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Everyone has a price; I just haven't found mine." / "The less blood, the better the job."
- Goal: "Get the ledger out of the counting house." / "Learn who sold out my old crew."
- Instinct: "Always check for a second way out." / "Never touch anything without gloves."

Relationships: Ally — a fence, a forger, a former mentor. Rival — an inspector who's close to catching you, a rival thief, the partner who betrayed you.

5. Savant

Knowledge is a weapon, a shield, and a cure. Scholars, detectives, scientists, physicians, archivists, engineers.

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 13 / 8
Edge	Psychē 2, plus 1 in Pneuma or Mētis
Anchor skill	Lore or Investigate
Suggested skills	+4 Lore · +3 Investigate, Medicine · +2 Notice, Tech, Empathy · +1 Persuade, Will, Craft, Arcana
XP trigger	Address a challenge with knowledge or insight

Playbook tags (choose 2): *read everything twice* · *eye for detail* · *steady surgeon's hands* · *speaks the old tongues* · *respected in academic circles* · *thinks in diagrams*



5.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Encyclopedic	Once per scene, ask one Discover question about a subject covered by your Lore without rolling.
2	Analyze	When you study a foe or obstacle, each Discover you buy also reveals one weakness tag of the target. Creating a Truth that exploits a revealed weakness costs 1 Power less (Core Rules §5). The Truth is leverage, not automatic victory.
3	Field Medic	Restore effects from Medicine cost 1 Power per 2 tiers, within the lasting-injury limits (Core Rules §6.6). You can treat *Sick* (Module B) at Standard Difficulty instead of Hard. Healing doesn't restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
4	Steady Mind	When you Resist confusion, illusion, deception, or forbidden knowledge with Psychē, reduce the status by 3 tiers.
5	Decipher	Codes, unknown languages, and ancient devices give way. Each success on a deciphering roll advances its clock 1 extra segment. This is clock progress only, not Power or Disposition loss.
6	Briefing	When an ally acts on information you gave them this scene, they get +1 (counts as a tag, within the tag cap). Once per scene, give the whole party this bonus.
7	★ Connect the Dots	Once per session, propose a hidden Truth based on clues you've found. The GM either makes it true or tells you one true hidden Truth about the situation instead.
8	★ I Planned for This	Once per scene, after any ally rolls but before Power is spent or consequences apply, spend 2 Psychē to let them reroll all dice and keep the better result. This replaces that roll; it isn't an extra action.
◆	Master of the Field	Choose one field, about as wide as a single skill (medicine, occult, engineering, history). The GM can refuse a field that would cover most of your rolls. Rolls in that field against a Difficulty, including independent conflict tests, are one Difficulty step lower versus tests are unchanged. Once per session, ask a Discover question about what will happen in that field; the GM answers truthfully.

5.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Annotated grimoire / great reference (1) — *the answer is in here somewhere*; once per scene, +1 to Lore	Physician's satchel (1) — *herbs and blades*; Restore +1 tier once per scene; lasting-injury treatment limits still apply
Modern	Laptop with research databases (1) — *online archive*	Forensics kit (1) — *evidence never lies*; +1 to Investigate at crime scenes
Sci-Fi	Datapad with AI assistant (1) — *ask the archive*; one free Discover per session	Bioscanner (1) — *reads the body*; Medicine and Notice tag

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Journal, ink, and charcoal	Notebook, camera, and voice recorder	Holo-recorder
1	Magnifying lens & specimen jars	UV light & evidence bags	Spectral analyser
1	Herbalist's kit	Full first-aid kit	Advanced medkit
1	Quarterstaff — *+1 Defend*	Taser — *+1 Maneuver*	Stun baton — *+1 Maneuver*
1	Scroll case with maps	Tablet with offline maps	Star charts / topographic uplink
1	Alchemist's reagents (1 cypher-like use: Create smoke, light, or acid)	Chemistry kit	Nanite sample kit

Always carried (0): Fantasy: spectacles, chalk. Modern: reading glasses, pen. Sci-Fi: translator earpiece, stylus.

5.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "No knowledge is forbidden; only misused." / "The dead deserve the truth about how they died."
- Goal: "Translate the inscription before the eclipse." / "Identify the poison."
- Instinct: "Always take a sample." / "Never trust a source I can't verify."

Relationships: Ally — a former teacher, a librarian, a patient who owes you their life. Rival — an academic rival, an ex-colleague who stole your work, a cultist who wants your research.

6. Interlocutor

> *Words open doors that swords can't. Diplomats, con artists, nobles, negotiators, preachers, captains.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 9 / 9 / 11
Edge	Pneuma 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Mētis
Anchor skill	Persuade
Suggested skills	+4 Persuade · +3 Empathy, Deceive · +2 Will, Notice, Intimidate · +1 Lore, Fight, Stealth, Investigate
XP trigger	Address a challenge with charm, lies, or bargaining

Playbook tags (choose 2): *silver tongue* · *friends in every port* · *reads people like books* · *noble bearing* · *a hundred faces* · *calm under fire*



6.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Silver Tongue	When you Persuade or Deceive, creating a Truth about a target's attitude (*convinced*, *trusts us*, *fooled*) costs 1 Power less (Core Rules §5). In a conflict, the Truth gives leverage, not the disputed objective.
2	Read the Room	Spend 1 Power on Discover to learn an NPC's Belief, Goal, or Instinct. You get +1 (counts as a tag, within the tag cap) against them for the scene.
3	Network	Once per session, declare a contact in the current location as a Truth (*contact: harbourmaster Elsa*). The GM gives them a quirk or something they want in return.
4	Smooth Recovery	Once per scene, when you fail a Persuade, Deceive or Empathy test against a Difficulty, before Power or consequences apply, turn it into Success at a Cost with 1 Power, whatever the margin. Pay the Success at a Cost price instead of ordinary-failure Woe; doubles and other separate consequences still apply. It works on independent tests, not on losing, tied or trumped versus tests.
5	Many Faces	With a moment to prepare, Create the Truth *I belong here* for 1 Power. It lasts the scene and removes one Truth that would raise the Difficulty of mingling or entry. It doesn't settle a contested conflict objective.
6	Command	When your side scripts an exchange and you can act and communicate, name one volley and its actor: that actor may act out of rotation, even in consecutive volleys. Commit it with the script. It still holds if you're later Taken Out, but can't make an unavailable actor act; record the turn normally, then resume rotation. Separately, when an ally succeeds with Defend and commits at least 1 Power to Disposition recovery, add +1 recovery (up to starting Disposition). Each benefit applies once per exchange for your side, however many Command users it has.
7	★ Inspire	You can spend your Tychē Points on allies' rolls. Enhance effects you create for allies cost 1 Power per 2 tiers.
8	★ Crowd Work	You influence a group as if it were one person. In Argument or Negotiation conflicts where the other side has two or more participants (a crowd, a council, a rival delegation), your successful Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition with ordinary Attack loss, however many people that side holds.
◆	Word Is Law	Once per session, a non-villain NPC agrees to a reasonable request without a roll. In Argument and Negotiation conflicts, your side starts with +3 Disposition (a flat modifier, §1.2).

6.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Signet ring & letters of introduction (0) — *carries a name that opens doors*	Rapier (1) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Feint*, *duelling style*
Modern	Tailored suit & business cards (0) — *looks like money*	Concealed pistol (1) — *+1 Attack*, *never seen it coming*
Sci-Fi	Diplomatic credentials (0) — *official envoy*	Hold-out blaster (1) — *+1 Attack*, *hidden in a sleeve*

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Fine clothes for court	Formal wear & accessories	Holo-fashion wardrobe
1	Disguise kit & wigs	Disguise kit & fake IDs	Holo-disguise emitter
1	Purse of gold — *money talks* (1 use per mission: Create tag *bribed*)	Credit card — *money talks* (same)	Credit stick — *money talks* (same)
1	Bottle of fine wine	Gift basket / bottle of scotch	Rare off-world delicacy
1	Forged seals & papers	Forged documents	Spoofed ID chip
1	Brocaded doublet (light armour)	Armoured coat (light armour)	Deflector jacket (light armour)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: perfume, deck of cards. Modern: smartphone with contacts, breath mints. Sci-Fi: translator implant, personal comm.

6.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Every war ends at a table; I'd rather start there." / "A lie that saves a life is no sin."
- Goal: "Get the guild master to sign the truce." / "Find out what the duke really wants."
- Instinct: "Always learn someone's name." / "Never be the first to name a price."

Relationships: Ally — a well-placed patron, a loyal servant, a reporter. Rival — a political opponent, a jilted lover, someone you conned who wants payback.

7. Explorator

> *At home where the map ends. Rangers, hunters, pilots, guides, explorers, scouts, voyageurs.*



Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	11 / 11 / 7 / 7
Edge	Sōma 1, Mētis 1, plus 1 in any pool
Anchor skill	Survival
Suggested skills	+4 Survival · +3 Notice, Shoot · +2 Athletics, Endure, Drive/Pilot · +1 Stealth, Medicine, Lore, Fight
XP trigger	Address a challenge with endurance, travel, or knowledge of the land

Playbook tags (choose 2): *reads the weather · never lost · sharp-eyed hunter · tireless · at home in the wild · steady at the helm*

7.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Pathfinder	As Guide (Module B), each Power spent on Make Time advances the Journey clock 1 extra segment without Module B, add 1 extra segment to any travel or pursuit clock you advance. Ignore one terrain Truth per leg.
2	Forager	As Quartermaster (Module B), a success also clears *Hungry & Thirsty* for the whole party and gives +1 Supplies for free. Without Module B, a successful foraging roll clears a hunger or thirst status for the whole party.
3	Tracker	When you track or read signs, each Discover you buy gives two answers.
4	Hunter's Eye	With Shoot, once per roll ignore one Truth about cover, distance, or weather. At long range, gain +1 Power on a success.
5	Ambusher	In wild terrain, if you had time to prepare, your side starts a Fight conflict with +2 Disposition (a flat modifier, §1.2), and your first-volley Attack resolves as independent whatever the opponent does.
6	At the Helm	Drive/Pilot rolls with your own vehicle or boat may use Survival. Your vehicle gains one power tag (*swift*, *rugged*, *nimble*). In Chase conflicts, your side gets +2 starting Disposition (a flat modifier, §1.2).
7	★ Animal Companion	You have a companion (hound, hawk, horse; a drone in sci-fi) with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. Once per scene it gives you a free bonus die (within the +2 cap), or acts on its own using your Survival. Acting on its own in a conflict takes a place in your side's script and rotation; it has no Disposition or injury trade of its own (Core Rules §10.9). It can take statuses; tier 6 means it's lost until downtime.
8	★ Weather Sense	Once per session, declare the weather or terrain Truth for the next scene (*thick fog*, *rising river*, *clear skies*). You also always know the next scene's weather and terrain Truths before the party plans it, including whether a travel leg is a hard stretch (Module B).
◆	One With the Wild	In wilderness, the party's Grind clock (Module B) is 2 segments larger, and you can't be surprised. Once per session, while your party flees through wilderness, declare before the next exchange is scripted that you're losing the pursuit. If you can lead and everyone escaping can travel or be carried, the pursuit ends with no roll: you reach safety and the pursuers lose your trail. It doesn't defeat them, recover anything left behind or undo injuries and paid costs, and the chase can't resume without a new discovery or changed circumstances.

7.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Longbow (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *hunter's draw*	Spear & hatchet (2) — *+1 Maneuver* (spear), *+1 Attack* (hatchet)
Modern	Scoped hunting rifle (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *+1 Maneuver*	Canoe or 4×4 truck (vehicle, 0 load) — *my rig*, Drive/Pilot tag
Sci-Fi	Long-las rifle (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *thermal scope*	Grav-bike or skiff (vehicle, 0 load) — *my rig*, Drive/Pilot tag

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Hunting knife & skinning tools	Survival knife & multitool	Survival blade with tool kit
2	Tent, bedroll & cookpot	Lightweight tent, sleeping bag & stove	Pop-up shelter & thermal pack
1	Snares & fishing line	Fishing kit & snares	Auto-snare & water purifier
1	Map case & compass	GPS, maps & compass	Topographic scanner
1	Leather jerkin (light armour)	Waxed-canvas jacket (light armour)	Environment suit (light armour, *sealed*)
1	Trail rations & waterskins (+2 Supplies)	Dehydrated meals & filter (+2 Supplies)	Nutrient packs & reclaimer (+2 Supplies)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: tinderbox, whistle. Modern: ferro rod, bug spray. Sci-Fi: emergency beacon, rebreather.

7.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "The land gives to those who respect it." / "No one gets left on the trail."
- Goal: "Reach the trading post before the freeze." / "Find the lost survey team."
- Instinct: "Always check the sky before setting out." / "Never camp where you can't see the approach."

Relationships: Ally — a trapper, a bush pilot, a village elder. Rival — a poacher, a rival guide, the company that wants your land.

8. Adept

> *Power from beyond the ordinary: magic, psionics, faith, or impossible technology. Mages, psychics, priests, hackers, gadgeteers.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 9 / 12
Edge	Pneuma 2 (Arcana Adepts) or Psychē 2 (Tech Adepts), plus 1 in any other pool
Anchor skill	Arcana (magic, faith, psionics) or Tech (hacking, gadgets)
Suggested skills	+4 Arcana · +3 Lore, Will · +2 Notice, Medicine, Persuade · +1 Investigate, Empathy, Deceive, Tech
XP trigger	Address a challenge with your powers or gadgets

Playbook tags (choose 2): *touched by the Other* · *disciplined mind* · *sees what others can't* · *blessed* · *tinkerer's genius* · *fluent in the old pacts*



8.1 Core Feature — Domain (free)

Every Adept has a Domain: a broad power tag describing what they can do (*fire*, *healing*, *telekinesis*, *shadows*, *machines*, *networks*, *the dead*, *weather*).

- Workings: within your Domain, you can attempt any effect with your anchor skill. The GM sets Difficulty by scope:

Scope	Difficulty	Example (Domain: fire)
Minor, personal	Easy 12	Light a candle, warm your hands
Significant	Standard 15	Hurl a firebolt, melt a lock
Dramatic	Hard 18	Wall of flame across a street
Spectacular	Formidable 21	Set a ship ablaze
World-shaking	Heroic 24 (usually a Ritual)	Call down a firestorm

- Cost: each working costs 1 point from Pneuma (Arcana) or Psychē (Tech), in addition to any Effort.
- Backlash: doubles on a failure or cost cause a backlash. The GM picks a fitting status for you (*burned-2*, *drained-2*, *glitched-2*) or a wild effect, in addition to the normal complication. Backlash still applies in conflicts.
- Your Domain counts as a power tag on workings (inside the +2 cap).

In a scripted conflict, Domain scope decides only whether a working fits and what it can affect. The working uses a permitted scripted action and resolves normally (independent or versus); scope doesn't change the Difficulty or add a roll. It adds no status to an ordinary Attack (Core Rules §10.5–10.6). The Testament of Dust Occultist uses the same rule.

8.2 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Focused Channel	Workings inside your Domain cost 0 pool points if you don't use Effort on that roll. This waives only the 1-point working cost; Backlash still applies.
2	Ward	You can create protective statuses (*warded-X*) with Enhance. While warded, an ally reduces supernatural or tech-based harm by +1 tier when Resisting.
3	Sense the Unseen	Once per scene, ask a free Discover question about hidden supernatural or technological forces nearby. You always notice when such forces are used near you.
4	Overchannel	Once per roll, when you use Effort for Power on a working, gain +2 Power instead of +1, but take *strained-1* as an accepted payment. Once recorded, it recovers normally.

#	Ability	Effect
5	Ritual	Given time, materials, and a safe place, run a working as a progress clock instead of a single roll (8 segments for Formidable, 12 for Heroic). Ritual results can create Site or Region Truths.
6	Bound Servant	You have a minor spirit, construct, or drone with one power tag and one weakness. It can scout (one free Discover per scene in places it can reach), carry messages, or handle simple tasks. It can't fight: it's an asset, not a conflict participant (Core Rules §10.9).
7	★ Second Domain	Gain a second Domain. Workings in it use the same rules.
8	★ Unleash	Once per scene, a working hits every target in an area or group, using Area Effects (Core Rules §10.17). Explicit statuses apply at full tier to each target, and conflict Disposition loss follows the same procedure. Afterwards, take *Weary* (Module B; without it, *exhausted-2* until a night's rest) or lose 3 points (paid in full) from your casting pool; either is an accepted payment.
◆	Ascendant	Once per session, a Heroic-scope working succeeds automatically with 5 Power, no ritual required. In a conflict, declare it before the roll for your normal action: a trumped action stays trumped, and in a versus test it wins unless the other side also succeeds automatically, which makes a tie. No roll means no doubles. If you use it again before your next downtime, gain a Pneuma or Psychē Scar.

8.3 Starting Equipment

Signature focus (choose 1)

Genre	Option A	Option B
Fantasy	Staff or wand (1) — *conduit*; +1 to workings, *+1 Defend* (staff)	Holy symbol or ancestral talisman (0) — *faith made solid*; Resist supernatural harm with Edge +1
Modern	Occult focus (ring, chalk, athame) (0) — *conduit*	Custom cyberdeck / laptop (1) — *my rig*; +1 to Tech workings
Sci-Fi	Psi-amp headset (1) — *amplifier*; +1 to psionic workings	Neural jack & cyberdeck (1) — *direct interface*; +1 to Tech workings

Playbook kit

Load	Fantasy	Modern	Sci-Fi
1	Grimoire or prayer book	Occult library on a tablet	Encrypted data archive
1	Spell components pouch	Salt, chalk, candles & herbs	Spare power cells & focus crystals
1	Ritual dagger — *+1 Attack*	Pistol — *+1 Attack*	Sidearm blaster — *+1 Attack*
1	Warding charms ×2 (0-Power *warded-1* once each)	Talismans ×2 (same)	Firewall chips ×2 (same)
1	Robes of the order (light armour, *marks my calling*)	Long coat with hidden pockets (light armour)	Insulated bodysuit (light armour)
1	Scrying bowl or crystal	Drone with camera	Micro-drone swarm (Bound Servant gear)

Always carried (0): Fantasy: a small familiar token, incense. Modern: tarot deck, phone. Sci-Fi: diagnostic implant, data spike.

8.4 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Power is a debt, and I always pay my debts." / "Knowledge should be free; locks are an insult."
- Goal: "Seal the rift before the new moon." / "Crack the corporation's archive."
- Instinct: "Always ward the room before I sleep." / "Never use my power in front of the authorities."

Relationships: Ally — your teacher, a fellow initiate, an entity you've bargained with. Rival — a rival practitioner, a hunter of your kind, the order that cast you out.

DESIGN NOTES

Roles. Bellator (Sōma): Attack and Defend, forcing obstacles, intimidation. Furcifer (Mētis): Feint and Maneuver, infiltration, deception. Savant (Psychē): analysis, investigation, healing. Interlocutor (Pneuma): leads Arguments and Negotiations, contacts. Explorator (Sōma/Mētis): ranged Attacks, ambush, travel and tracking. Adept (Pneuma/Psychē): flexible by Domain. These are role targets, not Effect permissions.

Watch in playtest. Power-cost discounts used with Effort for Power (Silver Tongue, Analyze, Field Medic, Deadly Precision, Jury-Rig in Generic Focuses). Adept workings: if they overshadow other playbooks, limit Focused Channel to minor and significant workings (Easy and Standard). Don't raise the base working cost to 2: a busy Adept runs out of Pneuma before Resistance is counted. Vehicle signature items are 0 load because they don't come on foot missions; an absent vehicle gives no bonus.

CHAPTER VII

Generic Focuses

Twenty-four setting-neutral Focuses complete the sentence: "...who [Focus]." Each one has two power tags, a weakness, a link to another player character, and tiered abilities with a choice at Tiers 2 and 3.

The verb of the character sentence.

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1. Focus Rules

1.1 What a Focus Gives You

Element	Detail
Power tags	2
Weakness tag	1 (can be compelled for Tychē Points)
PC link	A prompt that connects you to another player character
Tier 1 ability	Fixed; gained at creation for free
Tier 2 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 3 Advances, costs an Advance
Tier 3 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 6 Advances, costs an Advance

- The other option: once you've reached a tier, you may take its unchosen option later as a normal Advance.
- ★ Major: costs 1 Refresh when taken (Core Rules §3.6). Every Focus has exactly one ★ option, always at Tier 3, so you can always choose a path that keeps your Refresh.
- Any playbook can take any Focus. The "Suits" line is a suggestion.
- Changing Focus: at a major milestone, with GM approval, you can swap your Focus. You keep Tier 1 of the new one and rebuy higher tiers with Advances.

1.2 Weird Focuses ◈

Focuses marked ◈ Weird assume the supernatural, impossible technology, or both. In mundane settings the GM removes them from the list. Every other Focus works in any genre.

Module abilities. An ability marked (Module A), (Module B) or (Module C) needs that module. Without it, take the other ability at that tier, or agree a substitute with the GM. Lives Off the Land (marked B in §2) needs Module B throughout; without it, the GM removes it from the list.

1.3 Ability Limits

Focus abilities follow the Ability limits in Generic Playbooks §1.2 (free costs, no extra turns, separate bonuses, protected payments). In addition, so the entries don't repeat them:

- Free bonus dice still count toward the +2 bonus die maximum.
- An ability that lets a tag exceed the tag cap adds at most +1 above it (maximum +3), and only for the tag it names.
- Cost reductions: for Effects other than Create, only one reduction applies to a single Effect. Create is the exception: each stated Create discount lowers the cost by 1 Power, to a minimum of 1 (Core Rules §5).
- Flat starting-Disposition bonuses apply at full value with other flat modifiers, before the minimum of 1 and opposing Superiority (Core Rules §10.2–10.3). Changing conflict type within the same struggle doesn't refresh Disposition or reapply them.
- Declared facts (Truths, contingencies, contacts, hazards) can't contradict resolved events or recalculate Superiority after setup. Bonus clock segments advance that clock only.
- Difficulty reductions apply only when a roll tests against a Difficulty, including an independent conflict test; they never modify totals in a versus test (Core Rules §10.5).
- Crews, packs and allies that act in a conflict are one participant in your side's script and rotation, with no Disposition track or injury trade of their own. Free Help waives only the pool-point cost.
- Healing treats existing statuses. It doesn't restore Disposition, refresh an injury trade, erase a Scar or lift the 1-tier lasting-injury limit (Core Rules §6.6), and a Taken Out ally returns to an ongoing conflict only when an ability says so (Core Rules §6.4).

2. Quick Reference

#	Focus	Category	Suits	◆
1	Never Leaves Anyone Behind	Combat	Bellator, Explorator, Furcifer	
2	Leads From the Front	Combat	Interlocutor, Bellator, Explorator	
3	Masters a Weapon	Combat	Bellator, Furcifer, Explorator	
4	Fights Dirty	Combat	Bellator, Furcifer	
5	Moves Like a Shadow	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Explorator	
6	Never Misses	Stealth & Precision	Explorator, Furcifer, Bellator	
7	Opens Every Lock	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Savant, Adept	
8	Always Has an Escape Plan	Stealth & Precision	Furcifer, Interlocutor	
9	Builds Impossible Things	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Explorator	
10	Heals the Broken	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Interlocutor	
11	Solves the Unsolvable	Knowledge	Savant, Interlocutor, Furcifer	
12	Remembers What Was Forgotten	Knowledge	Savant, Adept, Explorator	
13	Talks Their Way Out of Anything	Social	Interlocutor, Furcifer	
14	Wears a Hundred Masks	Social	Interlocutor, Furcifer	
15	Knows Everyone Worth Knowing	Social	Interlocutor, Savant	
16	Carries the Weight of a Crown	Social	Interlocutor, Bellator	
17	Runs With the Pack	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Bellator	
18	Charts the Unknown	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Savant	
19	Lives Off the Land	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Bellator	B
20	Was Born Behind the Wheel	Wilderness & Travel	Explorator, Furcifer	
21	Hunts the Things in the Dark	Weird	Savant, Adept, Bellator	◈
22	Walks Between Worlds	Weird	Adept, Savant	◈
23	Made a Bargain With Something Old	Weird	Any	◈
24	Is More Than Human	Weird	Any	◈

3. Combat Focuses

1. Never Leaves Anyone Behind

> *Loyal to a fault. You go back for the fallen, every time.*

- Power tags: *I've got your back*, *carry them out*
- Weakness tag: *can't walk away*
- PC link: "I once failed to save someone. [PC] reminds me of them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Shield Bearer	When an ally next to you takes an imposed status, spend 1 point from any pool to reduce it by 1 tier before they Resist.
2a	Second Wind	Once per scene, when you succeed on a Defend and can reach a Taken Out ally, spend 2 Power (instead of recovering Disposition) to bring them back: reduce the status that took them out to tier 4. They rejoin your side's rotation without an immediate turn. Death, a settled defeat, other statuses and Scars stay.
2b	Cover	When you accept an injury to cancel Disposition loss from an Attack or Feint, cancel 1 additional Disposition loss, up to the loss inflicted. All normal injury-trade restrictions apply.
3a	No One Left	Once per session, before a volley is revealed, declare a coordinated withdrawal. After that volley, if you or an ally succeeded on a Defend or Maneuver in it, your side escapes together, with any Taken Out allies you can reach and carry. You give up the contested objective unless it was escape; the opposition gets any compatible part of its intent but can't capture or separate those you extract. No other compromise applies; injuries and paid costs stay.
3b	★ Living Wall	Once per scene, until your next action, imposed harm aimed at allies within reach that you can intercept hits you instead. Redirect it before their Resistance and use your own reduction; Resist each with Edge +1. Area effects that already hit you both aren't redirected.

2. Leads From the Front

> *Captain, chief, or sergeant: people follow you.*

- Power tags: *born to command*, *they believe in me*
- Weakness tag: *every loss is on me*
- PC link: "[PC] was the first person who ever followed my lead."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Rally	Once per scene, spend 1 Momentum to restore 2 points to one pool of every ally who can hear you.
2a	Battle Plan	At the start of a conflict, after the opposing side commits its first script and before yours, look at one of its actions.
2b	Lead by Example	When you succeed with 3+ Power, the next ally who acts toward the same goal gets a free bonus die.
3a	★ Warband	Gain a loyal crew (a group with 2 power tags and 1 weakness). It gives free Help once per scene, holds a position or acts as one group, and takes statuses as a single target (§1.3).
3b	Unbreakable Line	Once per conflict, when your side's Disposition would drop to 0, it stays at 1 and you take a tier-2 status as an accepted payment.

3. Masters a Weapon

> *Years of drill with one weapon: a blade, a rifle, a staff, bare fists.*

- Power tags: *one with my [weapon]*, *drilled every day*
- Weakness tag: *lost without it*
- PC link: "[PC] once saw me lose a duel, and kept it secret."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Signature Style	Choose a weapon type. That weapon's tag may add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3 from tags), and it gains a second conflict action tag (e.g. a sword also gives +1 Defend).
2a	Riposte	In Fight conflicts, when you win a versus roll with Defend, you may spend any of that Power to remove the opposing side's Disposition instead of restoring your side's.
2b	Disarming Master	The Disarm maneuver costs 2 Power instead of 3; other reductions don't lower it further. Outside conflicts, Weaken can strip an opponent's weapon tag for the scene.
3a	Perfect Strike	Once per scene, after rolling with your weapon, turn one kept die into a 12. If that creates doubles, apply them. Declare it before spending Power or applying consequences.
3b	★ Weapon Saint	Your weapon becomes an artifact (Module A) with one extra power tag and an ability you design with the GM. It never depletes and costs no attunement Refresh.

4. Fights Dirty

> *Honour is for people who can afford to lose.*

- Power tags: *no rules in a fight*, *eye for a cheap shot*
- Weakness tag: *no one trusts me in a fair fight*
- PC link: "I taught [PC] that winning is the only thing that matters. They're still deciding if I was right."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Cheap Shot	Once per scene, as part of an Attack, Create a Truth (*sand in the eyes*, *low blow*) for 1 Power. This permits only the Create purchase on that Attack.
2a	Improvised Arsenal	Anything in reach is a weapon for you: chairs, bottles, tools. It gives +1 Attack or +1 Maneuver as an action tag (within the tag cap) and costs no load (Generic Playbooks §2.1).
2b	Kick Them While They're Down	Against a target with a harmful status of tier 2+, gain +1 Power on Attack.
3a	Every Trick in the Book	In Fight conflicts, your successful Feints remove 1 additional Disposition.
3b	★ Nothing Is Off-Limits	Once per session, declare a hazard Truth that was already there (*gas leak*, *rotten floor*, *loose cargo*). Your next roll that uses it gets a free Extra Feat.

4. Stealth & Precision Focuses

5. Moves Like a Shadow

> *Silent, patient, and impossible to pin down.*

- Power tags: *silent as snowfall*, *at home in darkness*
- Weakness tag: *uneasy in the light*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who always knows where I am."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Shadow-Born	Truths about darkness, noise, or crowds lower your Stealth Difficulty by two steps instead of one.
2a	Vanish	Once per scene, after any roll, become hidden if there's any cover nearby. No roll needed. This changes your position from now on; it doesn't undo anything already resolved.
2b	Shadow Escort	Up to two allies can use your Stealth result instead of rolling their own.
3a	Unseen Hand	Any action you take while hidden gains +1 Power on a success. It doesn't stack with Opportunist.
3b	★ Living Shadow	Once per session, describe a concealed route through one guarded or blocked area to a destination beyond it. If the route could physically fit you, you reach it unnoticed without a roll; ordinary locks, patrols and surveillance don't stop you. It moves only you and what you carry. In a scripted conflict, use it between exchanges: if unnoticed passage was your only objective, you achieve it and leave without compromise; otherwise, continue from the new position.

6. Never Misses

> *Sniper, archer, gunslinger: steady breath and a sharp eye.*

- Power tags: *steady breath*, *eye like a hawk*
- Weakness tag: *clumsy up close*
- PC link: "[PC] owes their life to a shot I made."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Called Shot	Once per roll with Shoot, a free Weaken effect: suppress one of the target's tags (weapon, cover, mobility) for the scene.
2a	Overwatch	Once per scene, cancel an imposed status of tier 2 or less about to hit an ally by shooting the source; declare it before the status applies. In conflicts, you may Defend with Shoot when covering fire can protect your side.
2b	Trick Shot	Ignore Truths about cover and angles. Gain a free Extra Feat when you shoot objects (cut a rope, hit a switch, ricochet).
3a	One Shot	Once per session, a successful Shoot Attack against a non-major NPC Takes them Out. In a conflict, it removes that participant and 1 additional Disposition.
3b	★ Sniper's Patience	Spend a scene setting up (4-segment clock). Your shot gets +2 bonus dice for free and +2 Power on a success.

7. Opens Every Lock

> *Locks, safes, firewalls, sealed doors: they're puzzles, and you love puzzles.*

- Power tags: *nothing stays closed*, *thinks like an architect*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist a challenge*
- PC link: "[PC] keeps me out of trouble, or tries to."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Bypass	Each success on a lock, safe or security clock advances it 1 extra segment. Before you roll, you also know the clock's size and what failing will set off.
2a	Back Door	Once per location, Create the Truth *I know a way in* for 1 Power. It gives access or leverage, not victory over an unrelated objective.
2b	Trap Sense	You always notice traps and alarms before triggering them. Resisting traps costs 0 on a Resistance result of 5+. Allies you warn in time Resist that trap with Edge +1.
3a	Master Key	Ordinary locks open without a roll. Complex security is one Difficulty step lower.
3b	★ Vault Breaker	Once per mission, declare a security layer already cracked: fill one security clock completely.

8. Always Has an Escape Plan

> *You never walk into a room without knowing how to leave it.*

- Power tags: *knows every exit*, *slippery*
- Weakness tag: *runs first, thinks later*
- PC link: "[PC] was with me during my worst getaway."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Exit Strategy	When you enter a new scene, ask one free Discover question about exits or escape routes.
2a	Clean Getaway	In Chase conflicts where you're fleeing, your side gets +2 starting Disposition.
2b	Contin-gency	Once per mission, when things go wrong, reveal a prepared fallback (stashed gear, a getaway vehicle, a safe house) as a Truth. No Momentum needed.
3a	Not Here	Once per scene, when you would receive an imposed harmful status and can act, spend 1 Momentum and describe how you evade its source: cancel that status on yourself and move to a nearby position. Disposition loss and other effects of the triggering action still apply.
3b	★ Dead Man's Switch	Once per session, when you're captured or confined, declare a contingency and give the GM 2 Woe. At the start of your next scene it creates an opening (you slip one restraint, an exit opens, or an established contact helps), and you may at once make one escape roll, even if confinement would normally prevent it. In a conflict, resolve it before the next exchange. Your statuses stay, and it doesn't revive you, recover confiscated gear, free companions or guarantee the roll.

5. Knowledge Focuses

9. Builds Impossible Things

> *An artificer, engineer, or inventor who makes what shouldn't work, work.*

- Power tags: *workshop hands*, *it'll work, trust me*
- Weakness tag: *never quite finished*
- PC link: "I built [PC]'s gear, and I'm still tinkering with it."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Jury-Rig	Once per scene, Craft a temporary gadget: Create a Truth for 1 Power that lasts the scene.
2a	Inventor	During downtime, turn a gadget into a permanent item with a 6-segment clock. It gets 1 power tag and 1 action tag; count its benefit once per roll.
2b	Field Repairs	Restore effects work on gear, vehicles, and constructs. Repair damaged armour without downtime.
3a	Master-work	Create one artifact (Module A) with a 12-segment downtime clock. You pay no Refresh to attune your own masterwork.
3b	★ Rig the Field	Once per scene, rig the area with gadgets: Create two Truths for 2 Power total.

10. Heals the Broken

> *Doctor, field medic, herbalist, or combat surgeon.*

- Power tags: *calm hands*, *bedside manner*
- Weakness tag: *can't refuse anyone in pain*
- PC link: "I patched up [PC] when no one else would."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Triage	Once per scene, reduce an ally's harmful status by 1 tier without a roll.
2a	Battlefield Surgeon	In conflicts, you may Defend with Medicine when you can reach and treat an ally. On a successful Defend, restore Disposition normally and also clear one tier-1 harmful status from that ally that your treatment can address.
2b	Remedy	In each Players' Turn, clear one Grind condition (Module B) from one ally without spending a Check.
3a	Miracle Worker	Once per session, bring an ally back from a tier-6 physical status: they return at tier 4, are no longer Taken Out, and may rejoin an unresolved conflict if circumstances allow. A settled defeat stays settled.
3b	★ Physician's Care	Allies you treat during a Third rest recover all pool points instead of that rest's normal recovery.

11. Solves the Unsolvable

> *Detective, investigator, or analyst: you follow the thread to the end.*

- Power tags: *nothing gets past me*, *follows the thread*
- Weakness tag: *obsessed with the case*
- PC link: "[PC] was part of the case that made me."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Case File	Start a Mystery clock (6 or 8) for a case. Every Discover you buy also advances it 1 segment. When it fills, the GM reveals the core truth.
2a	Interro-gator	When questioning someone, each Discover gives two answers. You also learn whether the subject believes each answer.
2b	Recon-struction	At the scene of a past event, ask three Discover questions for free (once per location).
3a	The Reveal	Once per session, publicly name the culprit in a case you've investigated and explain the evidence. The GM confirms whether you're right. If you are, your side gains +3 starting Disposition in the next conflict this session in which it confronts the culprit over the case; declare it before Disposition is rolled. If your side wins, the culprit gets no compromise protecting them from the case-related outcome in the stakes; others on their side keep theirs. It doesn't prove guilt without evidence, expand the stakes, force a confession or skip a finishing procedure. A wrong accusation gives nothing and uses the session's use.
3b	★ One Step Ahead	Once per session, reveal that you anticipated an opponent's move: cancel one GM Woe spend as it happens, before its effect resolves.

12. Remembers What Was Forgotten

> *Historian, archaeologist, or keeper of lost lore.*

- Power tags: *walks among ruins*, *reads dead languages*
- Weakness tag: *lives in the past*
- PC link: "[PC] helped me recover something that was lost."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Echoes of the Past	At any old or abandoned place, ask one free Discover question about its history.
2a	Lost Knowledge	Once per session, you've read about this before: Create a Truth (*ancient weakness*, *forgotten route*) for 1 Power.
2b	Relic Hunter	When you find cyphers or treasure, roll or draw twice and choose. You identify artifacts automatically.
3a	Living Archive	Lore rolls about history, legends, and old cultures are one Difficulty step lower.
3b	★ Rewrite History	Prove a Campaign Truth is false with a 12-segment research clock. When it fills, the Truth changes (Module C).

6. Social Focuses

13. Talks Their Way Out of Anything

> *Charm, quick wit, and the right words at the right time.*

- Power tags: *always has a story ready*, *disarming smile*
- Weakness tag: *my mouth writes cheques*
- PC link: "[PC] has bailed me out more than once; I owe them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Fast Talk	Once per scene, use Persuade or Deceive in place of any other skill to get out of a bad situation. This swaps the skill only.
2a	Change of Plans	Once per scene, when a social roll is a Success at a Cost, you succeed without the cost.
2b	Disarming	Once per scene, stop a fight before it starts with a Persuade roll. On a success, the Fight becomes a Negotiation conflict; set the new skills before the next exchange.
3a	★ The Long Con	Start a long con clock (8) against a target. Each success against them Advances it. When it fills, they give up something substantial: land, title, a secret, or their master.
3b	Golden Tongue	Tychē Point invokes on Persuade and Deceive give +3 instead of +2.

14. Wears a Hundred Masks

> *Spy, impostor, or actor: you can be anyone.*

- Power tags: *perfect mimic*, *no one remembers my real face*
- Weakness tag: *who am I really?*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who knows my real name."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Quick Change	Create a disguise Truth for 1 Power, even without a disguise kit. It doesn't by itself settle a disputed objective.
2a	Mimic	You can copy voices, mannerisms, and handwriting. Impersonating a specific person gets a free bonus die.
2b	Deep Cover	Establish one persistent cover identity with a name, a credible background and one named contact who knows you by it. Record it as a Truth that lasts until the cover is blown. To expose it as false, the GM must name a credible cause and spend 2 Woe; without that, suspicion can create scrutiny or obstacles but doesn't prove the cover false. It doesn't protect unrelated lies, prevent arrest under the cover name or erase earlier evidence, and you can always reveal yourself. A new cover takes downtime.
3a	Belongs Anywhere	Ignore Truths about social barriers (*members only*, *high security*, *closed community*).
3b	★ Become Them	Once per session, after observing a specific NPC and preparing, take their place for one scene. People and ordinary identity checks accept you as them without a roll. This guarantees recognition, not obedience, and gives you none of their memories, abilities or possessions. It ends at scene end, when you reveal yourself, or when someone sees direct proof you can't be them (such as the real NPC beside you); suspicion or an unrelated failed roll isn't enough.

15. Knows Everyone Worth Knowing

> *Fixer, socialite, or broker: you're one call away from anyone.*

- Power tags: *favours owed*, *always on the guest list*
- Weakness tag: *owes favours too*
- PC link: "I introduced [PC] to the people who matter."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Contacts	Start with 3 named contacts (Truths that last until the contact is lost). Once per session, call one for a free Discover or a minor favour.
2a	Favour Bank	In each Players' Turn (Module B), help a contact (spend a Check) to bank a favour. Spend a favour for substantial help: a safe house, troops, a pardon.
2b	Gossip Network	At the start of each session, ask 2 Discover questions about current rumours. When confirming rumours (Module C), roll twice and choose.
3a	Power Broker	Once per World Turn (Module C or E), advance or reverse one faction or project clock by 1.
3b	★ The Right Person	Once per session, exactly the right contact for the situation happens to be present.

16. Carries the Weight of a Crown

> *Noble, officer, executive, or chieftain: you hold authority, and it holds you.*

- Power tags: *voice of authority*, *my name carries weight*
- Weakness tag: *duty before self*
- PC link: "[PC] serves me, or is the one person who refuses to."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Rank	Choose where your authority applies (a realm, company, fleet, or clan). There, Create the Truth *by my order* for 1 Power. It gives authority or leverage, not the disputed objective.
2a	Retainers	Gain loyal servants or aides as a group tag. They give free Help once per scene and handle errands, but take no turns in conflicts.
2b	Immunity	Once per session, when an authority that recognises your position would arrest you or impose a legal penalty, invoke your status first. The authority must suspend it and refer the matter to a named superior, court or institution. You stay free pending the hearing, but agree a concrete

Tier	Ability	Effect
		obligation now: appear at a stated time, provide a guarantor or an equivalent. It protects only you, doesn't erase the charge or undo penalties already applied, and doesn't bind those who reject your authority. In a conflict, it replaces your arrest or legal penalty but not the result, and it can't cancel a penalty you accepted as payment or concession.
3a	Command the Field	In Battle conflicts, your side gets +3 starting Disposition.
3b	★ Holdings	Gain a holding (keep, office, ship, estate) as a site (Module C) with 3 Truths you choose. Once per Players' Turn (Module B), one action there costs no Check.

7. Wilderness & Travel Focuses

17. Runs With the Pack

> *Beast handler, rider, falconer, or dog-musher.*

- Power tags: *animals trust me*, *calm voice*
- Weakness tag: *better with animals than people*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only person my animals like."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Handler	Calm or command ordinary animals with Empathy. If you have an Animal Companion, it gains +1 power tag.
2a	Pack Tactics	Your animals give free Help once per scene.
2b	Beast Lore	Once per scene, Discover a creature's weakness tag without rolling.
3a	★ The Pack	Gain a group of animals (hounds, ravens, horses) with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. It acts as one group, not one per animal, and takes statuses as a single target (§1.3).
3b	Trusted Mount	Gain a superb mount (or upgrade one). In Chase conflicts your side gets +2 starting Disposition, and the mount carries 3 extra load.

18. Charts the Unknown

> *Explorer, navigator, or surveyor drawn to the blank parts of the map.*

- Power tags: *always knows north*, *mapmaker's eye*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist the horizon*
- PC link: "[PC] backed my first expedition."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Carto-grapher	Any area you've travelled becomes a map (a permanent Truth). It lowers travel Difficulty there by one step.
2a	Shortcut	Once per journey, skip one leg entirely (no rolls, no Supplies spent) (Module B).
2b	First Contact	Your first Persuade or Empathy roll with a new people or culture gets a free bonus die. The normal bonus-dice cap applies.
3a	Discoverer	Once per session, discover a new site (Module C). You define one of its three Truths.
3b	★ Lands Unknown	When the party enters an uncharted region, you name one Region Truth (Module C).

19. Lives Off the Land

> *Survivalist, forager, or homesteader: you need nothing the world doesn't give.*

- Power tags: *nothing goes to waste*, *knows what's edible*
- Weakness tag: *distrusts civilization*
- PC link: "I taught [PC] how to survive their first winter."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Forager's Eye	The party loses Supplies only every other leg. You clear *Hungry & Thirsty* with an Easy Survival roll (Module B).
2a	Shelter Builder	Allies who rest in a camp you built each clear one Grind condition (Module B).
2b	Natural Remedies	Use Survival in place of Medicine for Restore effects, using what you gather.
3a	Hardened	You ignore *Exposed* and the first Grind condition you'd take each journey (Module B).
3b	★ Living Larder	The party never runs out of Supplies in any wild terrain that supports life (Module B).

20. Was Born Behind the Wheel

> *Driver, pilot, sailor, or rider: you and your vehicle are one.*

- Power tags: *my rig is part of me*, *nerves of steel at speed*
- Weakness tag: *can't leave her behind*
- PC link: "[PC] has ridden shotgun since day one."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Signature Vehicle	Gain a vehicle (horse and cart, truck, canoe, starship) with 2 power tags, or give your existing one 2 more. It takes no turns of its own.
2a	Stunt Driver	In Chase conflicts, your successful Maneuvers gain +1 Power.
2b	Grease Monkey	Repair your vehicle in the field with Craft. Restore on vehicle statuses costs 1 Power per 2 tiers.
3a	Ace	Once per scene, reroll a Drive/Pilot roll for free. Declare it after reading the dice, before spending Power or applying consequences.
3b	★ Legendary Ride	Your vehicle becomes an artifact (Module A) with one special ability (ram, jump, stealth mode, impossible speed). It costs no attunement Refresh.

8. Weird Focuses ◈

21. Hunts the Things in the Dark ◈

> *Monster-hunter, exorcist, or investigator of the strange.*

- Power tags: *knows their weaknesses*, *silver, salt, and iron*
- Weakness tag: *the dark hunts me back*
- PC link: "[PC] saw what I saw that night, and they're the only one who believes me."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Monster Lore	Once per scene, Discover a supernatural creature's weakness tag without rolling. You also know one thing that repels or binds it (salt, iron, a name).
2a	Bane	Against a creature whose weakness you've exploited, a successful conflict Attack removes 1 additional Disposition, or, if it inflicts a harmful status, raises that status by 1 tier (never both). The first time you exploit a weakness against a creature, also Discover one more of its weaknesses or abilities for free. It adds no status to an ordinary Attack and doesn't improve staking, killing strikes or other finishing procedures.
2b	Ward the Threshold	Spend an uninterrupted scene preparing one clearly defined entrance and state which side it protects. Until the next dawn, supernatural creatures can't cross without overcoming the ward: a Will test against Formidable 21 (Success at a Cost counts). Success lets that creature cross and ends the ward against it; failure leaves it outside. In a scripted conflict, crossing takes a Maneuver resolved as an independent Will test, at most once per exchange per creature, with no ordinary Maneuver effects; the opposing action also resolves independently. The ward doesn't stop attacks or Effects that reach across. Destroying the markings ends it.
3a	Unshakeable	When you Resist fear, possession, or corruption with Pneuma, the cost is 0 on a Resistance result of 5+, and you reduce the status by 3 tiers.
3b	★ Nemesis	Name a supernatural foe. You always sense its direction, and your rolls against it get a free bonus die.

22. Walks Between Worlds ◈

> *Touched by the spirit world, the Otherworld, or the deep net.*

- Power tags: *one foot across the veil*, *spirits whisper to me*
- Weakness tag: *not quite of this world*
- PC link: "[PC] anchors me. Without them, I'd drift away."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Spirit Sight	You can see and speak with spirits, ghosts, or digital entities. Once per scene, a Discover about them costs 0 Power.
2a	Crossing	With a 4-segment ritual clock, step into the other world and back, bringing up to two allies.
2b	Ghostly Ally	A minor spirit follows you. Once per scene, it gives a free Discover about places it can reach. It's an information asset, not a conflict participant.
3a	Ally Beyond	Gain a powerful patron in the other world. Once per session, call on it for a Heroic-scope favour; the GM gets a compel on your weakness tag in return.
3b	★ Half-Step	Once per scene, become intangible until your next action. Ignore one incoming imposed physical status.

23. Made a Bargain With Something Old ◈

> *Warlock, cursed heir, or desperate deal-maker. You have power, and a debt.*

- Power tags: *patron's gift*, *knows the old names*
- Weakness tag: *the debt comes due*
- PC link: "[PC] knows what I traded, and hasn't told anyone."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Patron's Gift	Gain a minor Domain (Generic Playbooks §8.1) tied to your patron. You can perform Easy and Standard workings with Arcana, paying Pneuma. If you're already an Adept, your Domain gets +1 power tag instead.
2a	Ask the Patron	Once per session, ask two Discover questions. The GM gains 1 Woe.
2b	Not Yet	Once per session, after reduction and stacking, when an imposed harmful status would reach tier 6 on you, invoke your patron: record it at tier 5 instead, so you aren't Taken Out by it and gain no Scar. The GM gets one free compel on *the debt comes due* next session. It can't prevent a shared-Disposition defeat or reverse death or a settled outcome.
3a	Greater Gift	Your patron Domain works up to Formidable 21.
3b	★ Borrowed Might	Once per session, before rolling an action that draws on your patron's Domain, give the GM 3 Woe. The action succeeds automatically with 4 Power, spent at once on Effects that action permits within the Domain's scope. It can't be used for a Heroic-scope working. A trumped action stays trumped; in a versus test it wins unless the other side also succeeds automatically, which makes a tie. The Power can't be banked or improve a finishing procedure that doesn't permit it.

24. Is More Than Human ◈

> *Mutant, cyborg, half-fae, or carrier of a strange bloodline.*

- Power tags: *[your trait]*, *unnatural resilience*
- Weakness tag: *outsider*
- PC link: "[PC] saw me change and stayed anyway."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Gift	Choose a trait (claws, enhanced senses, night vision, gills, wings, cyber-arm). Its tag may add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3) on related rolls. Gain +2 to one pool.
2a	Second Trait	Choose another trait. It also may add +1 above the normal cap (maximum +3).
2b	Regeneration	A Second or Third rest clears one tier-1 physical status. A Fourth rest clears 2 tiers from every physical status.
3a	Apex Form	Once per scene, unleash your nature: a free bonus die on Sōma and Mētis skills for the scene. At scene end, take *Weary* (Module B; without it, exhausted-2 until a night's rest) as an accepted payment.
3b	★ Beyond Limits	Gain +1 Edge in two pools (max 3 each).

DESIGN NOTES

Coverage. Strong fits by Focus number. Bellator: 1–4, 6, 16, 17, 19, 21. Furcifer: 1, 3–8, 11, 13, 14, 20. Savant: 7, 9–12, 15, 18, 21, 22. Interlocutor: 2, 8, 10, 11, 13–16. Explorator: 1–3, 5, 6, 9, 12, 17–20. Adept: 7, 9, 10, 12, 21–23. Any: 23, 24. Off-type combinations are encouraged: an Interlocutor who Masters a Weapon is a duellist-diplomat; an Adept who Was Born Behind the Wheel is a witch with a haunted truck.

Watch in playtest. The tag-cap exceptions (Masters a Weapon, Is More Than Human) at Formidable and Heroic Difficulty. Focus abilities that echo other abilities (Bypass and Decipher, Trap Sense and Escape Artist, Interrogator and Tracker, Bane and Brutal, Monster Lore and Beast Lore): the shared benefit doesn't stack on one character, but the Focus's rider still applies. Stated Create discounts still stack to the minimum (Core Rules §5).

Gaps. Planned Focuses: faith (Keeps the Faith), scholar of war, merchant, performer.

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APPENDIX

Quick Reference

Player procedures in table order, followed by a short GM strip. Full procedures and ability exceptions remain in their referenced sections.

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1. Make a Roll

2d12 + Skill + Modifiers vs. Difficulty.

Modifier	Apply
Skill	+0 to +4.
Power tags	+1 each, maximum +2.
Weakness tags	−1 each, no cap.
Statuses	Highest relevant helpful tier, minus highest relevant harmful tier.
Truths	Shift Difficulty, not the roll: one step per rank, at most ±3 steps; maximum rank 2.

Roll only when the outcome is uncertain and matters. Each Difficulty step is 3 points. A target below 9 still requires a roll unless the action is Trivial.

Difficulty	Target
Trivial	No roll
Routine	9
Easy	12
Standard	15
Hard	18
Formidable	21
Heroic	24
Epic	27
Divine	30

Bonus dice and Effort

Keep the best two dice. Maximum +2 bonus dice from all sources, including free dice.

Source	Cost
Effort	3 − relevant pool Edge, minimum 0, per use.
Momentum	1 for the first die, 2 for the second.
Woe	Give the GM 1 Woe per die.
Help	An ally spends 1 pool point and shares the risk.

Each Effort use buys one bonus die before rolling, or +1 Power after Success or Success at a Cost. Total uses per roll cannot exceed Effort Level (1 at start). Effort cannot turn failure into success.

Pay Effort and Help in full. Paying the last pool point runs that pool dry; a cost of 0 never does. Free Help waives its cost, not relevance or shared risk. Backing a conflict side is not Help.

Outcomes against Difficulty

Result	Outcome
Meet or beat target	Success: 1 Power, +1 per full 3 points over.
Miss by 1–3	Success at a Cost: 1 Power; choose a consequence or +1 Woe for the GM.
Miss by 4+	Failure: the GM makes a move and gains 1 Woe.

Spend Power on permitted Effects. Unspent Power becomes Momentum, maximum 6.

Scripted conflicts modify failure and Success at a Cost; use §3 below. Versus tests compare opposing totals instead of using this table.

Doubles and Risk

Use the two kept dice.

Dice / outcome	Result
Matching dice on Success	Critical: +1 Power and a flourish.
Matching dice on Failure / Success at a Cost	Complication.
Double 12s, independent	Always succeed; +2 Power instead of the usual +1 critical.
Double 1s	Always cause a complication, but do not automatically fail; a success still gains the ordinary +1 critical Power.

In versus tests, doubles do not override the opposing total or break ties. Winning doubles add +1 Power; winning double 12s add +2 instead. Losing or tied doubles grant no Power or normal action effect. Ability-created doubles use the same rules.

Buy off a dice complication by giving the GM 2 Woe. If you keep it and the GM cannot supply a fitting complication, the GM gains 2 Woe instead (Core §2.6).

Risky 1–3, optional: Roll one separate d12. Never keep it or add it to the total; it does not count toward the bonus-dice cap. At or below the Risk rating, it causes a complication after resolution, whatever the outcome. Buy it off normally.

Automatic success replaces an otherwise permitted roll, not its interaction or assigned turn. Use listed Power. In versus it wins unless both automatically succeed, then tie unless explicitly overridden. No extra action, rescue of a trumped action, or dice-based critical/complication.

Core §§2.1–2.7; conflict exceptions in §10.

2. Track Resources and Consequences

The four currencies

Resource	Who tracks it / main use
Pools	Each PC: Effort, abilities and Resistance.
Tychē Points	Each PC: invokes and compels.
Momentum	Party: bonus dice; maximum 6.
Woe	GM: opposition spending and escalation.

Statuses

Record a status's name, tier, scope and removal condition. Apply only the highest relevant helpful status and the highest relevant harmful status. Names alone do not establish scope. Impede is not a status; Grind conditions use Module B.3.

Resist an imposed status

Roll 2 + Edge d12 and take the highest die. Pay the result's cost; do not subtract Edge from it. Resistance reduces the incoming status by 2 tiers.

Result	Pool cost
Two or more 12s	0; also clear a tier-1 status.
9–12	1
5–8	2
1–4	3

With negative Edge, roll 1d12. At Edge −2 or lower, increase the cost by 1, maximum 3.

Ordinary Disposition loss and accepted payments cannot be Resisted.

Running dry

A cost that empties a pool imposes depletion at tier 1 + overrun. Overrun is the amount by which the cost exceeds points remaining.

Only Resistance and imposed costs may overrun unless explicitly permitted. A cost of 0 never runs dry. Depletion stacks normally. At tier 6, you are Taken Out within its scope and gain one Scar, at most once per scene.

The pool and depletion recover separately: 2 recovery points remove 1 depletion tier.

Rest and recovery

Rest	Time	Recovery
First	Seconds; 1 action mid-encounter	½d12, round up
Second	10 minutes	½d12, round up, +1
Third	1 hour	½d12, round up, +2
Fourth	10 hours / overnight	All pools full

Divide points among your pools without exceeding their maximums. Edge does not apply. Recovery-modifying abilities use their full entries.

Pool recovery and status healing do not restore Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars. Treatment removes at most 1 tier of a lasting injury until healing time does.

Life-threatening tier-6 harm with lethal stakes can start a 3-segment Dying clock. Medicine vs. Hard 18 stabilises. Explicit creature breaking-point rules replace generic outcomes only where stated.

Core §§5–6.5; currencies in §§2–4 and §9.

3. Run a Conflict

Use scripting when the stakes matter, opposition actively resists and several tactical choices matter.

Setup

1. State objectives, stakes, participants and exits.
2. Roll 2d12 + Disposition skill + highest Edge in that skill's pool.
3. Divide by 3 and round down.
4. Add +1 per eligible backer and all flat modifiers at full value.
5. Apply the minimum of 1, then opposing Superiority.
6. Determine both adjusted totals before resolving setup.
7. Record adjusted starting Disposition.

Backing is free and committed before the setup roll. Each backer explains a meaningful contribution and joins the side's stakes. It is not Help and grants no die. Free-Help abilities add no further setup benefit unless explicit.

Grit-built adversary sides use their listed setup instead of the Disposition roll.

Superiority: one per distinct, relevant preparation category—Know Thy Foe, Know Thy Battlefield, Know Thy Players—maximum 3. Use Core §10.3 for eligibility. PC/opposition symmetry and eligibility retain their PLAYTEST flags.

Adjusted totals	Setup outcome
Only one side at 0	Its opponent wins at no cost within the stakes.
Both sides at 0	Mutual defeat; neither wins outright.
Neither side at 0	Proceed to scripting.

Only Superiority can reduce setup below the minimum of 1. Setup defeat scripts no exchange and inflicts no injury, pool loss or Taken Out by itself.

Script and reveal

Each side secretly commits three actions and their assigned actors. Reveal one volley at a time. If the conflict continues, script another exchange.

Track rotation continuously across exchanges:

- Everyone available acts once per round.
- Nobody acts in consecutive volleys unless they are the only available participant.
- Helping does not count as a turn.
- Update rotation when someone joins, withdraws or becomes unable to act.

Before reveal, the players may spend 2 Momentum to change one unrevealed action, keeping its assigned actor. An unsuitable or unperformable action grants no free replacement.

Action interactions

I = independent; V = versus; A = Attack only; F = Feint only.

Your action	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Attack	I	V	A	V
Defend	V	I	F	V
Feint	A	F	V	V
Maneuver	V	V	V	I

A: Attack rolls independently; Feint is trumped. F: Feint rolls independently; Defend is trumped.

Independent: Test against Standard 15, adjusted by Truths and explicit modifiers such as Guard. Both independent actions finish before checking victory, even if one defeats a side or Takes Out its actor.

Versus: Higher total wins with 1 Power, +1 per full 3 points over the opponent. Exact tie: no Power or normal action effect. Losing by 1–3 is not Success at a Cost. Winning prevents the opposing normal effect even if all Power buys other permitted Effects.

Trumped: No roll and no action effect. Paid costs remain spent.

Conflict failure and costs

Situation	Ordinary-failure Woe
Failed independent action	+1
Versus loss, exact tie or trump	None

An ordinary failed action grants no additional unrelated GM move, automatic injury or extra Disposition loss.

Independent Success at a Cost grants 1 Power. Its ordinary cost cannot impose a status or extra Disposition loss without explicit permission. Separately triggered complications, explicit costs and scenery Dangers retain their own rules.

Core §§10.1–10.7.

4. Spend Power in a Conflict

Use one Power budget. No primary purchase is mandatory. Relevance alone does not grant permission.

Action / purchase	Power	Result
Attack / Feint	Commit at least 1	Remove committed Power + 1 opposing Disposition. Apply the +1 once per action.
Defend	1 per point	Restore shared Disposition up to the original adjusted start.
Impede	1	−3 on the opposing side's next scripted action roll.
Gain Position	1	One bonus die on the friendly side's next scripted action roll.
Disarm	3	Disable the named asset for the conflict.
Create a Truth	2 per rank	Establish a justified Truth; apply explicit discounts and the normal minimum.

With no Power committed to ordinary loss or recovery, apply none unless an explicit ability grants it independently. Ordinary Attacks and Feints grant no status or pool loss. Attack bonuses do not improve Feint unless stated.

Buy Impede, Gain Position and Disarm at most once each per Maneuver. Impede and Gain Position affect the next scripted action, including across exchanges. A no-roll action consumes them unused. Neither affects unrelated Resistance or incidental rolls.

Pending Impedes do not stack or extend duration. Only one Gain Position may be pending per side regardless of source; additional grants do not stack, refresh or extend it. Its die counts toward the normal cap.

Disarm disables an asset, not automatically an entire action category. Switching equipment does not itself change a script.

Supplementary Effects

Effect	Permitted actions	Power / limit
Weaken	Explicit ability only	As permitted by the ability and Core §5; not a cheaper Disarm.
Create	Maneuver	2 per rank; explicit discounts and minimum cost apply.
Enhance	Defend or Maneuver	Normal tier price and scope (§5).
Restore	Defend	Normal tier price, scope and treatment limits (§5).
Discover	Any successful action	1 per relevant question; repeatable.
Advance	Attack or Maneuver	1 per segment; repeatable.
Disrupt	Maneuver	3; once per Maneuver.
Extra Feat	Any successful action	1; once unless expressly overridden.

Other actions require explicit permission. An exception grants only its stated purchase, trigger, cost, frequency and scope; free waives only its listed cost.

Advance affects a separate established clock, not a duplicate Disposition track or an unstated bypass of the objective. Establish any conflict-ending clock relationship before scripting.

Disrupt affects an established prepared action outside the committed script, or removes 1 available GM Woe. It cannot generically cancel, replace, reveal or delay a committed action, reverse a spend or cancel an accepted payment.

Extra Feat grants one related secondary accomplishment—not another turn or roll, duplicate primary effect, prohibited purchase, cancellation of an independent opposing action or objective outside the stakes.

Create costs 2 Power per Truth rank outside conflicts as well. Each explicit ability/item discount reduces its Power cost by 1, minimum 1. An ordinary Attack or Feint gains no harmful-status permission from supplementary purchases.

Scenery purchases use Core §10.8. Furcifer openings and other ability exceptions use their full entries; see Generic Playbooks §4.1 for Opportunist and Deadly Precision.

Core §5 and §§10.6–10.8.

5. Resolve Loss and Outcomes

Shared Disposition

Each side has one total. It is not health and has no individual shares or spill-over. Ordinary Disposition loss removes no particular participant.

Armour and Resistance do not reduce ordinary Disposition loss without explicit permission. Removing a participant or backer subtracts no Disposition and does not recalculate setup.

Reinforcements add listed Grit to current Disposition, not the original start, recovery cap or compromise reference. At or above the cap, recovery restores nothing and removes no excess.

Accept injury

Once per character per conflict, accept a lasting injury to cancel ordinary loss from a successful Attack or Feint. Declare before

applying loss. Only one participant may trade against each Attack or Feint.

Accepted injury	Loss cancelled
Tier 2	1
Tier 3	2
Tier 4	3

The injury must follow from the action, be relevant, new or worsened, and remain below tier 6 after stacking. Do not pay with an existing, irrelevant or redundant injury, trade after being Taken Out, or cancel more loss than inflicted.

This trade affects incoming ordinary Attack/Feint loss, not loss already suffered, imposed statuses, finishing procedures or other sources unless explicitly permitted.

Accepted injury is a protected payment: it cannot be prevented, reduced, redirected or Resisted. Later recovery follows its own rules and refunds no benefit.

Area effects

Establish the area and everyone within reach; allies are not automatically excluded. Apply ordinary shared loss once, adding 1 per additional opposing participant affected, only when Power funds ordinary loss. One group rules entry counts as one participant, not one per Body.

Explicit statuses apply at full tier with separate Resistance or NPC reduction. Area alone grants no status to an ordinary Attack. At most one participant may trade injury against the combined loss. No Disposition loss outside conflicts.

Defeat and compromise

A side loses at 0 Disposition or when nobody can continue pursuing its objective. Complete independent actions and eligible pre-defeat effects before settling the outcome.

Defeat does not automatically inflict injury. Resolve any required creature finishing procedure before compromise; adversary Specials retain their explicit aftermath timing.

Compare the winner's final remaining Disposition with its original adjusted start:

Starting Disposition lost	Compromise
None	None
More than 0, less than half	Minor
At least half, less than three-quarters	Significant
Three-quarters or more	Major

Use proportions without rounding, not cumulative loss. Remaining Disposition at or above the original start means no compromise. Reinforcements do not change the reference.

Negotiate one outcome-first package. Injury tiers 2/3/4 guide Minor/Significant/Major severity; they are not automatic injuries. Credit each eligible existing injury once. Eligible imposed statuses may be Resisted; agreed payments may not. Resistance does not revoke a concession or create replacement injury costs.

If both sides are defeated, use mutual defeat rather than a winner's compromise: resolve compatible parts of both intents and a shared setback within the stakes; neither wins outright (Core §10.12).

Concede

Before the next roll, propose what the opponent gains, what your side retains, every cost and how the struggle ends.

If accepted, apply the terms without another roll or additional compromise unless included. Agreed costs are protected payments. If rejected, continue.

Core §§10.9–10.14; area effects §10.17.

GM Strip

Full adversary procedures govern; this strip grants no additional activation permission.

Reminder	Procedure
Change an unrevealed action	3 Woe, or 2 with an eligible Leader; keep the assigned actor.
NPC dice complication	Spend 2 Woe to cancel it.
NPC injury trades	Ordinary NPCs and groups cannot trade; full-PC rivals and explicit exceptions use Core §10.14.
Bulwark	Once per exchange, choose status interception or Hold the Line. Intercept before the ally's Resistance/reduction; redirect the whole eligible status and use the Bulwark's eligible reduction, at most one NPC reduction per status. Hold the Line reduces one successful opposing Attack's combined ordinary loss by 1 before injury trade/application. For Hold the Line: no multiple-Bulwark stacking, Feint, Maneuver, separate Special damage, protected payments or solely self-protecting use. Interception cannot affect protected payments or shield an ally from an area status already affecting both. Outside conflicts, fitting-status interception has no separate frequency limit; Hold the Line has no effect. Full eligibility: Adversaries §6.13.
Declarations and reactions	Close Power purchases and action-triggered supplementary declarations, resolve permitted reactions, then uncancelled effects. Cancellation does not reopen declarations. Preserve expressly later windows, including Self-Repair (Adversaries §6.16).
End of volley	Complete both independent actions → Self-Repair → Bolt → defeat / eligible Last Stand → eligible phases → eligible exchange-end arrivals → participation and rotation. No Disposition repair from 0; status repair does not cancel pending defeat. Arrivals create no extra action or phase check.
Calls and Last Stand	Calls use pre-reveal windows. Last Stand creates no call window or new exchange boundary. If activated after volley three, check that exchange's arrivals once before the extension, never again afterward; pending-defeat recovery remains prohibited.
Special exceptions	Use Adversaries §§6.10–6.24 for participation, aftermath order, delayed arrivals and same-volley Lockdown/Bolt. Deferred records: once per named Special per target per conflict across sources; resolve individually after every outcome.

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